

GOD OF BALIMWEZO

THE OMNIBUS EDITION – VOLUMES ONE THROUGH THREE

Volumes One, Two & Three



MUHUMUZA BRIGHT ANDREW

GOD OF BALIMWEZO

The Omnibus Edition: Volumes One Through Three

BY MUHUMUZA BRIGHT ANDREW

Bryt Ma Tech Uganda

Comprising Volume One: God of Balimwezo, Volume Two: The Door Bobi Wine Opened, and Volume Three: Kingmaker.

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Comprising Volume One: God of Balimwezo, Volume Two: The Door Bobi Wine Opened, and Volume Three: Kingmaker.

First edition, 2026.

Published by Bryt Ma Tech Uganda.

*For every person still faithful
in a season no one is applauding.*

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MUHUMUZA BRIGHT ANDREW

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VOLUME ONE

GOD OF BALIMWEZO

How One Man's Obedience Opened Another Man's Door

Before You Begin

This book can be read in one sitting, or one chapter at a time over several weeks. Neither way is wrong.

Each chapter stands on its own, but they build toward the same question: what would change in you if you believed that faithfulness in a small, unnoticed place was never actually wasted?

You do not need to agree with every sentence to be changed by the book. You only need to be willing to ask, honestly, whose door you might already be standing near.

Read slowly where something resists you. That resistance is usually where the book has something to say.

CHAPTER 1

The Years Nobody Applauded



There is a kind of faithfulness that does not look important while you are living it.

It does not arrive with music. No one gathers around it. There is no crowd waiting to celebrate the morning you decide to keep going. It looks like returning to the same place. It looks like carrying responsibility that has become ordinary. It looks like doing work that matters, even when the work does not make your name larger.

Ronald Balimwezo spent years in that kind of season.

He is a civil engineer and a lecturer at Kyambogo University. He has been in local government since 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division. These are not small facts, but they can feel small when placed beside a later title. A citywide office has a way of making earlier years

look like a preface. The final position becomes so visible that we begin to read everything before it as if it were merely leading there.

But life is not usually experienced that way.

The person serving in the smaller place does not possess a complete map of the future. The councillor does not wake each morning holding a printed explanation of what the next fifteen years will mean. The lecturer does not know which lesson, which student, or which ordinary day will become part of a larger story. The mayor of one division does not automatically know that a larger door will one day open.

Most of us live without that map.

We work with what has been placed in front of us. We serve where we are. We make the next responsible choice. We answer the next call. We carry the duty that belongs to this particular season, even when another season seems more impressive from a distance.

That is why Ronald Balimwezo's story begins before the Lord Mayor's seat.

It begins with the unnoticed years.

Faithfulness often looks ordinary before it looks significant.

We are often tempted to believe that preparation must feel like promotion. If God is preparing us for something larger, we imagine that the preparation should come with signs large enough to reassure us. We expect increasing recognition, clearer opportunities, and perhaps some visible evidence that our present work is being watched by the right people.

Yet much of preparation is hidden from the person being prepared.

A civil engineer may continue to be an engineer. A lecturer may continue to teach. A local government servant may continue to serve one division. None of these activities announces what they might become in the hands of God. They are simply the work of the day. The meaning comes later, if it comes at all.

This is difficult for us because we prefer a story in which the future explains the present before we have to endure the present. We want to know that the delay is purposeful while we are still waiting. We want confirmation before obedience. We want to be told that the small place is connected to the larger place before we give ourselves fully to the small place.

But what if the small place is not a punishment?

What if it is not evidence that we have been forgotten?

What if the work itself is the place where God is forming the steadiness that a later responsibility will require?

We should be careful here. A later title does not prove that every earlier difficulty was arranged as a neat plan. We do not need to turn a real life into a simplistic formula.

Faith does not require us to pretend that every unanswered question has already been answered. It asks us to remain honest about what we know and humble about what we do not.

What we know about Balimwezo is that he served in local government from 2006. We know that he was mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. We know that he worked as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. We know that, in January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and that he was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

But before those later facts could be listed together, they had to be lived one day at a time.

That is the part we are most likely to overlook.

We see the office and forget the years of service. We see the recognition and forget the repetition. We see a door opening and forget that the person standing before it had already spent a long time becoming someone who could walk through it with responsibility.

This is not because the years before the door were worthless. It is because visibility changes our memory. Once a person is known for one thing, we begin to imagine that the earlier version of them was only waiting to be

discovered. We speak as though the future greatness was obvious. We say, “It was always there,” and perhaps it was. But something being present is not the same as something being recognized.

There is a difference between potential and opportunity.

A person may possess ability for years without receiving the room in which that ability can serve more people. Competence can remain local. Wisdom can remain unconsulted. Character can be built in places where there is no public reward for having it.

Ronald Balimwezo’s story gives us a picture of that difference. The later office did not create the years that came before it. The title did not manufacture the service. It gave a wider platform to a life that had already been spent serving.

That distinction matters spiritually.

Sometimes we ask God to make us ready when what we mean is that we want to be seen. Sometimes we call a season “preparation” only when we can point to the promotion that followed it. If no larger door opens, we conclude that the smaller work did not count.

But God does not measure value by the size of the audience.

A person can be deeply useful before being widely known. A life can carry weight before it carries a public title. A servant can be shaping a community before anyone outside that community knows the servant’s name.

This should change how we look at the people around us.

The person next to you may not yet have the opportunity that matches their ability. The colleague whose work feels routine may be carrying a discipline that will matter in a different setting. The neighbour who has served quietly may have learned the patience that a larger assignment will demand. The person you have reduced to their current role may already contain more than their current role reveals.

And perhaps the harder question is this: have we helped them believe that what they carry matters?

Appreciation is not the same as flattery. It is not the habit of praising everyone for everything. It is the moral act of paying attention. It is the willingness to recognize value before the wider world confirms it. It says, “I see the faithfulness in what you are doing,” even when there is no dramatic result to point toward.

We often wait too long to say such things.

We wait until the person has become successful. We wait until the appointment is public. We wait until other people begin speaking well of them. Then appreciation becomes easy because it no longer requires discernment. The evidence is already visible. The crowd has made the judgment for us.

But the appreciation that changes a life often comes earlier, when the evidence is incomplete and the future is uncertain.

The central truth of this series is not that every quiet servant will become a mayor. That would be another form of disappointment disguised as encouragement. The truth is deeper and less predictable: God works through people, and we do not know which person sitting next to us He is preparing to use.

That uncertainty is part of the responsibility.

We cannot see in advance who will be entrusted with a larger assignment. We cannot know which ordinary season will later become part of a public story. We cannot tell whether the person we overlook is simply passing through a small season or is being prepared for a responsibility we cannot imagine.

So we are called to appreciate people before their significance is obvious.

Ronald Balimwezo did not become Lord Mayor in the first year of his service. The story, as given to us, includes a long period in local government, a decade as mayor of Nakawa Division, and work as an engineer and lecturer. The later door did not erase the earlier years. It revealed that they had not been empty.

And yet even that door was not built by one person alone.

A musician named Bobi Wine entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. That decision was made for reasons belonging to Bobi Wine's own life. It was not made as a plan for Ronald Balimwezo. At the time, there was no reason for anyone to know that the platform would later become connected to Balimwezo's rise to the city's highest local office.

This is how God sometimes moves through history. One person obeys a burden they can see. Another person benefits from an opening they could not have predicted. The connection becomes visible only afterward.

We should not use that mystery to avoid our duties. We should use it to become more attentive.

Your work may be smaller than you hoped. Someone else's decision may be changing the shape of your future without your knowledge. The person you are tempted to dismiss may be carrying the beginning of something that will bless many people. The encouragement you withhold may not destroy their calling, but it may make the road lonelier than it needs to be.

We do not control the future of another person. We are not their saviour. We cannot manufacture a calling or guarantee an outcome. But we can refuse to despise small beginnings. We can learn to honour faithful service. We can speak gratitude while a person is still serving without applause.

The years nobody applauded still mattered.

They mattered to the communities Balimwezo served. They mattered to the work he carried. They mattered to the person he was becoming. And, in ways no one could see at the time, they became part of the story of a door that would eventually open.

Perhaps you are living in such a year now. Perhaps the work is repetitive. Perhaps your name is known only to the people immediately around you. Perhaps you have started to measure your life by the opportunities you have not received instead of the responsibilities you have received and carried well.

Do not rush to call the season wasted.

And do not wait for a title before you appreciate the person who is faithful beside you.

Whose quiet service are you overlooking today because the world has not yet given you proof that it matters?

CHAPTER 2

The Door Built Somewhere Else



A door can be built for one reason and used for another.

The person who lifts the first stone may never meet the person who later walks through the opening. The decision may begin in one life and bear its consequences in another. A choice can be deeply personal at the moment it is made, yet become part of a story much larger than the person who made it could see.

That is what makes the story of Ronald Balimwezo and Bobi Wine so difficult to explain with ordinary language.

Ronald Balimwezo was serving in local government. He was a civil engineer and a lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to

2021. His work had its own shape, its own demands, and its own place in the life of the community.

Far away from the full meaning of that future, a musician was facing a different kind of decision.

In 2017, Bobi Wine entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election. He had been known as a musician. Politics was not the continuation of an established political career. It was a step into a different public role, with uncertainty attached to it. From that beginning, he built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform.

At the time of that first decision, Ronald Balimwezo was not the person for whom the door was being built. There is no reason to imagine that he was. Bobi Wine was making a decision in his own story. He was responding to a call, an opportunity, or a conviction that belonged to that moment of his life. The later connection was not visible.

This is often how God works through people.

One person sees only the next step. God sees the people who may one day be helped by that step.

You may be building a door whose future visitor you will never know.

We tend to imagine influence as something intentional and direct. Someone decides to mentor us. Someone recommends us. Someone opens a specific opportunity and tells us why they are doing it. Those moments matter, and we should be grateful for them.

But there is another kind of influence. It is less tidy. It moves through decisions whose full consequences remain hidden. A person chooses obedience in one area, and years later someone else discovers that the choice created room for them to serve.

The first person may never have known the second person would benefit.

That hiddenness can make obedience hard. If we knew exactly who would be helped, we might feel encouraged. If we could see the final result, we

might accept the cost more willingly. If Bobi Wine had known that the platform he would build would later become part of the path through which Ronald Balimwezo reached the office of Lord Mayor of Kampala, perhaps the decision would have felt easier to interpret.

But people rarely receive that kind of information in advance.

The decision comes before the explanation.

This does not mean that every difficult decision is automatically a divine assignment. We should not claim certainty where we have none. It does mean that a faithful act can have a reach beyond its maker's intention. Human beings live inside networks of consequence. What one person does creates conditions in which another person may act.

A teacher's work may prepare a student for a task the teacher never sees. A friend's encouragement may give courage to someone who later helps an entire community. A parent's quiet discipline may shape a child who carries strength into places the parent will never enter. A citizen's years of service may become the foundation for someone else's public responsibility.

The work travels.

Bobi Wine's entry into politics changed the shape of his own public life. It also became the beginning of a platform through which other people would later serve. Ronald Balimwezo's eventual rise did not make Bobi Wine's original decision about Ronald Balimwezo. The two stories are connected without being identical.

That distinction is important because it protects us from a shallow understanding of calling.

We do not obey only when the outcome will reward us. We do not act only when the people who benefit can be named. We do not serve merely because the future will make the present look wise. Sometimes the integrity of a decision must be enough for the person making it. The result may belong partly to people who have not yet entered the story.

This is one of the humbling parts of faith.

We want our obedience to come with ownership. We want to say, “I did this, and here is what it produced.” We want the outcome to remain attached to our name. We want to see the people we helped and hear them explain what our help meant.

God may give us that joy. But He may also allow our work to become useful in ways we cannot trace.

A door is not less valuable because the builder does not control everyone who uses it.

Consider the years of Balimwezo’s service. His work in local government was real before anyone could connect it to the larger platform that later became available. His years as mayor of Nakawa Division had meaning before the Lord Mayor’s office became part of his public story. The opportunity that eventually opened did not give value to those years. It gave them a wider field in which their value could be expressed.

This is why comparison can be so damaging.

We look at another person’s new opportunity and decide that our own work must have been inferior because it did not lead to the same place. We see a door open for someone else and assume God has judged us to be less capable. We forget that doors do not all serve the same purpose, and that timing is not a measurement of worth.

Bobi Wine’s decision and Ronald Balimwezo’s preparation belonged to different stories before they became connected. One man built a political platform. Another man spent years serving in local government. Neither could have arranged the entire sequence alone.

That is a needed correction to our pride.

We like to describe achievement as if it were the product of one person’s strength. We praise the individual who stands in the visible place and forget the people, choices, institutions, opportunities, and years that made the moment possible. We say that someone “made it” when the truth is usually more complicated. A person may have worked hard and still needed a door. A person may have been prepared and still needed an opening. A person may have been faithful and still needed someone else’s courage to change the

available path.

Ronald Balimwezo did not need Bobi Wine to be capable. He needed an opening through which his capability could serve at a different scale.

And Bobi Wine, in turn, could not know whose life would later be touched by the platform he built. That is the mystery of human obedience. We are responsible for the step in front of us, not for controlling every consequence after it.

This should make us gentler with our own lives.

Perhaps you have made a decision that appears to have helped no one. Perhaps you left something familiar. Perhaps you accepted a responsibility that did not produce immediate recognition. Perhaps you encouraged someone and never saw what the encouragement became. Perhaps you served in a place that seemed too small to matter.

Do not assume that the absence of visible results means the absence of fruit.

At the same time, do not demand that every sacrifice be called meaningful simply because it was difficult. Difficulty alone is not proof of obedience. We need honesty. We need prayer. We need wise counsel. We need the humility to admit that we cannot always tell what our choices will produce.

The lesson is not “make every bold decision.” The lesson is “take seriously the decisions you make,” because other lives may be affected by them in ways you cannot predict.

A person may be watching you without telling you. A colleague may be learning courage from the way you carry an ordinary duty. A younger person may be measuring what is possible by what you are willing to attempt. Someone in your own home may be receiving permission to hope because you refused to surrender to fear.

You may never know.

That is why appreciation matters so much. We should not wait until the complete story is visible before we honour the people whose choices helped make it possible. We should appreciate the builder while the door is still only

taking shape. We should recognize the servant before the title arrives. We should say thank you before the result gives us a convenient reason.

The people around us are not merely background figures in our own stories. They may be carrying decisions that will shape opportunities for others. They may be doing work whose full usefulness is hidden even from them. They may need one sentence of appreciation to remain faithful in a season that offers little applause.

And we may be the people who are close enough to say it.

The story of Balimwezo's rise to the Lord Mayorship of Kampala includes a decision made years earlier by someone else, for reasons that were not about him. The connection could not have been obvious at the start. It became visible only as time passed and the platform opened a path that had not previously existed in the same form.

That should leave us with both wonder and responsibility.

Wonder, because our lives are more connected than we know. Responsibility, because our choices are not contained within us as neatly as we sometimes pretend. The person we appreciate may gain courage. The person we dismiss may retreat. The opportunity we build may become someone else's answer to prayer.

We do not get to choose who God will use. We do get to choose whether we will become the kind of person through whom He can make room for others.

A musician's decision can become an engineer's door. A platform created in one season can carry a servant into another. A choice made without knowledge of its future can still become part of God's preparation.

The builder may not know the traveller.

But God does.

What decision are you making now that may be preparing an opportunity **for someone whose name you do not yet know?**

CHAPTER 3

When Faithfulness Has No Audience



There is a particular kind of tiredness that comes from doing good work without being noticed.

It is not always physical tiredness. Sometimes it is the weariness of wondering whether anyone understands what the work costs. You keep showing up, but no one says your presence matters. You carry responsibility, but the responsibility does not come with recognition. You serve the same people in the same place, and the repetition begins to whisper that your life is standing still.

This is where many people quietly give up.

Not always by leaving. Sometimes they remain in the place, but their heart leaves first. They continue to perform the task while withdrawing the

love that once made the task an offering. They become careful, not faithful. They do only what can be measured. They stop giving what cannot be applauded.

The unseen years test more than our endurance. They test why we serve.

Ronald Balimwezo's public story includes a long period of local government service. He entered local government in 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division. He also worked as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University.

Those years give us something more valuable than a dramatic beginning. They give us duration.

A person can appear faithful for a short time because the first season is exciting. New work can carry its own energy. A new responsibility can make sacrifice feel meaningful. But years reveal whether the service has become part of a person's character or was only a temporary response to attention.

We should not romanticize long service. Time alone does not make a person wise or good. A person can repeat the same work without growing. A person can hold a position for years without serving well. The point is not that every long season is automatically holy.

The point is that faithfulness must be practiced over time.

What is done faithfully in private is still seen by God.

We say this easily, but many of us do not live as if we believe it. We want a human witness. We want someone to notice the restraint, the patience, the extra effort, the decision not to abandon the work when the work stopped flattering us.

We want our sacrifice to be recorded.

God's attention is comforting, but it can also be confronting. If He sees the hidden work, then He sees not only the good we do without applause but also the good we refuse to do because no one will applaud it. He sees the motive beneath the visible action. He knows when our service is an offering and when it is a performance waiting for a review.

This is not meant to frighten us into pretending. It is an invitation to honesty.

Why are you doing what you are doing?

That question may not have one answer. We often serve from mixed motives. We may love people and still want recognition. We may accept responsibility sincerely and still feel disappointed when appreciation does not come. We may be willing to wait and still wish the waiting would end.

There is no shame in admitting this. The danger begins when we allow the desire to be seen to determine whether we will remain faithful.

Ronald Balimwezo's years in local government can be read as a reminder that meaningful service may take place long before the wider public understands its value. His work as mayor of Nakawa Division was not a rehearsal in the sense that the people of Nakawa were merely an audience for a future office. The work mattered where it was

done. The smaller setting was not important only because it later connected to a larger one.

This is where our ambition must be purified.

A small assignment is not valuable merely because it may lead to a larger assignment. A congregation is not valuable merely because someone there may one day become famous. A local community is not valuable merely because it may serve as a stepping-stone to a more visible role.

People are not stepping-stones.

Places are not disposable.

The work in front of us deserves integrity because the people receiving that work possess dignity now, not only after our service leads somewhere else. If God later opens a wider door, we may be grateful. But we must not use the possibility of that door as the only reason to care about the room we are already in.

The story of Balimwezo's service begins, therefore, not with what the service eventually produced for him. It begins with the people and responsibilities that received his attention during the years when the future

had not yet announced itself.

This changes the way we understand preparation.

Preparation is not always a private project in which God trains us for our real life while we wait in an unreal one. The season we call preparation is real life. The people we serve during it are real people. The decisions we make there are real decisions. If a later opportunity comes, it will not make the earlier season more real. It will only reveal another use for what was formed there.

That is why the unseen years deserve our respect.

They are not empty spaces between significant events. They are where habits are established. They are where a person learns what responsibility feels like after the excitement fades. They are where one discovers whether service depends on being praised. They are where the heart faces the possibility that no one may ever say, “Well done,” and must decide whether obedience is still worth offering.

I know how easy it is to want evidence.

We tell ourselves that one encouraging word would be enough. One invitation. One person asking what we think. One sign that the effort is reaching somewhere. Sometimes that is true. Encouragement is a gift, and those who withhold it should not excuse themselves by saying that God sees everything. God’s sight is not permission for human beings to be careless with one another.

The person next to us still needs appreciation from people.

Yet there will be seasons when appreciation does not arrive in the measure we need. There will be work whose results appear slowly. There will be service that is known only to a few. There will be days when we must decide whether the absence of praise has changed the value of what we are doing.

It has not.

A seed does not become less alive because it is beneath the soil. A foundation does not become less necessary because it will later be covered.

The hidden part of a building is not decorative, but it carries weight. What cannot be seen may still be bearing the structure.

We should be careful with comparisons here. We do not know every detail of Balimwezo's experience, and we should not invent his private thoughts or claim that he never felt discouraged. He is a real person, not a symbol designed to make our lessons convenient. What we can say is that the public facts show sustained service across years and roles: local government, the mayorship of Nakawa Division, engineering, and lecturing.

That is enough to ask a serious question about our own lives.

What are we willing to keep doing when the work is no longer new, the result is not immediate, and the applause belongs to someone else?

The question is not about becoming passive. Faithfulness does not mean refusing change. It does not mean staying in every place forever. It does not mean allowing people to exploit our willingness to serve. Sometimes obedience requires leaving. Sometimes wisdom requires rest. Sometimes a season ends because God is not asking us to maintain what He once asked us to begin.

But we should not leave merely because the work has become ordinary.

Ordinary is not the opposite of sacred.

The daily responsibility, the repeated act of care, the long attention given to a community: these may be the very places where God is shaping the person who will later carry a larger trust. The formation may be invisible because it is happening through repetition rather than spectacle.

And while we are learning faithfulness, we must learn appreciation.

Look again at the people whose work has become familiar to you. Familiarity can make us blind. We stop seeing the nurse who remains patient, the parent who keeps providing, the teacher who continues preparing, the volunteer who quietly arranges what everyone else takes for granted. We call it "what they do" and forget that people can become exhausted while doing what they are known for doing.

Perhaps the person you now take for granted once needed someone to tell them that their service mattered. Perhaps they still do.

Appreciation is one way we participate in another person's endurance. It does not create their calling. It does not guarantee their future. But it can strengthen the heart for another day of faithful work. A sentence spoken at the right time may remind someone that their effort has not disappeared into nothing.

We should not wait for the world to confirm a person before we honour them.

By January 2026, Ronald Balimwezo had won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket. In May 2026, he was sworn in as Lord Mayor. Those events brought public

attention to a role he had not previously held. But public attention did not begin his service. It arrived after years in which the work had already been happening.

This is the temptation of visible success: it makes the hidden years look obvious in retrospect. We read backward and assume the outcome was inevitable. We forget that a future can be possible without being guaranteed. We forget that people serve without knowing whether the next door will open.

Faithfulness does not possess the future.

It offers the present.

That is all we are asked to do today. Not to force tomorrow into view. Not to demand that our current task explain the whole of our life. Not to despise the place where God has presently given us responsibility.

Offer the present honestly.

Do the work in front of you with the strength you have. Ask for help when you need it. Receive correction without treating it as rejection. Accept encouragement without making praise your god. And when you see someone else carrying an ordinary responsibility with uncommon steadiness, say so.

You may be closer to their hidden years than you realize.

You may be the person whose appreciation helps them remain faithful. You may be standing beside someone who will one day serve many more people than they can currently reach. Or you may simply be standing beside a person who deserves to know that their service is already valuable, even if it never becomes famous.

That is reason enough.

The work does not have to become a public story before it becomes a holy offering. The servant does not have to become a household name before their life matters. And the person beside you does not have to prove their future significance before you treat them with care.

The years nobody applauded were not waiting to become meaningful.

They were meaningful while they were being lived.

Who has been faithfully serving beside you for so long that you have stopped noticing, and what specific appreciation can you offer them before today ends?

CHAPTER 4

When the Door Finally Opens



A door can be open before we feel ready to walk through it.

For years, Ronald Balimwezo's work had been connected to one division of Kampala. He had been in local government since 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division. He was also a civil engineer and a lecturer at Kyambogo University.

Then the scale of the responsibility changed.

In January 2026, Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. In May 2026, he was sworn in as Lord Mayor.

The facts are simple. The meaning is not.

A larger office can make a person's earlier life look as though it was always moving toward that exact moment. We look back at the years of local

service and see a straight line. We look at the engineering background, the lecturing, and the work in Nakawa Division, and we arrange them into a sequence that seems inevitable.

But a person living through those years does not see a straight line. They see the responsibility immediately in front of them. They see the work that must be done today. They do not know whether the next opportunity will come, when it will come, or whether it will look anything like the opportunity that eventually appears.

A door may be part of God's preparation long before it becomes part of our expectation.

The right door does not erase the years; it reveals what they were carrying.

The opening of a door can be unsettling. We often speak of opportunity as if it were only good news. We say that someone has been blessed with a larger platform, and that may be true. But a larger platform also brings greater responsibility. More people are watching. More needs become visible. More decisions carry consequences. The room is wider, but the weight may be heavier.

This is why preparation matters.

Balimwezo's rise to Lord Mayor did not mean that every question had been answered or that every difficulty had disappeared. It meant that a new responsibility had been placed before him. His earlier years did not make him invulnerable. They gave him experience of serving before the eyes of the whole city were on him.

There is a difference between being ready for attention and being ready for responsibility.

Attention asks whether people know your name. Responsibility asks whether you will remain present when the name is known and the work is hard. Attention can be received in a moment. Responsibility must be carried over time.

The most important preparation may therefore be the part no one notices. It is not always the visible achievement. It may be the discipline of returning. It may be the patience learned in a smaller setting. It may be the humility of serving people who cannot expand your reputation. It may be the ability to keep doing what matters without needing every action to enlarge your public image.

We do not know every detail of Balimwezo's inner experience as the Lord Mayor's door opened, and we should not invent his private thoughts. We can say only what the public record permits us to say: he had served in local government for many years, had been mayor of Nakawa Division, worked as an engineer and lecturer, won the 2026 race, and was sworn in during May 2026.

That public record is enough to show a pattern of responsibility preceding wider recognition.

The pattern challenges our impatience.

We often want the larger assignment without the smaller obligations that prepare us to carry it. We want the title without the years that teach us how to live beneath it. We want the citywide opportunity while resenting the local task. We want the harvest while regarding the season of planting as an interruption.

But growth rarely happens by announcement.

It happens through ordinary repetition. It happens while the person is still learning. It happens while the work is still close enough to reveal the needs of real people. It happens before there is a public explanation for why the person has been asked to continue.

Then, sometimes, the door opens.

When it does, the opening can seem sudden even if the preparation was long. Other people may call it an overnight change. They may speak of a new position as though the person entered it from nowhere. They may not know what came before because the earlier work took place outside their view.

This is why appreciation must be more observant than public recognition.

Public recognition usually arrives after the value has become difficult to deny. Appreciation can arrive when value is still easy to overlook. Recognition announces that a person has become significant. Appreciation helps us honour the significance that was already there.

Ronald Balimwezo publicly thanked Bobi Wine for “believing in me and giving me a chance.” Those words matter because they identify something that achievement can tempt us to forget. A person may have ability and still need a chance. A person may have served faithfully and still need someone to make room for that service to reach farther.

The chance does not cancel the person’s work.

Nor does the person’s work cancel the importance of the chance.

We sometimes choose one side because we are uncomfortable with dependence. We want to say that a person succeeded entirely by personal effort, or entirely because someone else helped them. Real lives are rarely that simple. Balimwezo’s years of service mattered. So did the platform through which a wider opportunity became possible. The door and the person both matter.

This is a humbling truth for those of us who want to be self-made.

No one is entirely self-made. We all stand inside opportunities we did not create alone. We inherit language, instruction, trust, access, courage, and examples. We benefit from decisions made before we understood their consequences. We receive doors whose builders may not know our names.

Acknowledging this does not diminish our labour. It places our labour inside reality.

Ronald Balimwezo did not need Bobi Wine to be capable. He needed a door through which his capability could serve a wider public. Bobi Wine could not have carried Balimwezo through the door, either. The one who opens an opportunity cannot walk

another person’s path for them. A door is not a destination. Someone must still choose to enter, accept the work, and carry the responsibility on the other side.

This is where opportunity becomes obedience again.

The opening of a door does not remove the need for courage. It creates a new place in which courage must be practiced. A person may wait for years for a larger assignment and then discover that the assignment asks for a different kind of faithfulness than the waiting did.

Waiting requires trust.

Walking through requires trust too.

The waiting person must trust God when the opportunity is absent. The newly appointed person must trust God when the opportunity is present and its weight can no longer be imagined from a distance. Both seasons require humility because neither is fully controlled by the person living it.

Perhaps this is why appreciation is essential at the moment of transition. When someone enters a new responsibility, the natural response is to focus on what they must now accomplish. We may forget to acknowledge the path that brought them there. We may offer advice before offering gratitude. We may ask what they will do next without saying that their years of service were seen.

A person should not have to become Lord Mayor before someone tells them that their years of service mattered.

The larger door may open in public, but preparation usually happens in ordinary rooms. The announcement is visible. The formation is not. The swearing-in can be recorded. The years of endurance often cannot.

That should shape the way we interpret our own transitions.

If a door opens for you, receive it with gratitude rather than vanity. You did not create every condition that made it possible. If a door has not opened, do not assume that your current work is beneath God's attention. You may still be carrying a responsibility that matters deeply where you are. If another person's door opens, do not reduce their opportunity to luck or reduce your own life to failure.

Their opening is not your rejection.

A door can open for someone else without proving that God has forgotten you. We need this reminder because comparison turns another person's blessing into an accusation against our own lives. We look at the new office, the new recognition, the new influence, and hear a voice saying that we have been left behind.

But God is not limited to one door.

The door that opened for Balimwezo did not close the possibility of God working through anyone else. His story is not a promise that every faithful person will receive the same office. It is an invitation to notice how preparation, opportunity, and the courage of others can meet in a life.

The deeper lesson is not about attaining a particular position. It is about becoming able to receive the responsibility that belongs to our calling, whatever form that calling takes.

For one person, that may mean a citywide public office. For another, it may mean serving a family through a difficult season. For another, it may mean teaching, building, organizing, listening, or remaining present in a place where no one outside the community will ever know what was accomplished.

The size of the door is not the measure of God's love.

Neither is the size of the audience.

Balimwezo's rise helps us see what happens when a life of sustained service meets an opportunity created through someone else's earlier decision. The moment is public, but the pattern is spiritual. God often prepares people in places where their preparation cannot yet be named. He often uses one person's obedience to create room for another person's gifts. And He asks us to appreciate people before the final result gives us permission to do so.

When the door finally opens, we may be surprised by how many hands are connected to it.

Some belonged to the person who made the first decision. Some belonged to the communities that received years of service. Some belonged to the people who offered trust. Some belonged to the person who kept preparing without knowing whether the preparation would ever be recognized.

The visible moment belongs to a longer story.

So if your door is opening, remember the unseen years. Remember the people who made room. Thank them while you can. If your door has not opened, remember that hidden preparation is still preparation. Keep serving honestly, but do not turn waiting into an excuse for refusing to grow. And if you are standing beside someone whose ability has not yet found its larger platform, do not wait for the crowd to teach you how to see them.

Your appreciation may not open every door.

But it may help someone believe they are allowed to walk through the one God places before them.

When someone near you receives a larger opportunity, will you celebrate only the visible moment, or will you honour the hidden years that made them ready to carry it?

CHAPTER 5

The Obedience You Cannot Own



We like to believe that obedience belongs entirely to the person who obeys.

Someone makes the brave decision. Someone accepts the cost. Someone takes the risk. Someone steps forward when others remain uncertain. We honour that person, and rightly so. The choice was theirs. The burden was theirs. The courage was theirs to practice.

But obedience does not always remain inside the life that offers it.

A decision can travel. It can create space. It can prepare an opportunity. It can become useful to people who were not present when it was made and were not considered when the decision-maker first stepped forward.

That is one of the mysteries in Ronald Balimwezo's story.

Balimwezo had his own history of service. He is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He entered local government in 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Those facts describe a life of work and a later opportunity. They do not, by themselves, explain the whole doorway through which the opportunity came.

For that, we must look to a different story. In 2017, Bobi Wine entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election. He then built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. His decision belonged to his own public journey. It was not made as a plan for Balimwezo. Yet the platform that grew from it later became connected to Balimwezo's rise to the Lord Mayorship of Kampala.

One man obeyed a step he could see. Another man later received an opening the first man could not have mapped in advance.

*Obedience is not a possession; it is a gift that may keep travelling
after we release it.*

This challenges our desire to control the meaning of what we do.

We want to know who benefited. We want to measure the results. We want to receive the thank-you and hear the explanation. We want our sacrifice to remain attached to our name. If the work becomes fruitful, we want to stand near the fruit and make sure everyone knows which seed we planted.

There is nothing wrong with receiving gratitude. Gratitude is good. Recognition can be just. People should not be erased from the stories they helped make possible.

But there is a difference between being properly acknowledged and needing to own the entire outcome.

God may use our obedience beyond our ability to supervise it.

This is good news for people who feel insignificant. Your decision does not have to produce a result that is visible to you before it has value. You may never know who was helped by the work you did. You may never receive a report explaining the connection between your faithfulness and another person's opportunity. The absence of evidence is not the same as the absence of influence.

It is also a warning for people who are visible. Influence can tempt us to believe that every later achievement belongs to us. If we helped create a platform, we may begin to treat the people who use it as extensions of our own story. If we opened a door, we may expect those who enter to remain permanently grateful, permanently dependent, and permanently identified with us.

That is not a door. It is a cage.

A healthy act of obedience creates room for another person to become responsible for their own calling. Bobi Wine's decision and the platform he built became part of a path Balimwezo could walk, but Balimwezo still had to carry his own life and service. No one else could substitute for his years in local government, his work as an engineer and lecturer, or the responsibility of becoming Lord Mayor.

One person can open a door. Another person must still walk through it.

This is why we should resist two opposite errors. The first is the error of self-sufficiency, which says, "I reached this place alone." The second is the error of dependency, which says, "Because someone helped me, I can never stand in my own responsibility." Both errors misunderstand grace.

Grace acknowledges the help we received and calls us to use it faithfully.

Balimwezo's public thanks to Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance" expresses this balance. The words honour the person who opened an opportunity. They also imply that the opportunity was received by someone who had to do something with it. Being given a chance is not the same as being given the finished result.

There is humility in saying thank you.

There is also strength in accepting the responsibility that follows.

Many of us have received doors we did not build. A teacher made room for us. A friend spoke our name in a room we could not enter. A parent endured hardship that gave us options. A community trusted us before our work was proven. Someone shared

knowledge, offered correction, or simply refused to dismiss us when we were still uncertain.

Sometimes the door came through a person's public decision. More often, it came through an ordinary act that looked too small to become part of a life story.

We may not know which of our own choices will become such a door for someone else.

This is why the language of calling must be connected to the language of community. We are not called in isolation. Even when the burden feels personal, the consequences may not be. A person may obey God for reasons that are deeply inward and still produce outward room for others.

Bobi Wine did not enter politics as a way of making Ronald Balimwezo Lord Mayor. The facts do not permit us to claim that. The later connection is more surprising precisely because the original decision was not made with that outcome in view.

God does not need us to understand the whole chain before He can use one link.

This protects us from discouragement when our motives are misunderstood. People may not see why you are making a decision. They may think your step is too costly, too uncertain, or unrelated to their needs. They may be right that you cannot predict the result. But the inability to predict the future does not make the present decision meaningless.

At the same time, we must remain humble enough to test our motives. Not every strong desire is obedience. Not every public act is courageous. Not every sacrifice should be

admired merely because it is expensive. A faith-rooted life requires honesty, patience, and the willingness to distinguish between self-promotion and service.

The story before us does not tell us to imitate another person's exact decision. It asks us to notice a pattern: one person's entrance into a new public role helped create a platform that later served another person's path. That pattern is enough to make us ask what our own decisions are making possible.

Who might receive courage because you remained faithful?

Who might find a platform because you were willing to build one?

Who might be seen because you refused to look away?

The answer may not be someone who resembles you. Balimwezo's work as an engineer, lecturer, and local government servant was different from Bobi Wine's work as a musician who entered politics. Their backgrounds and roles were not the same. Yet their stories became connected through an opportunity that crossed those differences.

This is another reason not to limit the usefulness of our obedience to people who share our profession, personality, or circumstances. God can carry a gift across boundaries we would not think to cross. The person helped by your work may be in another field. The person who benefits from your courage may be younger or older, richer or poorer, more visible or less known. They may never be able to repay you in the form you expect.

Their difference from you does not make the connection less real.

Appreciation helps us live this truth with grace. We can thank the builders of doors without worshipping them. We can honour the people who gave us opportunities without pretending they are the source of every gift in our lives. We can acknowledge the human hands involved while recognizing that no human being sees the entire story.

This balance is especially important when success arrives.

Success can make us forget the uncertainty that came before it. Once Balimwezo had won the Lord Mayor race in January 2026 and been sworn in

during May 2026, it would have been easy for observers to speak as though the outcome had always been guaranteed. But a public result does not remove the uncertainty of the years that preceded it. Nor does it make the platform that carried the opportunity irrelevant.

A result should produce gratitude, not amnesia.

Remember the people. Remember the places. Remember the time. Remember the decisions you did not make alone. Remember that ability and opportunity are related but not identical. A person may be prepared and still need a door. A person may build a door and never know who will eventually use it.

This remembrance can keep achievement from becoming pride.

It can also keep waiting from becoming despair.

If your own door has not opened, you may still be helping to build one for another person. That possibility does not mean you should ignore your own needs or remain in a harmful situation. It does mean that the value of your current work is not limited to

the future benefit you will personally receive. Some of what God is doing through you may be intended for people you will never meet.

That can feel unfair if we think life must reward us in proportion to what we give. It can feel beautiful if we begin to see service as participation rather than ownership.

We are invited to participate in work whose full harvest belongs to God.

The person who plants does not control the weather. The person who builds does not decide every visitor. The person who opens a door does not determine every life that passes through it. Our responsibility is to act with integrity, courage, and love. The future remains larger than our hands.

This should make us more careful with the doors we build.

Will the opportunity you create leave room for another person's responsibility? Will the platform you establish serve people rather than merely magnify your name? Will you appreciate those who use it, or will you resent them for becoming visible through something you began? Will you be

able to say, "I am grateful that this helped," even when the final story no longer centres on you?

These are not easy questions.

They touch our pride because they ask whether we can rejoice in fruit we do not own. They touch our fear because they ask whether we can trust God with consequences we cannot manage. They touch our loneliness because obedience can feel like an act performed without witnesses.

But the witness is not absent.

The God who sees the first step also sees the later traveller. He sees the decision made in uncertainty, the years spent in preparation, the chance received with gratitude, and the responsibility carried after the door opens. He sees how one person's obedience and another person's faithfulness can meet without either person controlling the whole story.

The door is not the glory.

The glory belongs to the God who can use a decision beyond the limits of its maker's understanding.

So let us make our choices with humility. Let us accept opportunities without pretending we created every condition that made them possible. Let us thank the people who believed in us. Let us appreciate those still preparing in places the world considers small. And let us release our obedience to God without demanding that He show us the complete outcome before we take the next faithful step.

One day, someone may thank you for a door you did not know you were building.

When that day comes, receive the gratitude with humility. Then remember that the door was never yours to own. You were entrusted with the building. God remained responsible for the lives that would pass through.

What good work are you tempted to abandon because you cannot yet see who it may help?

CHAPTER 6

The Person Beside You



We have spent these pages looking at a door.

Not only the door that led Ronald Balimwezo to the Lord Mayorship of Kampala, but the kind of door that changes the meaning of a life without being built by that life alone. We have looked at years of service, a decision made somewhere else, a platform that grew beyond its beginning, and an opportunity that eventually met a person who had been preparing without knowing exactly what the preparation was for.

Now the story must turn toward us.

A story can be admired without being obeyed. We can read about another person's faithfulness, underline the memorable lines, and continue living exactly as we lived before. We can agree that God works through people and still fail to notice the people He has placed beside us.

The lesson is not complete until it changes our attention.

Ronald Balimwezo's story gives us a public example. He is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He has been in local government since 2006. He served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The public record also includes his thanks to Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance." That sentence gathers much of the story into a few words. It recognizes ability, but it also recognizes opportunity. It honours years of work, but it also honours the person who helped make a wider opening possible.

A chance matters.

So does the person who receives it.

You may be standing beside the person whose door is about to open.

We do not know who that person is.

That uncertainty is not a problem to solve. It is a reason to practice humility. If we knew in advance which people would become influential, we would have no trouble appreciating them. We would be attentive because attention would seem profitable. We would offer encouragement because we would already know the encouragement would be attached to a significant future.

But God does not give us that list.

He asks us to appreciate people before we know what their lives will become.

This is harder than it sounds. We are drawn to visible potential. We notice the person who speaks well, performs well, or already receives approval from others. We are less patient with the person whose gift is still developing. We overlook the quiet worker because their contribution does not announce itself. We assume that the person with no public title has no public significance.

That assumption is dangerous.

The people who change a community may not begin with the kind of life we know how to celebrate. They may begin as engineers, lecturers, singers, comedians, journalists, parents, students, or neighbours. Their current work may not resemble their future responsibility. They may not even imagine that a wider assignment is possible.

The point is not that everyone is destined for public office. The point is that no one's significance can be measured completely by their current visibility.

This should affect the way we speak.

Words can close a door before a person ever reaches it. Contempt can make a gift feel foolish. Constant criticism can train someone to hide. Indifference can communicate that their effort is not worth continuing. We may never intend to crush another person, but neglect has consequences too.

The opposite is also true.

A word of appreciation can strengthen what is still fragile. A person who is believed in may become more willing to take responsibility. A person who is given a chance may discover that their preparation was not wasted. Encouragement does not replace discipline, and it does not guarantee success. But it can help someone remain present long enough for their ability to find its proper place.

Bobi Wine's role in this story began with his own decision to enter politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and to build the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. Ronald Balimwezo's later opportunity came through a platform that did not exist in the same form before that decision. Neither man could have seen the entire chain at the beginning.

That is the kind of uncertainty in which appreciation must operate.

We appreciate without knowing.

We honour without possessing proof.

We believe that a person matters because they bear dignity, not because they have already demonstrated usefulness to us. This is not sentimental. It is a disciplined way of seeing. It refuses to turn human beings into investments whose value depends on their future returns.

Someone can deserve appreciation even if they never become famous.

Someone can deserve appreciation because they kept serving in a small place. Someone can deserve appreciation because they made a difficult task lighter for others. Someone can deserve appreciation because they are learning, trying, repairing, or remaining present. The Lord Mayor's office is not the standard by which every life must be judged.

Balimwezo's story is not a promise that your years of faithfulness will end in the same kind of public recognition. It is not a formula that says small service always leads to a larger title. We should not reduce God's work to a reward system in which every hidden sacrifice eventually becomes visible in the way we hoped.

Some doors open differently.

Some doors lead to public responsibility. Some lead to reconciliation. Some lead to a new way of serving people who have always been near us. Some open inwardly, changing the person before changing their circumstances. Some may not open during our lifetime in a way we can measure.

Faith is not a contract promising that every good act will produce a visible promotion.

Faith is trust that our obedience is not meaningless, even when the outcome remains beyond our view.

That is why the question of appreciation cannot be postponed until the future is clear. If we wait until a person's importance is undeniable, we are no longer practicing the kind of recognition this story calls us toward. We are simply agreeing with the crowd after the crowd has already decided.

True appreciation often arrives earlier.

It notices the civil engineer before the citywide office. It notices the lecturer before the public recognition. It notices the local government servant while the work is still local. It notices the person whose current assignment is real, even if it does not yet look like a beginning.

Look around your own life.

Who do you see every day without truly seeing them? Who has become so dependable that you have mistaken dependability for endless capacity? Who do you contact only when you need something? Who has been serving in a role that no longer attracts anyone's attention?

Do not answer too quickly.

The easiest names to identify are often the people who are already receiving appreciation. The harder work is to notice the person who has been normalized by your familiarity. We become used to the people who carry weight. We call them strong and then stop asking whether they are tired. We call them gifted and then stop encouraging them to grow. We call them loyal and then assume they will always remain available.

Appreciation must be specific.

Do not say only, "You are doing well." Say what you have seen. Name the patience. Name the care. Name the consistency. Name the way the person made room for others. General praise can be pleasant, but specific gratitude tells someone that their life has not passed unnoticed.

And do not make your appreciation conditional on future success.

Tell the person what their service means now. Not because you know they will become important later, but because they are already worthy of honour. If a larger door opens, be grateful. If it does not open in the way you expected, the appreciation will still have been true.

This is where the story becomes personal.

Perhaps you are the unnoticed person. Perhaps you have spent years doing work that others rely on but rarely mention. Perhaps you have begun to wonder whether your preparation is going anywhere. You may be tempted to measure your life by the doors that have not opened.

Remember Ronald Balimwezo's long path through local government. Remember that the public moment came after years of service. Remember that the person who eventually walks through a larger door may not know what the earlier years are preparing them for.

But also remember this: your worth is not waiting on a title.

A later office may enlarge your responsibility, but it cannot create your dignity. Recognition may widen your platform, but it cannot be the source of your value. If you are serving honestly, the work matters where you are.

Do not despise your current place because it is not yet your imagined future.

At the same time, do not use humility as a reason to hide from a door when it opens. There is a false modesty that sounds spiritual but is really fear. It says, "I am only a small person," when what God is asking is not self-contempt but responsible courage. When the opportunity comes, receive it with gratitude. Remember the people who helped you. Then do the work.

A door is an invitation, not a guarantee.

Someone must still walk through it. Someone must still learn the new responsibilities. Someone must still serve the people on the other side. Someone must still remain humble when visibility increases.

This is why the story does not end with Balimwezo becoming Lord Mayor. The title is important, but it is not the final teaching. The final teaching is what the title allows us to see: a person can prepare quietly; another person can create an opening without knowing who will benefit; appreciation can connect the two; and God can use the whole pattern for purposes no individual controls.

The person beside you may need one of those things from you.

They may need appreciation. They may need permission to try. They may need you to stop defining them by their present limits. They may need you to celebrate their small responsibility instead of asking why they have not achieved something larger. They may need the dignity of being seen without being turned into a project.

You may need the same from them.

We are all, at different times, the builder and the traveller. We benefit from doors we did not build, and we build doors whose travellers we may never meet. We are prepared in hidden places, and we are asked to notice preparation in others. We receive chances, and we are given chances to make room.

No one stands outside this pattern.

That is why appreciation is not a decorative virtue. It is a form of participation in God's work. When we appreciate a person, we are not claiming to know their future. We are agreeing to honour what is already present. We are refusing to wait for public confirmation before we practice love.

The world often teaches us to value people after they have proved their usefulness. The gospel teaches us to see people before the proof is complete.

This kind of seeing may make us look foolish at times. We may encourage someone who does not become what we imagined. We may invest attention in a person whose path remains ordinary. We may celebrate a gift that never becomes public.

That does not make the appreciation wasted.

Love is not wasted because it cannot be converted into a headline.

A person is not a failed investment because their future did not resemble our expectations. We are not called to predict people perfectly. We are called to treat them faithfully. The God who prepares people also knows what He is doing with lives that remain hidden from our understanding.

So let the story of Ronald Balimwezo send you back into your own ordinary places with clearer eyes.

Look at the person in your home. Look at the person in your workplace. Look at the person serving in your church, neighbourhood, classroom, or community. Look at the person whose work has become background noise because they have done it faithfully for so long.

Then ask God to help you see them before the world names them.

Perhaps the person beside you will never become a mayor. Perhaps they will never hold a public office. Perhaps the door God opens for them will be known only to a few people. It will still matter. Their life will still matter. Your appreciation will still matter.

And perhaps one day you will discover that your words helped them remain faithful long enough to walk through a door you could not see.

That is enough reason to speak.

God works through people. He works through decisions, platforms, opportunities, and years that seem ordinary while they are happening. He works through the builder and the traveller. He works through the person who receives a chance and the person who has the courage to give one.

Most of all, He asks us to remember that we cannot see in advance who He is preparing to use.

Therefore, appreciate the person next to you now.

Do not wait for proof of their significance. Do not wait for the public announcement. Do not wait until their name appears in a place where everyone else can see it. The opportunity you help create may be part of God's answer to a need you cannot yet identify.

And if you are the one still waiting, still serving, still wondering whether anyone sees, remember this: your hidden years are not invisible to God. The door may open in a way you cannot predict. Until then, the work in front of you is still worthy of care.

The person beside you may be carrying a future you cannot recognize.

Treat them accordingly.

Whose future might your appreciation help protect, strengthen, or release, and what will you say to that person today?

CHAPTER 7

Appreciation Before Proof



Most appreciation arrives late.

It comes after the difficult season has ended. It comes after the appointment, the award, the promotion, the election, the recovery, or the public success. Once the outcome is visible, we become generous with our words. We say we always knew the person had it in them. We tell them that their faithfulness was obvious. We speak as though we had been standing beside them with clear understanding from the beginning.

Sometimes we were.

Often we were not.

There is a difference between appreciating a person before the proof and congratulating them after the proof. Both have value, but they require different kinds of vision. Congratulations responds to an outcome.

Appreciation recognizes a person while the outcome is still uncertain.

The story of Ronald Balimwezo invites us to practice the second kind.

He served in local government from 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he was mayor of Nakawa Division. He worked as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and he was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Those later facts make it easy to notice him. They give the wider public a clear reason to pay attention. But his value did not begin when the larger office became visible. The years of service were not important only because they led to a title. They mattered while they were being lived.

Appreciation sees what recognition is still waiting to discover.

This is not a small distinction.

When we appreciate only after success, we train ourselves to follow the crowd. We wait for someone else to identify the worthy person. We watch for public confirmation, then add our agreement. We may call this wisdom, but sometimes it is simply caution without courage.

It is safer to praise someone after everyone else has praised them.

No one can accuse us of seeing badly. No one can ask why we supported a person whose future was not yet certain. No one can say that our encouragement was misplaced because the outcome has already defended it.

But faith does not always ask us to be safe.

It asks us to see carefully.

Careful seeing is not the same as making grand predictions. We do not need to declare that a person will become famous. We do not need to announce that someone is destined for a particular office. We do not need to turn appreciation into prophecy.

We can simply tell the truth about what we see now.

"You have served this community faithfully."

“Your work has made this responsibility lighter for others.”

“I have noticed the care you bring to this task.”

“Thank you for continuing when no one was watching.”

These statements do not claim to know the future. They honour the present.

That is the kind of appreciation many people need.

We may think people need predictions, but often they need recognition of what is already in front of us. The teacher does not need us to guarantee a future career. The parent does not need us to promise that every sacrifice will produce a particular result. The servant does not need us to say that a larger door will certainly open.

They may simply need to know that their present faithfulness is not invisible.

Ronald Balimwezo publicly thanked Bobi Wine for “believing in me and giving me a chance.” That sentence does not erase Balimwezo’s own years of work. It does show the importance of being believed in before a larger opportunity is secure. A chance is not the same as proof. Someone must often be trusted while the full result remains unknown.

This is where appreciation becomes active.

It does not merely describe value. It can help protect a person’s willingness to keep offering it. When someone knows that their work is seen, they may find strength to continue. When someone receives a chance, they may become more willing to accept responsibility. When someone is treated as though their current life matters, they may stop waiting for permission to take their own service seriously.

We must be careful not to exaggerate what encouragement can do. A kind word cannot remove every barrier. Appreciation cannot guarantee an appointment, an election, or a successful outcome. It cannot carry another person’s responsibilities for them. It should

not be used as a substitute for justice, practical support, honest correction, or real opportunity.

Still, words matter.

So does the absence of words.

A person can begin to doubt what they carry when every contribution is treated as ordinary in the dismissive sense. There is a healthy ordinariness in daily work, but there is also a careless ordinariness that says, “Anyone could do this, and it does not matter that you are the one doing it.” That kind of dismissal can become a quiet wound.

We do not always know what another person is carrying while they serve.

The rules governing this story ask us not to invent private thoughts or motives. We cannot claim to know exactly what Ronald Balimwezo felt during his years in local government. We can say that his service continued across a long period and that his later public recognition did not create the earlier work.

That is enough to remind us that endurance deserves attention.

We should also remember that appreciation is not reserved for people whose work resembles our own. Balimwezo’s path included engineering, lecturing, and local government. The person beside you may serve through music, administration, caregiving, technical work, public speaking, manual labour, or quiet reliability. The form of the gift may be unfamiliar to you.

Do not let unfamiliarity become contempt.

We often appreciate what we understand. We honour the work we can measure. We notice outcomes that resemble our own definition of success. If someone’s gift is expressed differently, we may miss it entirely. A person can be deeply effective in a language we do not speak.

Appreciation requires curiosity.

What is this person carrying? What problem are they helping to solve? What kind of patience does their work require? Who is safer, stronger, better taught, or more hopeful because they keep doing it?

These questions slow us down. They keep us from reducing people to their job titles or public visibility. They also help us see the connection between present service and future opportunity without treating the future

as the only thing that matters.

A civil engineer may become a Lord Mayor. A lecturer may carry lessons into public responsibility. A local government servant may receive a citywide platform. But the later role does not tell us that every earlier task had to be impressive. It tells us that a person's potential may exceed the way we currently see them.

The same may be true of the person you have already placed in a category.

You may know them as the quiet one. The difficult one. The new one. The person who has never been given a chance. The person whose work is useful but invisible. The person who is still learning. The person who does not resemble the leaders you have been taught to recognize.

Categories can help us organize information. They become dangerous when they become verdicts.

No category can tell you the whole story of a human being.

This is why the central message returns to appreciation. We cannot see in advance who God is preparing to use. We may be standing next to someone whose influence will grow. We may also be standing next to someone whose influence will remain quiet but deeply important. Either way, our responsibility is the same: to see them with dignity and to refuse to dismiss what we have not yet learned how to measure.

The public story of Balimwezo's rise includes a platform built through Bobi Wine's earlier political decision. That connection reminds us that opportunity often depends on more than individual ability. People need rooms in which to serve. They need structures that allow their gifts to reach others. They need someone to believe that their contribution belongs in the room.

We cannot create every room. We can make the rooms we occupy more hospitable.

We can stop treating appreciation as a scarce resource. Some people act as though another person's recognition diminishes their own. They withhold praise because they fear that naming another person's strength will make them look weaker. They turn every relationship into a competition for

attention.

But honour is not a limited substance.

Your appreciation does not make you smaller. It makes your vision larger. It frees you from the exhausting need to be the only person whose work matters. It allows you to rejoice when another person's gift becomes visible, even if the visibility does not benefit you directly.

This is a spiritual discipline because pride prefers delayed appreciation.

Pride says, "Let them prove themselves first."

Humility says, "I will pay attention to what is already true."

Pride says, "If they become important, I will support them."

Humility says, "I will honour them as a person before their importance is known."

Pride says, "If I help them, I should control the outcome."

Humility says, "I can make room without owning what God does with their life."

These are not merely private attitudes. They shape communities. A community that appreciates only visible success becomes harsh toward beginners. It pushes people to perform significance instead of growing in character. It makes every small assignment feel like a test that must produce a public result.

A community that appreciates faithfully can become a place where people are allowed to develop.

It can tell the truth without humiliation. It can offer correction without contempt. It can recognize progress without pretending that progress is completion. It can celebrate service without demanding that service become a spectacle.

That kind of community may open doors we cannot predict.

Perhaps the person you appreciate will one day carry a wider responsibility. Perhaps they will not. The appreciation remains worth giving because it was not a bargain. You were not purchasing a future outcome. You

were practising the truth that the person matters now.

This protects us from disappointment.

If our encouragement depends on a person becoming what we expected, then we were not truly appreciating them. We were investing in an imagined version of their future. When they take another path, we may feel betrayed because we confused their life with our plan for it.

God does not ask us to manage people into significance.

He asks us to love them faithfully.

That includes appreciating what is good, challenging what is harmful, and respecting the mystery of what each life may become. We can believe in someone without claiming them. We can give a chance without demanding permanent dependence. We can honour a person's gifts without making them responsible for fulfilling our hopes.

The person beside you is not your project.

They are your neighbour.

Treating them as a neighbour means paying attention. It means saying thank you while the work is still ordinary. It means refusing to wait for a public title before you offer respect. It means remembering that the Lord Mayor was once also a person whose service was connected to a smaller place and a longer season of preparation.

The wider world may have learned to see Balimwezo differently after January and May 2026. But God did not need those dates to discover him.

Neither should we need a date, title, or public result before we learn to appreciate the people in front of us.

Begin with one person.

Name one faithful thing they have done. Say it without exaggeration. Say it without attaching a demand. Let the appreciation stand on its own.

You may not know what it will mean to them. You may not know whether it will change anything. You may never hear what happened after you spoke.

Speak anyway.

The future is not yours to predict. The present is yours to honour.

Whom have you been waiting to appreciate until they prove their significance, and what true thing about their present service can you name today?

CHAPTER 8

Prepared in a Place You Cannot Explain



Some seasons make sense only after they are over.

While we are living through them, they seem disconnected from the life we hoped to have. The work feels too small. The delay feels too long. The place feels too narrow. We cannot see how the present task could possibly prepare us for anything beyond itself.

So we begin to call the season a mistake.

We assume that if the future were important, the preparation would be more obvious. We expect the path to announce its destination. We want each step to explain the next one. When it does not, we become suspicious of the journey and sometimes suspicious of God.

Ronald Balimwezo's story asks us to consider another possibility: that preparation can be real before it is understandable.

Balimwezo is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He entered local government in 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The later office was citywide. Much of the earlier service was connected to one division. The final responsibility was more visible than the beginning. The wider platform could make the earlier years appear like a path that had been designed from the start.

But preparation does not have to feel like a map.

A season can be preparing you even when it does not resemble your future.

This is difficult because we often judge the present by the future we want. If we hope to lead, we want every current task to look like leadership. If we hope to teach, we want every responsibility to look like teaching. If we hope to serve a large community, we become impatient with the small community already in front of us.

We are tempted to say, "This is not what I am meant for."

Sometimes that statement is wise. A person can remain in the wrong place out of fear. A person can confuse endurance with obedience. A person can stay where they are not called because leaving would require an uncomfortable act of faith.

But sometimes the statement is simply impatience speaking.

We do not know enough about the future to judge every present responsibility by its immediate resemblance to our dreams. The engineer may learn to carry public responsibility through work that appears technical. The lecturer may develop patience through teaching that seems separate from public leadership. The local government servant may learn the texture

of community needs in a setting that seems too limited to matter.

We should not claim that every task was specifically designed as a secret lesson for a later office. That would go beyond what the public facts allow. We can say that long service gives a person experience of responsibility, and that such experience may become useful when a wider opportunity appears.

Usefulness is not the same as certainty.

A season may prepare us without guaranteeing a particular outcome. We must hold that distinction carefully. Otherwise, we turn faith into a promise that our preferred future will arrive if we endure long enough. When it does not, we may conclude that God failed or that our service was wasted.

The truth is more spacious.

Your present work can matter even if it never leads to the title you imagined. Your preparation can be real even if the next door opens somewhere different from the one you expected. God can form character, wisdom, compassion, and steadiness without giving you the specific platform you once pictured.

Balimwezo's later office does not make every local government servant a future Lord Mayor. It shows that a person's current scale does not always reveal the full range of responsibility they may later carry.

That should make us slower to dismiss people.

We often decide that someone is ordinary because their current assignment is ordinary. We see the role and assume it defines the person. We see the present limitation and make it a permanent description. We forget that we are looking at a season, not a complete life.

A person may be more prepared than their opportunity suggests.

They may be ready to contribute more than anyone has asked of them. They may have developed skills in one field that become valuable in another. They may have learned how to listen, organize, explain, build, or remain calm in situations that do not yet resemble their future work.

This is why we need appreciation with imagination.

Not fantasy. Not exaggerated praise. Imagination means allowing that a person is larger than the role we currently see. It means recognizing present faithfulness without

insisting that we know exactly where it will lead. It means leaving room for God to surprise us.

Bobi Wine's political decision provides another picture of this hiddenness. In 2017, he entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election and later built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. That platform eventually became part of the path through which Balimwezo won the Kampala Lord Mayor race in January 2026.

The platform itself was built over time. Its later use could not have been fully visible at its beginning. One decision became a movement, and that movement became an opportunity through which other lives could be changed.

A person may be building something whose most important use is still ahead.

This can be true of institutions, friendships, habits, and communities. It can be true of the work we do in our own homes. We may be creating a culture of honesty that will help someone make a difficult decision years later. We may be modelling service that a younger person will carry into a different field. We may be establishing a place of welcome for someone who has not yet arrived.

We may never know.

The hiddenness can be frustrating because we want to feel effective. We want to be able to point to a result and say, "There. That is why I did it." But much of what matters cannot be traced so neatly. A life is not a spreadsheet in which every input produces a visible and immediate output.

Some work becomes part of another person's courage.

Some service becomes part of another person's competence.

Some appreciation becomes part of another person's decision to remain faithful.

The connection may be real even when it cannot be documented in a way that satisfies our desire for proof.

This is where faith becomes more than optimism. Optimism expects that things will probably turn out well. Faith can remain obedient without knowing how the story will turn out. It does not deny disappointment. It does not call every delay good. It simply refuses to believe that hidden means meaningless.

We need that refusal in seasons of obscurity.

Perhaps you are serving in a role that does not use all you believe you carry. Perhaps you have been known by one responsibility for so long that others cannot imagine you doing anything else. Perhaps you are competent in a room that has become too familiar, yet you cannot see a way into a wider one.

Do not despise the room.

Learn from it. Serve the people in it. Pay attention to what the work is teaching you. Ask what kind of person you are becoming while you wait. The purpose of preparation is not merely to collect skills. It is to shape the manner in which those skills will be used.

A person can be gifted and still need formation.

A person can be intelligent and still need patience. A person can be ambitious and still need humility. A person can be ready for a position in one sense and unready for its weight in another. The hidden season often deals with the part of us that would rather be admired than made trustworthy.

We should not assume that a larger door is always a reward for surviving a smaller place. Sometimes it is an invitation to greater service. Sometimes it reveals areas where we still need to grow. Sometimes it exposes motives that were easy to hide when few people were watching.

Preparation is not only God making us capable.

It is also God teaching us what capability is for.

This matters because public responsibility can magnify both strengths and weaknesses. A person who has learned to listen may serve many people

well. A person who has learned only to seek attention may discover that a larger platform cannot satisfy them. A person who has practiced responsibility in a smaller setting may understand that leadership is not mainly about being seen.

Again, we should not invent private conclusions about Balimwezo's character or motives. We can observe the sequence of public facts without pretending to know every internal lesson. His years in local government preceded his 2026 win and May swearing-in. That sequence is enough to show why hidden preparation deserves our attention.

It also gives us a responsibility toward people who are still in it.

When someone is learning, do not mock the unfinished work. When someone is serving faithfully in a small place, do not treat the place as proof of their smallness. When someone's ability is developing, do not make a permanent judgment from a temporary weakness.

Correction may be needed. Accountability may be necessary. Respect does not require us to pretend that every performance is excellent. But correction and contempt are not the same. A person can be told the truth without being told that they are incapable of becoming more.

Appreciation creates room for growth because it tells the truth about what is already present.

"You are not finished, but I can see your faithfulness."

"You have more to learn, but your effort is real."

"This work is still small, but it matters to the people receiving it."

"You do not need to prove your entire future today."

These are not excuses for stagnation. They are words that protect a person from the lie that they must already be complete before they are worthy of encouragement.

God does not prepare finished people.

He prepares willing people, teachable people, persistent people, people who are still being formed. If we demand perfection before we appreciate anyone, we will appreciate no one honestly, not even ourselves.

The same grace applies to our own hidden years.

We may look back and wish we had understood more. We may regret time spent in places that did not lead to the outcome we desired. We may feel embarrassed that we once believed a door would open and it did not. We may compare our preparation with another person's opportunity and decide that God has been more generous to them.

Comparison makes poor theology.

We do not know the whole cost of another person's path. We do not know the hidden work behind their visible opportunity. We do not know what God is forming in us through a route that looks slower. We should not treat another person's door as evidence that our own life has been mismanaged.

The door that opened for Balimwezo was connected to Bobi Wine's earlier decision, but Balimwezo still had his own responsibility. His story was not copied from someone else's. It emerged through a particular combination of service, timing, opportunity, and courage.

Your life will have its own combination.

You cannot force it by imitating the visible details of another person's story. You can prepare by becoming faithful with what is in your hands. You can make room for others. You can appreciate the people whose gifts are still emerging. You can refuse to make premature judgments about yourself or anyone else.

The future may explain some things.

It will not explain everything.

We must learn to live with a measure of holy uncertainty. God can use what we understand, but He is not limited to what we understand. A decision can have consequences beyond its original intention. A season can form us without telling us its name. A person can be preparing for a responsibility they cannot yet imagine.

That is not a reason to become passive. It is a reason to become attentive.

Attend to the work. Attend to the people. Attend to the lessons you keep meeting. Attend to the opportunities to encourage someone who has not yet

been publicly confirmed. Attend to the places where pride makes you dismiss what is small.

The person beside you may be in a season they cannot explain.

Do not add to their confusion by making their present role a verdict on their future. Do not promise them a particular outcome. Do not use spiritual language to manipulate them into endless service. Simply tell the truth about what you see and help them carry today with dignity.

That may be the door they need.

Not a dramatic platform. Not a guaranteed promotion. Not a prediction. Just the recognition that their present life is worth faithful attention and that their future belongs to God.

Years later, when a larger opportunity appears, they may understand some of what the earlier season was carrying. Or they may not. Either way, the work was not wasted. The person was not forgotten. The preparation was not invalidated by the fact that its purpose remained hidden.

A season can be holy before it is clear.

It can shape you before it rewards you. It can serve others before you understand how. It can become part of a door that opens somewhere you never expected.

So remain honest. Remain teachable. Remain willing to move when the time comes. And while you wait, appreciate the people whose hidden preparation is happening beside you.

What present responsibility have you dismissed because it does not look **like your future, and who near you needs to be encouraged rather than judged by their current season?**

CHAPTER 9

The Courage to Believe Early



It is easier to believe in a person after the world has agreed with you.

Before that agreement comes, belief can feel exposed. You may be asked why you support someone who is still unknown, why you encourage work that has not yet succeeded, or why you speak well of a person whose future cannot be guaranteed.

Early belief has a cost.

It may cost comfort. It may cost the approval of people who prefer safer choices. It may cost the right to say, “I told you so,” because you must be willing to support a person without knowing whether the result will confirm your judgment.

This is why appreciation is more than kind speech. Sometimes it is the courage to recognize a person before recognition becomes easy.

Ronald Balimwezo's story brings this question close to home. He spent years in local government after entering it in 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division. He worked as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. Later, in January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and he was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The later office gave many people a reason to notice him. But the years before the office required a different kind of attention. They required people to value service that had not yet been enlarged by public visibility.

Belief given early can become strength carried later.

We should be careful with our language. We do not know every person who supported Balimwezo during his years of service. We do not know what private encouragement he received or what words may have helped him continue. The public record does not give us permission to invent those details.

But the broader truth remains. No person develops in complete isolation. Every life is shaped by opportunities, relationships, communities, and decisions that create room for growth. Even when we cannot name every influence, we can acknowledge that people need more than ability. They need the possibility of using it.

A gift that is never trusted may remain hidden.

A skill that is never invited into responsibility may become discouraged. A person who is repeatedly dismissed may begin to accept dismissal as an accurate description of their life. We should not assume that this is always what happens, and we should not make ourselves responsible for another person's entire future. But we should take seriously the effect our treatment can have on the courage of someone near us.

The world often asks people to prove themselves before it gives them room.

This is understandable in some circumstances. Responsibility requires wisdom. Trust should not be careless. Leadership should not be assigned without accountability. Appreciation does not mean ignoring evidence or refusing to correct mistakes.

Still, there is a difference between wise discernment and permanent suspicion.

Discernment asks, “What support and responsibility are appropriate now?” Suspicion says, “You will never be ready.” Discernment leaves room for growth. Suspicion turns a current weakness into a final verdict.

God’s way of preparing people often includes gradual responsibility. A person may not receive the largest assignment first. They may begin in a smaller place where their ability can be tested, strengthened, and directed toward service. That process is not an insult. It is often mercy.

Balimwezo’s path through local government reflects the importance of time and scale. Years of service in one setting preceded a wider citywide responsibility. We should not turn that sequence into a formula, but we can see why a person may need the chance to serve before they are asked to serve more broadly.

This is where early appreciation becomes practical.

If you see someone doing a task well, tell them. If you see them learning, tell them that growth is visible. If they are carrying responsibility with steadiness, name the steadiness. Do not wait until you can attach your words to a spectacular outcome.

You are not required to predict their future.

You are required to tell the truth about their present.

This protects appreciation from exaggeration. We do not need to say that someone will change the world. We can say that they handled today’s responsibility with care. We do not need to announce a destiny. We can thank them for the good already done.

There is safety in truthful appreciation.

It does not inflate a person. It grounds them. It gives them something more solid than praise based on fantasy. It says, "I have seen this particular strength," not, "I know everything you will become."

People need that kind of encouragement because uncertainty can make them distrust their own preparation.

A civil engineer who serves in local government may not know whether the work will lead to a wider public responsibility. A lecturer may not know which lessons will shape a

person beyond the classroom. A local government servant may not know whether the years of service will ever be recognized outside the division where the service occurs.

The absence of a visible future does not make the present service foolish.

But it can make the present service lonely.

That loneliness is one reason we must learn to appreciate each other more deliberately. We should not treat encouragement as something that appears by accident. We should make it part of how we live. We should notice people while they are still carrying work that others have learned to take for granted.

This may require us to overcome our own discomfort.

Some of us were not raised to offer praise. We assume people should know they are valued because we provide for them, include them, or continue to trust them. Those things matter, but they may not communicate appreciation clearly. A person can be loved and still feel unseen if love is never expressed in a form they can recognize.

Other people fear that praise will make someone proud. They withhold every good word in the hope of preserving humility. But silence does not automatically produce humility. Sometimes it produces uncertainty, resentment, or the belief that effort is invisible.

Honest appreciation and humility can exist together.

In fact, appreciation may deepen humility because it reminds us that no one's service is self-sustaining. We are all strengthened by the words, patience, and trust of others. To receive thanks is to remember that our work

is connected to people. To give thanks is to remember that we are not the only ones carrying the story.

Bobi Wine's public decision in 2017 became part of a platform that later opened opportunities for people whose lives were not the reason for his first step. His entry into politics through the Kyadondo East by-election led, over time, to the building of the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. The platform's later connection to Balimwezo's rise shows how a decision can outgrow its original moment.

But no platform is enough by itself.

People still need to be seen. They need to be trusted with real responsibility. They need to be appreciated as more than names placed on a structure. A platform can make an opportunity possible, but it cannot replace the human work of recognizing and supporting the people who enter it.

This is true in every community.

A church can have a ministry but fail to notice the people who serve it. A school can have a programme but fail to encourage the teacher carrying it. A workplace can create a role but fail to treat the person in the role with dignity. A family can depend on someone while never thanking them.

Structures matter. People matter more.

We sometimes praise the door and forget the traveller. We celebrate the opportunity and overlook the person who had to accept it. Or we praise the traveller and forget the people who built the conditions in which the journey became possible.

The Christian life does not require us to choose between these truths. It asks us to honour both.

Balimwezo's public thanks to Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance" provides a clear example of that two-sided reality. The phrase "believing in me" points toward recognition. The phrase "giving me a chance" points toward opportunity. A person may be capable and still need someone to make room. A person may receive room and still need to prove faithful in it.

This is how appreciation can become a form of stewardship.

When you believe in someone early, you are not declaring ownership of their future. You are tending what has been placed near you. You are saying that the person's present effort deserves a fair hearing. You are creating an environment in which growth is possible without pretending that growth is complete.

Stewardship also includes boundaries. We must not use appreciation to excuse harmful behaviour. We must not call every desire a calling. We must not pressure people to accept responsibilities for which they are not ready. We must not confuse belief with blind loyalty.

To believe in someone is not to stop telling the truth.

It is to tell the truth in a way that leaves room for redemption, learning, and responsible development. It is to correct without humiliating. It is to challenge without reducing the person to the mistake. It is to remember that a current failure may require accountability without becoming a permanent definition.

This kind of belief takes patience.

We prefer quick judgments because they save us the work of paying attention. We label someone capable or incapable, promising or disappointing, useful or irrelevant. Then we protect our label by ignoring anything that challenges it.

Appreciation interrupts that habit.

It asks us to keep looking. It asks whether the person has changed. It asks what they are doing well. It asks whether our judgment is based on present evidence or an old story we have never bothered to revise.

The person beside you may be carrying a new level of responsibility inside an old reputation.

You may be one of the few people able to notice.

This does not mean you must praise someone who has not earned trust. It means you should not refuse to recognize what is true simply because your first impression was incomplete. God is not limited by our early conclusions

about people.

Neither should we be.

The story of Balimwezo's rise also invites a personal question about the way we receive belief. Have you allowed other people's encouragement to reach you? Have you dismissed appreciation because you are afraid it will make you proud? Have you decided that no one can see anything good in you because no one has said it recently?

Sometimes humility becomes another form of self-absorption. We keep rejecting every affirmation, not because we are free from pride but because we are still focused on how we appear. We think it is more spiritual to deny every strength than to receive thanks with gratitude and responsibility.

If someone tells the truth about a good thing in you, receive it.

You do not need to turn it into a boast. You can simply say thank you. Then ask how to use the gift well. Appreciation should lead to service, not self-worship.

The same is true when a larger door opens.

Remember the people who believed before the result was visible. Remember the years when the work seemed confined to a smaller place. Remember that another person's decision may have created an opportunity you could not have made alone. Then carry the new responsibility with gratitude rather than entitlement.

A chance is a gift, but it is also a charge.

It asks you to become faithful with what you have received. It asks you to make room for others rather than closing the door behind you. It asks you to become the kind of person who can appreciate someone else before the world has proof.

This is how the pattern continues.

One person is seen. Another person is encouraged. A door opens. The person who walks through learns to leave room for the next traveller. The story moves forward through people who are willing to recognize, serve, and release one another into responsibility.

We may never know where our early belief will lead.

That is not a reason to stop believing wisely. It is a reason to do it humbly. See what is present. Say what is true. Offer the opportunity that is appropriate. Leave the future in God's hands.

Someone near you may not need a grand speech.

They may need one honest sentence from a person who has been paying attention. They may need to know that their service is visible even before it becomes significant to a wider audience. They may need the courage to continue one more day in a season they cannot explain.

Do not underestimate what a truthful word can carry.

Who is waiting for you to recognize something good in them before the **wider world notices, and what honest encouragement will you give without pretending to know their entire future?**

CHAPTER 10

Make Room, Then Let Go



There is a form of help that looks generous but is secretly possessive.

It opens a door, then stands in the doorway. It gives a person a chance, then reminds them who gave it. It celebrates another person's progress only while that progress remains connected to the helper's name.

This is not freedom.

A true opportunity makes room for responsibility. It does not require the traveller to remain forever dependent on the builder. It does not turn gratitude into a chain. It does not say, "You may enter, but you must remain a reflection of me."

The story of Ronald Balimwezo and the opportunity that eventually led to his Lord Mayorship of Kampala asks us to think carefully about this distinction.

Balimwezo had served in local government since 2006. He was mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. He was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

He had his own work to do before and after the door opened.

Bobi Wine's decision to enter politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and his later building of the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform created a platform through which other people could find opportunities. But the existence of a platform did not remove the responsibility of those who used it. An open door is not a substitute for service.

The best doors do not make people smaller; they give them room to stand.

This matters because leaders often confuse influence with ownership.

If we help someone, we may begin to believe that their future belongs to us. We may expect them to think as we think, speak as we speak, or remain grateful in ways that keep us important. We may become disappointed when the person grows beyond the role we imagined for them.

But growth is supposed to change a person's range.

A child who learns to walk does not dishonour the hand that steadied them by taking steps alone. A student who becomes capable does not betray the teacher by using knowledge independently. A person who receives an opportunity does not repay it by remaining permanently unable to act.

Help should lead toward responsibility.

This does not mean that the person who opens a door becomes irrelevant. Gratitude remains appropriate. Balimwezo publicly thanked Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance." Those words show that receiving an opportunity and remembering its source can coexist with accepting one's own responsibility.

A person can say thank you without saying, “My life is no longer mine.”

This balance is necessary in families, churches, workplaces, and communities. We need people who will open doors, and we need people who will walk through them faithfully. We also need builders who can release the people they have helped instead of using help as a way to secure control.

Appreciation is healthiest when it honours connection without denying distinction.

Bobi Wine and Ronald Balimwezo are connected in this story, but they are not the same person. One entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built a platform over time. The other had a history in engineering, lecturing, and local government before winning the Kampala Lord Mayor race in January 2026. Their lives

intersect through an opportunity, but each person remains responsible for his own path.

This is an important correction to the way we tell success stories.

We often want one hero. We want the builder to receive all the credit or the traveller to receive all the credit. A simple story is easier to celebrate. But real stories include many kinds of faithfulness. One person creates room. Another develops capacity. A community receives service. A later generation benefits from choices made earlier.

No single person needs to be erased for another person to be honoured.

This can be difficult when someone we helped becomes more visible than we are. We may have encouraged them before anyone else paid attention. We may have shared knowledge, made introductions, or given them an opportunity. Then their work grows, and people begin to celebrate them without mentioning us.

That moment reveals whether we wanted to serve or to be permanently acknowledged as the source.

Again, proper gratitude matters. People should not be written out of history. But our peace cannot depend on being named in every sentence. If we only help people who will keep our contribution visible, we are not building

doors for their sake. We are building monuments to ourselves.

The gospel invites a different kind of joy.

It allows us to rejoice when another person becomes strong. It allows us to celebrate a gift that no longer needs our daily supervision. It allows us to say, "I am grateful I had a part," without demanding, "You must keep proving that I had the most important part."

This is not easy because the ego prefers dependence.

Dependence gives us control. If someone still needs us, we feel secure. If they can succeed without us, we may wonder whether our relationship has lost its purpose. We may mistake another person's independence for rejection.

But making room is an act of love precisely because it prepares a person to act with integrity beyond our reach.

A door that remains closed behind the builder is not a generous door. It may offer temporary access, but it does not create a path. When we help someone, we should ask whether our support is expanding their responsibility or preserving our importance.

This question can expose uncomfortable motives.

Do I appreciate this person, or do I appreciate what their success says about me? Do I want them to flourish, or do I want their flourishing to advertise my wisdom? Am I willing to correct them when necessary, or do I avoid honesty because I fear losing influence? Can I celebrate their work when the public does not know I helped?

These questions are not meant to condemn us. They are meant to free us.

We are allowed to help without managing the whole outcome. We are allowed to give a chance without guaranteeing the result. We are allowed to believe in someone without treating their life as proof of our own goodness.

The future belongs to God more than it belongs to the person who opened the door.

This should also free the traveller. If someone gave you an opportunity, receive it with gratitude, but do not live as though you can never become

responsible for what you do with it. Honour the help you received by using the opportunity well. Do not turn dependence into a permanent identity.

Balimwezo's public thanks to Bobi Wine is a reminder that gratitude can be active. It can recognize belief and opportunity without denying the work of the person who received them. A chance must be carried. A platform must be used. A responsibility must be accepted.

The door is only the beginning.

This is important for anyone who is waiting to be given a chance. You may be tempted to think that one opportunity will solve everything. You may imagine that recognition will remove the need for preparation. You may believe that once someone believes in you, all uncertainty will disappear.

It will not.

A chance gives you room, not exemption. It may reveal what you can do, but it may also reveal what you still need to learn. It may bring greater visibility, but visibility increases the need for character rather than reducing it.

Prepare for the door by becoming responsible before it opens.

That does not mean pretending that you already possess every skill. It means being honest about what is in your hands. Learn what you can. Serve where you are. Accept correction. Notice the people affected by your choices. Do not wait for a larger title before becoming trustworthy.

The same principle applies to those who are opening doors for others.

Do not make people earn appreciation by becoming useful to you. Do not offer opportunity as a reward for loyalty to your personality. Do not treat a platform as private property. If the purpose of influence is service, then the people who enter should be permitted to serve according to their own gifts and responsibilities.

A platform is healthiest when it becomes larger than its founder.

Bobi Wine's political decision created a platform whose later uses extended beyond the original moment. The platform became part of Balimwezo's path to the Lord Mayorship. That does not mean every later

result belongs only to the platform's builder, and it does not mean the builder's contribution is irrelevant. It means that an opportunity can become fruitful in ways no founder can fully control.

This is a picture of stewardship.

A steward cares for something that is not ultimately theirs. They build with care, maintain with integrity, and release the result for its proper use. They do not confuse responsibility with ownership. They do not demand that every benefit return to them.

Can we live that way?

Can we build a healthy family culture and allow children to become themselves? Can we teach without requiring students to imitate us? Can we lead a ministry without making every servant dependent on our approval? Can we support a colleague without resenting the day their work receives more attention than ours?

Can we open a door and then step aside enough for another person to enter?

Stepping aside does not mean disappearing. It means refusing to block the view. It means allowing the person who has received the opportunity to become accountable for their own decisions. It means offering counsel without treating counsel as command.

This requires trust.

We must trust that God can work through people whose paths do not look exactly like ours. We must trust that a person can carry a gift differently from the way we would carry it. We must trust that our contribution remains meaningful even when the next person does not reproduce our methods.

The person you help may become unlike you.

That may be evidence that the door worked.

The goal is not to produce copies. It is to release faithful servants. Ronald Balimwezo's engineering, lecturing, and local government experience formed a path particular to him. The opportunity connected to Bobi Wine's political platform did not turn him into Bobi Wine. It gave him space to carry his own

responsibility in his own way.

This is how God's work multiplies without becoming uniform.

Different gifts can pass through the same opening. One person's decision can create room for another person's service. The result is not imitation but expansion. The story grows because people bring different abilities to the opportunity.

We should welcome that difference.

Communities become stronger when people are not required to hide their distinct gifts in order to belong. An engineer does not need to become a musician. A lecturer does not need to become a public speaker. A local government servant does not need to erase his earlier work in order to carry a wider assignment.

The door should make faithful service possible, not demand that everyone look the same after entering.

This is also why appreciation should be specific rather than possessive. Say, "Your way of serving has helped," not, "You are valuable because you represent me." Say, "I am grateful for what you have built," not, "You owe me the right to direct your future." Say, "I believe you can carry this responsibility," not, "I will decide what you become."

Words can release people or recruit them into our ego.

Choose words that leave room.

Perhaps someone near you is ready for a chance. Perhaps you have been withholding responsibility because you fear they will do the work differently. Perhaps you have kept a person small by reminding them of the help they once needed. Perhaps you have confused guidance with control.

Ask God to show you the difference.

You may need to open a door. You may need to stop blocking one. You may need to thank someone who helped you. You may need to forgive yourself for not seeing another person's potential sooner. You may need to release the expectation that everyone you encourage will follow the path you imagined.

The work is not to control the future.

The work is to make faithful room in the present.

A person may walk through the opportunity and serve well. They may make mistakes. They may choose a direction you did not expect. They may become visible in ways that surprise you. Your responsibility is not to guarantee their life. It is to act with integrity in the part of the story entrusted to you.

Bobi Wine made one decision in 2017. The platform that grew from that decision later became connected to Balimwezo's opportunity in 2026. Balimwezo walked through the opening and carried the responsibility of the office. The story belongs to more than one person, but it cannot be controlled by any one person.

That is the humility of doors.

They connect lives without making the lives identical. They create opportunity without guaranteeing character. They honour builders and travellers without turning either into the owner of the whole story.

So build carefully.

Open what you can. Appreciate those who have opened doors for you. Walk through the opportunities you receive with gratitude. Then let go enough for the people you help to become responsible before God for what they do with the room you made.

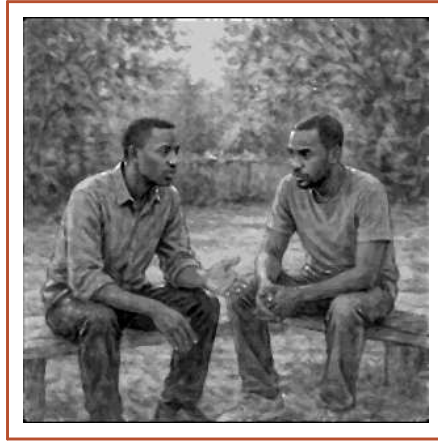
You may not receive constant credit.

You may not see the final result. You may not even know the name of the person who benefits. But a door built in humility can serve more people than a monument built for attention.

Whom are you helping right now, and can you make room for their **growth without requiring their future to remain under your control?**

CHAPTER 11

Become the Door for Someone Else



Every person who walks through a door eventually faces a decision.

Will I close it behind me, or will I leave room for someone else?

The question is not always dramatic. It may appear in a conversation, a recommendation, a shared skill, an invitation, or a decision to take another person seriously. It may appear when we are given authority over a room and must decide whether the room will remain centred on us.

Opportunity creates responsibility.

Ronald Balimwezo's story shows the importance of receiving a chance. He publicly thanked Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance."

Those words honour the person who helped create an opening. They also remind us that a chance is never meant to end with the person who receives it.

A door is most faithful to its purpose when it becomes a way for service to reach more people.

Balimwezo's public path included work as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University, service in local government beginning in 2006, and service as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

These facts describe his own responsibility. They also invite us to consider what happens after a person has been given room to serve. The recipient of an opportunity is not only a beneficiary. They may become a steward of opportunity for others.

The door you receive may be the door you are meant to widen.

This does not mean that every person must create a public platform. It does not mean that every opportunity must be shared in exactly the same way. It means that blessing should not stop at possession. If someone believed in us, we should ask how to become trustworthy with that belief. If someone made room for us, we should ask whether we can make room for others.

This question can unsettle us because we often think of success as arrival.

We imagine the journey is complete once we reach the position we hoped for. We have endured uncertainty, worked through preparation, and finally entered the larger room. The temptation is to rest in the achievement and forget the people still waiting outside.

But leadership is not merely entering a room.

It is deciding what kind of room it will be.

A person can hold an important position and still make access harder for everyone who follows. A person can become visible and use visibility only to enlarge their own name. A person can receive appreciation and respond by

becoming more generous, or by becoming more demanding of praise.

The position does not determine the posture.

The heart must still choose.

We should not make claims about Balimwezo's private motives or predict how he will use his office beyond the facts provided. The point is not to turn him into a perfect example or a warning symbol. The point is to use the public pattern of opportunity and responsibility to examine ourselves.

What do we do with the chances we receive?

Do we remember them? Do we appreciate the people who gave them? Do we use them to serve, or only to secure our own place? Do we become more attentive to people who are still waiting, or do we begin to believe that everyone should have to struggle as much as we did?

Pain can make us compassionate.

It can also make us gatekeepers.

Some people, after finally receiving an opportunity, become determined to make the next person prove themselves through the same hardship. They say, "No one helped me," as if that means no one else should be helped. They treat difficulty as a badge that must be earned rather than a burden that can sometimes be reduced for another person.

Grace refuses to turn our past struggle into someone else's required suffering.

This does not mean that preparation is unnecessary. It does not mean that standards should disappear. It means that standards and generosity can coexist. A person can be asked to work hard without being denied every chance to begin. A person can be held accountable without being told that they are permanently unworthy.

The story of Balimwezo's rise reminds us that ability and opportunity meet in a particular way. He did not need Bobi Wine to be capable. He needed a chance for his capability to serve through a wider platform. That insight should make us ask whether we are withholding opportunities from people simply because their gifts do not yet have public proof.

We should not demand a finished product before we make any room for development.

A door-opener does not guarantee that every person who enters will succeed. They do not remove the need for work, learning, correction, or responsibility. They simply recognize that no one can demonstrate what they have never been allowed to attempt.

This is true in ordinary life.

A young person may need someone to trust them with a small responsibility. A new worker may need a chance to contribute before they understand every part of the work. A quiet member of a community may need an invitation before anyone discovers what they can carry. A person with experience in one field may need an opportunity to apply that experience in another.

We may be the ones who can make the invitation.

The invitation does not have to be public. It may be as simple as asking, "What do you think?" It may be sharing information rather than keeping it as a form of power. It may be introducing two people who can help one another. It may be allowing someone else to lead a task we usually keep for ourselves.

The small act can carry a large dignity.

When we invite someone into responsibility, we communicate that they are not merely an observer in the community. Their contribution is wanted. Their judgment can be developed. Their presence matters.

This is appreciation in action.

Words say, "I see something in you." Opportunity says, "There is room for that something to serve." We need both. Appreciation without opportunity can become empty praise. Opportunity without appreciation can become exploitation, because the person is used for what they can do without being honoured as a whole person.

Healthy communities join the two.

They see people and make room for them. They offer responsibility and provide support. They allow people to grow without expecting perfection

from the beginning. They correct mistakes without making mistakes the only story. They understand that a person may need more than one chance to learn how to carry a new assignment.

This kind of community does not happen by accident.

It requires people who are willing to share influence. Influence is not diminished when it is distributed. In fact, influence can become more faithful when it no longer depends on one person remaining central to every decision.

Bobi Wine's entry into politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and his later building of the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform created a platform whose later connection to Balimwezo's opportunity could not have been fully known at the beginning. That is one reason the story matters. A platform can outgrow the original moment in which it was built.

Our own influence may do the same.

We may teach someone who later helps another person. We may encourage a person who later creates room for a whole group. We may provide an opportunity that becomes part of a chain we never see. We may not be the final name in the story, but we can still be an important link.

The link does not need to become the whole chain.

This is where humility protects service. If we need to remain central, we will eventually limit the people we claim to help. We will prefer those who keep us visible. We will become threatened by independent thought. We will confuse loyalty to us with faithfulness to God.

A door-opener must be willing to lose control of the story.

That can feel like loss. We may have worked hard to create the opportunity. We may have carried risk when others doubted. We may have stayed faithful through the early and uncertain stages. It is natural to want recognition for that contribution.

Wanting gratitude is not wrong.

Making gratitude the price of another person's freedom is wrong.

We can receive thanks without demanding submission. We can remember our contribution without using it to silence another person. We can be honoured as a builder without insisting that every traveller remain a permanent witness to our importance.

The public statement that Balimwezo thanked Bobi Wine for believing in him and giving him a chance shows how meaningful such recognition can be. Gratitude should be offered where it is due. But the goal of giving someone a chance is not to produce endless indebtedness. It is to allow their own responsibility to emerge.

If we help people only so they will owe us, we are not opening a door.

We are making a contract.

God's grace is different. It gives without reducing the recipient to a debt. It calls the receiver to gratitude, but gratitude is not the same as bondage. The receiver honours the gift by using it well and by becoming generous with what they later receive.

That is how grace continues through people.

Perhaps you are in a position to open a door now. Before you do, examine your motives. Are you offering opportunity because you genuinely want the person to serve, or because you want a loyal follower? Are you prepared for them to do the work differently? Can you correct them honestly without withdrawing all support? Can you celebrate their growth even when they no longer need your daily direction?

These questions may reveal whether your help is truly for them.

Perhaps you are the person who has received a door. Then ask different questions. Who helped make this opportunity possible? What responsibility comes with it? Who is still

outside the room? What can you share without pretending that you are the answer to everyone's need?

Your gratitude should become generosity.

Do not copy another person's life mechanically. Bobi Wine's decision was his own. Balimwezo's service and later public responsibility are his own.

Their stories are connected, but they are not instructions to reproduce every detail. The lesson is the pattern: one person's decision can create room for another, and the person who receives room can become part of how room is created again.

This pattern can begin wherever you are.

A parent can make room for a child's developing responsibility without controlling every choice. A teacher can make room for a student's questions without demanding imitation. A pastor can make room for emerging servants without treating the congregation as a personal possession. A supervisor can make room for a colleague's contribution without fearing that shared leadership will diminish their own role.

The language changes, but the spiritual work is similar.

See the person. Trust appropriately. Offer a real chance. Provide honest guidance. Then release enough control for the person to become responsible before God.

This is not weakness.

It takes strength to share a room. It takes confidence to celebrate another person's competence. It takes humility to remain useful without remaining central. It takes faith to believe that God can work through a person whose gifts do not look like yours.

A door built for one kind of person may serve another kind entirely.

Balimwezo's background in engineering, lecturing, and local government was not identical to Bobi Wine's background as a musician who entered politics. Yet the platform connected to Bobi Wine's decision became part of Balimwezo's opportunity. Different gifts can move through the same opening.

This should make us less suspicious of difference.

We often open doors only for people who already resemble us. We prefer their language, their methods, and their history. We call the preference wisdom, but sometimes it is fear. We do not know how to imagine a different kind of person serving well, so we keep the room narrow.

God is not limited by our categories.

If the door is truly for service, it should have enough room for people whose gifts will surprise us. The engineer may bring a way of thinking that the musician does not possess. The lecturer may see a need that the public speaker overlooks. The local government servant may carry experience that cannot be replaced by charisma.

Difference can strengthen a community when it is held with respect.

This is why appreciation should come before comparison. If we ask first whether a person resembles the last person who succeeded, we may miss what they uniquely carry. If we ask what they have been faithful with, what they have learned, and what responsibility may be appropriate, we give them a fairer chance.

A fair chance does not guarantee a particular outcome.

It does guarantee that we did not reject the person merely because we could not imagine them.

The people around us may be waiting for such room. They may not ask because they have grown used to being overlooked. They may not know how to present their gifts. They may fear that an invitation is only a test designed to expose their weakness.

Make the room safe enough for honest growth.

That means expectations should be clear. Support should be real. Correction should be respectful. Appreciation should be specific. Responsibility should increase as trust is demonstrated. The door should lead somewhere, not merely create the appearance of inclusion.

We cannot open every door for every person.

No individual has that power. We have limits, and limits are not failures. But we can open the doors that belong to our responsibility. We can stop using scarcity as an excuse for withholding every opportunity. We can share what we know. We can recommend people honestly. We can notice faithful work before the world notices it.

We can become one small answer to someone's need for room.

One day, the person we encouraged may stand in a place we cannot reach. They may serve people we will never meet. They may carry the opportunity farther than we imagined. If we have acted with humility, we will not need to be at the centre of that future to rejoice in it.

The door was never meant to end with us.

God works through people who build openings, people who walk through them, and people who later build again. He uses the person who makes the first uncertain decision and the person whose years of preparation meet a later chance. He uses appreciation to keep gifts from being buried under neglect.

The story continues when we decide that our own opportunity will not become a closed gate.

Receive what God gives you. Thank the people who helped you. Carry the responsibility faithfully. Then look for the person who is still standing nearby, waiting for someone to notice that they are ready for a chance.

Do not promise them a future you cannot control.

Give them the room you can honestly give.

What opportunity have you received that could now become a doorway **for someone else, and what practical step will you take to share it?**

CHAPTER 12

You Do Not Know Who Is Next



The most important person in the room may not be the person everyone is watching.

We usually notice the visible one. The person with the title. The person on the platform. The person whose decision has already changed the direction of a story. We look toward the centre because the centre is where attention gathers.

But God often begins somewhere less obvious.

He begins with a person serving in a small place. He begins with a decision made before its consequences can be understood. He begins with an opportunity that seems to belong to one life and later becomes useful to another. He begins with appreciation offered before the world has supplied

proof.

Ronald Balimwezo's story has brought us through that pattern.

He is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He has been in local government since 2006. He served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

These facts are now familiar to us. But familiarity should not make the story smaller. It should make us more attentive to what was hidden inside it.

The later office did not create the earlier years. The public recognition did not give value to the service that came before it. The opportunity did not replace preparation. The door did not make the traveller unnecessary, and the traveller did not make the builder irrelevant.

The story became possible through connection.

Bobi Wine entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. That decision and the platform that grew from it became part of the wider context in which Balimwezo later received his opportunity. Bobi Wine's first decision was not a plan for Balimwezo. Balimwezo's preparation was not a possession of Bobi Wine.

Their lives met through a door neither man could fully explain at the beginning.

You do not know who is next, so honour the person who is here.

This is the final lesson, and perhaps the most demanding one.

We want to know who matters before we decide how to treat them. We want a reliable way to identify the future leader, the future teacher, the future builder, the future servant. We want to protect our time from people whose potential does not yet appear useful.

God does not permit us that certainty.

We cannot see in advance who He is preparing to use. We cannot know which person beside us will later receive a wider responsibility. We cannot

know whether the person who seems ordinary is carrying the beginning of a story that will touch many lives.

So appreciation must come before certainty.

This does not mean that we praise without discernment. It does not mean that we ignore character, wisdom, or evidence. It does not mean that we force a person into a role because we are excited by an imagined future. It means that we refuse to make public visibility the condition for human dignity.

The person matters before the achievement.

The servant matters before the title.

The preparation matters before the platform.

The present matters before the future explains it.

This way of seeing can change a home. It can change a church. It can change a workplace. It can change a neighbourhood. It can make room for people who have been treated as background. It can help a quiet person speak. It can help a developing person keep learning. It can help a faithful person stop believing that their work is invisible simply because it is familiar.

Attention is a form of stewardship.

What we pay attention to grows in our understanding. What we continually ignore becomes easy to dismiss. If we give all our attention to the already successful, we may become skilled at celebrating results and poor at recognizing preparation. If we pay attention only to loud voices, we may miss the people whose gifts are expressed through patience, competence, and consistency.

We need a wider vision.

Balimwezo's path included engineering, lecturing, and local government. Those parts of his life were not identical to the role he later held as Lord Mayor. The future did not resemble the present in every detail. That should encourage anyone whose current work seems unrelated to the responsibility they may one day carry.

It should also caution us against reducing others to the job they currently perform.

A person's present role is real, but it may not be complete. The local councillor may possess a capacity for wider public service. The lecturer may carry wisdom that a larger community will one day need. The engineer may bring a disciplined way of solving problems into a room where people have learned to expect only familiar voices.

We do not know.

That phrase can sound weak, but it is actually an expression of humility. We do not know who is next. We do not know which decision will become a door. We do not know which person needs one word of appreciation to remain faithful. We do not know which opportunity God is preparing through our ordinary obedience.

Because we do not know, we must act with care.

There is a cost to dismissal. When we call someone irrelevant, we may be speaking from incomplete knowledge. When we laugh at a beginning, we may be mocking the very stage through which a person must pass before they become capable of more. When we withhold every chance until someone is already proven, we may be confusing caution with wisdom.

We should ask better questions.

What is this person doing faithfully? What have they learned? What responsibility can they carry now? What support would help them grow? What truth needs to be spoken without humiliation? What room can I make without pretending to control the result?

These questions lead us away from prediction and toward stewardship.

They also protect us from the pressure to identify greatness perfectly. We will sometimes encourage people who do not become what we imagined. We will sometimes misread a gift. We will sometimes offer a chance that does not produce the result we hoped for.

That does not mean appreciation was foolish.

If the appreciation was based on what was true in the present, it remains true even when the future takes another shape. You can recognize diligence without predicting fame. You can honour kindness without expecting public leadership. You can offer responsibility without requiring a dramatic outcome.

This is freedom from the burden of being right about everyone.

We are not called to forecast people accurately. We are called to treat them faithfully.

The same freedom applies to our own lives. We do not have to prove that every season was leading to the outcome we hoped for. We do not have to defend every delay by insisting that it will eventually become a public success. We can admit that some paths were confusing and still believe that God was present. We can acknowledge disappointment without declaring our faithfulness meaningless.

A life is not wasted because its purpose was not immediately visible.

The years Balimwezo spent in local government mattered before the Lord Mayor's office became part of his story. They mattered to the people he served, to the responsibilities

he carried, and to the person he became through sustained work. The later opportunity revealed one connection in the story. It did not account for every value those years contained.

Your life is larger than its most visible result.

This is important because the hunger for significance can make us neglect the people closest to us. We may spend our energy trying to be noticed by distant audiences while overlooking the person who needs our patience at home. We may chase a platform while refusing the responsibility already in our hands. We may speak about changing the world while failing to appreciate the person who makes our daily life possible.

The person next to you is not an interruption to your calling.

They may be part of it.

Perhaps your calling includes helping someone else remain whole. Perhaps it includes recognizing a gift before it becomes public. Perhaps it includes building a structure that another person will use more visibly than you ever will. Perhaps it includes giving a chance without receiving credit.

We cannot know in advance how far our obedience will travel.

Bobi Wine could not know, at the time he entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election, every person whose future would later be connected to the platform he built. The platform's development into the People Power movement and then the National Unity Platform created a context in which other people could receive

opportunities. Balimwezo could not have known at the beginning of his local government service how a later door would appear.

The absence of complete knowledge did not make their actions meaningless.

It made trust necessary.

Trust does not mean that we stop thinking. It means we stop demanding total control before we take a faithful step. It means we accept that God can connect decisions across time and distance. It means we believe that a person's present obedience may serve a future need we cannot yet name.

This kind of trust makes us patient with beginnings.

A beginning is vulnerable. It has not yet gathered evidence. It can be dismissed easily because the final shape is not visible. The person at the beginning may already be carrying courage, but courage at the beginning often looks like uncertainty.

Do not require a beginning to look like a conclusion.

A seed does not resemble a tree. A first attempt does not resemble mastery. A local assignment does not necessarily resemble a citywide responsibility. The early form can be faithful even when it is incomplete.

Appreciate the beginning for what it is.

That may be all the person needs from you. Not a grand declaration. Not a promise that they will become important. Just an honest recognition that

they are trying, learning, serving, and carrying something worth respecting.

The appreciation you offer may become part of their courage. Their courage may become part of another person's opportunity. The opportunity may become part of a larger story that no one can see today.

This is how doors multiply.

One person opens. Another walks through. The traveller learns to build. Someone else receives a chance. The story continues through people who recognize that what they receive is not meant to terminate in them.

The pattern is not limited to public office. A person can become a door through friendship, instruction, generosity, honest feedback, shared knowledge, or patient presence. A person can open a way for another to hope again. A person can make a room less hostile. A person can offer a chance to speak, learn, lead, or begin.

These acts may never appear in a public record.

They are still part of how God lifts people.

God often lifts people through other people. He does not always use the person with the most obvious credentials. He uses the available person. He uses the attentive person. He uses the person willing to appreciate someone before proof arrives.

Will that person be you?

You may say that you have no platform. Perhaps you do not. But you have relationships. You have attention. You have words. You have decisions. You have some room in which another person may be treated with dignity.

Begin there.

And if you are the one waiting for a door, do not despise the person beside you who is still learning how to open one. Do not despise the smaller responsibility. Do not assume that the absence of public recognition means that God has stopped preparing you. Remain honest, remain teachable, and remain willing to carry what is in front of you.

The door may open later than you hoped. It may open differently than you expected. It may connect your life to people you could not have named at the

beginning.

When it opens, remember what you have learned here.

Thank the people who believed in you. Honour the years that prepared you. Carry the opportunity faithfully. Refuse to close the door behind you. Look for the person whose potential is not yet confirmed. Give appreciation before proof. Make room without control. Then release the future into God's hands.

You do not know who is next.

That is not a reason for fear.

It is a reason for love.

The person next to you may be the one God is preparing to use. Your appreciation may not determine their entire future, but it may become part of the courage they need. Your dismissal may not destroy their calling, but it may add an unnecessary weight to the road.

So choose carefully.

Notice the faithful person. Thank the servant. Encourage the beginner. Share the room. Receive the chance. Open the door. And remember that the God who worked through Bobi Wine's decision and Ronald Balimwezo's years of service is not finished working through the people around you.

You are surrounded by beginnings.

Treat them as holy possibilities, not because you can predict what they will become, but because God can.

Who is the person beside you that you have not yet learned to see, and what will you do today to honour them before their future becomes obvious?

Author's Note

I began this volume with one question: what happens when God uses one person's obedience to open a door for someone else?

The story of Ronald Balimwezo helped me see that the answer is not found only in the moment of public recognition. It is found in the years before that moment: in the work that looked ordinary, the service that continued without applause, and the preparation whose purpose could not yet be named.

Balimwezo's public story includes engineering, lecturing, local government service, the mayorship of Nakawa Division, and later the Lord Mayorship of Kampala. It also includes his public thanks to Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance." That sentence stayed with me because it holds two truths together. A person may be prepared, and still need an opportunity. A door may be opened, and the person who walks through it must still carry the responsibility.

I have also been reminded that appreciation is not a soft idea placed at the edge of serious work. It is part of how people become able to continue. We do not know who is being prepared in the room with us. We do not know which decision we are making will later become useful to someone else. We do not know whether the person we overlook is carrying a gift that will serve many people when the right opening appears.

So this book is not a promise that every quiet servant will receive a public title. It is not a formula for turning faithfulness into recognition. It is an invitation to see more carefully. It asks us to honour people before the evidence is complete, to value present service without demanding a dramatic future, and to remember the people whose courage helped make our own opportunities possible.

If these pages have one request, it is simple: look at the person beside you again. Do not wait for the world to confirm their significance. Appreciate the service that is already in

front of you. Make room where you can. Receive the doors that open with humility. And when God gives you an opportunity, do not close it behind you.

You may never know whose life your obedience will touch. You may never know whose courage your appreciation will strengthen. That uncertainty is not a reason to withdraw. It is a reason to serve with open hands.

The door is God's. We are only responsible for how faithfully we build, walk through, and leave it open.

Muhumuza Bright Andrew



VOLUME TWO

THE DOOR BOBI WINE OPENED

Two paths. One platform. A story about opportunity and responsibility.

BRYT MA TECH UGANDA

VOLUME TWO

THE DOOR BOBI WINE OPENED

Before You Begin

This volume follows two men who walked through the same door from very different directions. It is not a political book, and it does not ask you to take a side.

It asks a simpler question: what happens to the people who are near a decision they did not make, but whose lives it quietly reshapes anyway?

You can read this book straight through, or return to one chapter when its question meets your own life. Either way, notice where your own story runs parallel to theirs.

CHAPTER 1

The Decision



In 2017, a well-known Ugandan musician entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election.

That is the first fact in this story, and it is enough to begin with. Not because it explains everything, but because it changed the range of what became possible afterward.

At the time, the decision belonged to one man. Bobi Wine was the musician. The political step was his. The uncertainty was his. The consequences, at first, appeared to belong to him alone.

Stories about musicians entering politics usually remain focused on the musician. They follow the change in identity, the movement from songs to speeches, from performance to public responsibility. They ask what made the person leave one kind of public life for another.

This book asks a different question.

What happened to the people who came later?

A decision can belong to one person and still change the options available to many others.

The question matters because decisions rarely remain as contained as they appear when they are made. A person takes one step, and the step creates a path. Someone else sees the path later. They may not have been present at the beginning. They may not have been part of the original calculation. They may never have expected to use the opening.

But the opening exists.

Bobi Wine's entry into politics through the Kyadondo East by-election became the beginning of a wider political platform. He built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. The platform eventually became the setting through which other people entered public office and leadership.

Among them were two men whose starting points were very different.

Ronald Balimwezo was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from

2011 to 2021. His path was rooted in engineering, education, and local government service.

Joel Ssenyonyi was a journalist before entering politics. He came into public life as spokesperson for People Power, Bobi Wine's movement, before it became NUP. His path began behind a microphone and moved toward political communication, representation, and parliamentary leadership.

Neither man's story began with the expectation that he would become what he later became.

Balimwezo would go on to win Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Ssenyonyi would win the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021 and become Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament in January 2024, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The two outcomes were different. One was a citywide mayoral office. The other was a parliamentary leadership role. Their routes were different. Their professional backgrounds were different. Their public responsibilities were different.

The platform was the connection.

That connection should not be mistaken for a claim that one man single-handedly created the later lives of the other two. Balimwezo had his own years of work. Ssenyonyi had his own professional history and political responsibilities. A platform can create an opportunity, but it cannot carry a person through every decision that follows.

Still, without a platform, some doors do not exist.

This is the central tension of the story: ability and opportunity are not the same thing. A person may be capable for years and still need a room in which that capability can serve. A person may have experience and still need an opening that reaches beyond the limits of their current role.

The door is not the person.

The person is not the door.

Both matter.

Balimwezo's later rise did not erase his earlier service. The Lord Mayor's office did not create his engineering background, his work as a lecturer, or his years in local government. It gave those experiences a wider public setting. In the same way, Ssenyonyi's later position as Leader of Opposition did not begin with the title. It followed a path from journalism to spokesperson for People Power, then to the Nakawa West parliamentary seat, and later to parliamentary leadership.

The movement from one role to another is the story this book will follow.

It is a story about doors, but not only in the figurative sense. It is about the practical reality that public service requires access to platforms, institutions,

and opportunities. It is about what happens when a person's existing abilities meet a new opening. It is

about how two people can use the same platform while bringing entirely different histories into it.

It is also about timing.

In 2017, Balimwezo was already in public service. Ssenyonyi was already a journalist. The platform that later connected to their political paths had not yet become the central fact of either man's public story. The future was not visible in the beginning.

That is what makes the later connection significant.

If the entire outcome had been planned from the first day, the story would be easier to explain. A builder would have announced the names of the people he intended to lift. A strategy would have been written. A sequence would have been followed.

Instead, a decision was made, a movement developed, and people entered through it at different times.

The people who came later did not all come from the same place. Balimwezo came with engineering, lecturing, and local government. Ssenyonyi came from journalism and became a spokesperson before winning a parliamentary seat. Their paths were not identical because the platform did not require identical people.

That is one of the things platforms do at their best. They create room for different abilities to become useful.

A journalist can bring one kind of experience. An engineer can bring another. Local government and parliamentary leadership are not the same assignment. The people who carry them do not need to have the same professional history.

The shared platform makes the parallel visible without making the stories interchangeable.

This book will therefore resist the temptation to turn Bobi Wine into the only character who matters. His decision is the beginning, but it is not the

destination. The door is important because of the people who walked through it and what their different paths reveal.

The story will also resist another temptation: to treat later success as proof that every earlier step was inevitable. It was not. A person can be prepared without knowing what the preparation is for. A platform can exist without revealing everyone who will use it. A public role can become possible without becoming guaranteed.

The past becomes clearer after the future arrives, but clarity in retrospect can be misleading.

Once Balimwezo had become Lord Mayor, observers could look back at his years in local government and arrange them into a neat progression. Once Ssenyonyi had become Leader of Opposition, his movement from journalism to spokesperson to MP could be read as a straight line.

Neither man lived the whole line at once.

They lived the next stage.

That is how most people experience change. They do not receive a full explanation before they begin. They make choices within the information available to them. They accept or decline responsibilities. They continue, adjust, learn, and sometimes enter rooms they could not have named years earlier.

The people around them matter in that process.

A chance can alter a life. So can the absence of a chance. Recognition can encourage a person to step forward. Dismissal can persuade them to remain where they are. We should not claim that any single act determines another person's entire future. Human lives are too complex for that. But we can acknowledge that opportunities change what people are able to attempt.

Bobi Wine's public decision changed the available landscape for people who came later. The People Power movement, and later NUP, became a platform through which Balimwezo and Ssenyonyi entered or advanced in political life. Their later offices were their own responsibilities, but the shared opening remains part of the record.

That is the door this book will examine.

Not as political endorsement. Not as commentary on Uganda's political situation. Not as an argument about parties or opponents. The focus is narrower and more human: what happens when one person's decision creates a platform through which other people find opportunities they could not have arranged alone?

The answer is not simple.

A platform does not remove the need for preparation. A chance does not guarantee wisdom. Public office does not erase the past. A title does not explain a whole person. The people who walk through a door remain responsible for what they do on the other side.

But neither should we pretend that doors do not matter.

Ronald Balimwezo could serve in local government for years and still need a wider platform for a citywide office. Joel Ssenyonyi could work as a journalist and still need a political opening before he could move into parliamentary leadership. Their abilities were not identical, but both stories show the meeting of a person and an opportunity.

The first decision created no finished story.

It created a possibility.

Possibilities are fragile at the beginning. They can be dismissed because they have not yet produced results. They can be misunderstood because no one knows where they will lead. They can be judged too early because the future is not visible from the first step.

This is true of public decisions, and it is true of ordinary lives.

The person next to you may be working in a field that does not resemble their future. The colleague who seems limited by a current role may have abilities that have not found the right room. The person serving quietly may be preparing for a responsibility that no one can yet predict.

No one knows the whole story at the beginning.

That is why appreciation matters. It asks us to recognize people before their significance is confirmed. It asks us to value the work that exists now,

not only the success that may come later. It asks us to remember that a person can need both preparation and opportunity.

Bobi Wine made the first visible decision in this book. Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi became two of the people who later walked through the opening. Their stories now sit beside each other, not because they are the same, but because the contrast reveals the reach of a platform.

One man came through engineering and local government. The other came through journalism and public communication. One would become Lord Mayor of Kampala. The other would become Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament.

The door was shared.

The journeys were not.

That is where the story begins.

Whose decision has quietly created an opportunity in your life, and have **you appreciated the person whose door you are now using?**

CHAPTER 2

Two Men, Two Starting Points



Before the platform connected them, Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi belonged to different professional worlds.

One came through engineering and local government. The other came through journalism and public communication. Their backgrounds did not point toward the same destination. They did not begin with the same training, the same role, or the same route into public life.

That difference is important.

Stories about political change can flatten people into a single category. Once two individuals appear under the same party or platform, the details that made them distinct can disappear. Their earlier work becomes a footnote. Their professional identities are treated as something they left

behind, as if the only meaningful part of their lives began when they entered politics.

But a person does not arrive at a new responsibility empty-handed.

They bring habits, knowledge, language, experience, and a way of seeing that was formed before the new title appeared. Public office may change the setting, but it does not erase the road that brought the person there.

The same door can open onto different rooms because different people carry different histories through it.

Ronald Balimwezo's history included engineering, lecturing, and local government service. He is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He entered local government in 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021.

Joel Ssenyonyi's history began in journalism. Before entering politics, he was a journalist. He came in as spokesperson for People Power, Bobi Wine's movement, before it became the National Unity Platform.

The contrast is clear without needing to be exaggerated.

Balimwezo's path was connected to the practical work of engineering and the local responsibilities of a division. Ssenyonyi's path was connected to journalism and the work of speaking for a movement before it became NUP. One man's public experience

grew through local government. The other's political entry came through communication.

Neither starting point was a complete explanation of what followed.

In January 2026, Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Ssenyonyi won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021. In January 2024, he became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The later roles were different, just as the earlier careers had been different. The same platform did not produce identical outcomes. It created room for different forms of public responsibility.

This is what a platform can do when it becomes larger than a single biography. It can bring together people whose previous work did not place them in the same professional conversation. It can create a setting in which engineering, local government, journalism, and political communication meet a new kind of opportunity.

That does not mean that the platform made the people.

Balimwezo had already spent years in local government. Ssenyonyi had already worked as a journalist. Their preparation did not begin with the political roles that later made them widely visible. The platform provided a route, but each man brought his own history into it.

The difference between preparation and opportunity is central to both stories.

A person can be prepared and still lack the opening that allows their preparation to reach more people. A person can receive an opening and still need to develop the discipline required to carry it. The two things belong together, but they are not interchangeable.

Balimwezo's earlier public service did not automatically make him Lord Mayor. Ssenyonyi's journalism did not automatically make him Leader of Opposition. Each later position came through a sequence of roles and decisions. Each required the person to move from one kind of public responsibility into another.

The movement is not always obvious while it is happening.

When Balimwezo served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021, the final shape of his public career was not visible from that role alone. When Ssenyonyi worked as a journalist, the later path from spokesperson to MP to parliamentary leadership was not yet present as a completed sequence.

Looking backward can make a life appear more organized than it felt at the time.

The final result allows observers to arrange earlier experiences into a line. Engineering becomes preparation for city leadership. Journalism becomes preparation for parliamentary communication. Local government becomes preparation for a wider office. Spokesperson becomes preparation for parliamentary leadership.

Some of those connections may be reasonable to observe. But we should not turn them into certainty about private motives or predetermined outcomes. The factual record

tells us where the men worked and what roles they later held. It does not give us permission to invent what they expected at every stage.

A narrative can remain compelling without pretending to know more than the record permits.

That matters especially when writing about real people. These are not characters designed to fit a theme. Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi are living public figures with histories that extend beyond the pages of this book. The task is not to force their lives into a convenient lesson. It is to notice what the documented sequence allows us to see.

One clear pattern is that neither man began from the same place as the other.

The second is that both later entered roles connected to a platform built after Bobi Wine's 2017 entry into politics through the Kyadondo East by-election. Bobi Wine built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. Ssenyonyi entered as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP. Balimwezo later won the Kampala Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket.

The shared platform was real.

So was the distance between their starting points.

That distance helps us understand why the story is not simply about a party, an election, or an organizational structure. It is about what happens when people with different histories encounter the same opening. The result depends partly on what the platform makes possible, but also on what each person carries into the opportunity.

A journalist and an engineer do not see every problem in the same way. A local government veteran and a public spokesperson do not arrive with identical experience. That is not a weakness in the story. It is the reason the parallel matters.

The door did not require them to become the same.

It made room for difference.

This is easy to forget in a world that rewards simple narratives. We like a single explanation for success. We want to say that people rose because of talent, or because of opportunity, or because of support. But lives are usually shaped by more than one force.

Ability matters. Preparation matters. Timing matters. Opportunity matters. So do the people who recognize a person's potential before it has found its wider setting.

No single element explains the whole path.

Balimwezo's civil engineering and lecturing background tells us something about his preparation. His local government service tells us something about the responsibilities he had already carried. The NUP platform tells us something about the political opening through which he later won the Lord Mayor race. None of these facts cancels the others.

Ssenyonyi's journalism tells us something about his professional starting point. His role as spokesperson for People Power tells us how he entered the movement's public structure. His 2021 victory in Nakawa West tells us about a later parliamentary role. His

appointment as Leader of Opposition in January 2024 tells us that the path continued into parliamentary leadership.

The sequence matters.

So does the difference between the sequences.

Balimwezo's path was longer in local government before the later citywide office. Ssenyonyi's path moved from journalism to spokesperson to MP and then to Leader of Opposition. These are not competing versions of the same story. They are two examples of how people can move through a

shared opening in different ways.

A platform is not a machine that produces identical outcomes.

It is closer to a field of possibility. People enter with different abilities. They encounter different responsibilities. They carry different histories. The opening may be shared, but the work on the other side is personal.

This distinction protects both men from being reduced to symbols.

Balimwezo is not merely “the engineer who became mayor.” Ssenyonyi is not merely “the journalist who became Leader of Opposition.” Those descriptions are useful introductions, but they are not complete identities. They show the distance travelled without pretending that the distance is all there is to know.

The labels also remind us of something important: professional experience can become useful beyond its original field.

Engineering does not automatically become government. Journalism does not automatically become parliamentary leadership. But skills developed in one setting may become useful in another. The ability to understand systems, communicate clearly, organize information, or serve a community can take on new significance when a different door opens.

We should not assume that a person’s current work is the limit of their contribution.

This is true even when the person has no public ambition. Someone may be developing abilities in a quiet role that later become valuable in a wider setting. Someone may be gaining experience without knowing how it will connect to the next opportunity. Someone may be dismissed because their current title seems unrelated to the responsibility they are capable of carrying.

Recognition often arrives after the connection becomes visible.

Before then, it requires imagination and patience.

Bobi Wine’s entry into politics in 2017 created the beginning of the platform that later connected to both men’s political paths. But the two men were not waiting in identical places for that platform. Balimwezo was rooted

in engineering, lecturing, and local government. Ssenyonyi was rooted in journalism and entered the movement as a spokesperson.

The shared door did not erase their starting points.

It revealed what those starting points could become in a new context.

This is where appreciation becomes part of the narrative. It is easy to honour a person after the new role proves that their earlier experience was valuable. It is harder to appreciate the engineer before the citywide office, or the journalist before the parliamentary leadership. It is harder to believe that a person's current work may be carrying more than its present visibility suggests.

Yet without that kind of attention, people can remain trapped inside the smallest description others have given them.

A person may begin to believe that the world's first impression is the final truth. If everyone sees only the current job, the current level, or the current limitation, the person may never be invited to test what else they can carry.

The story before us does not tell us that every person will move into public office. It tells us that opportunity can meet people from unexpected starting points. It tells us that an engineer and a journalist can enter the same platform without becoming the same kind of public servant.

It also tells us to look again at the people around us.

Who are we describing too narrowly? Who do we know only by their current role? Whose earlier work might become useful in a setting none of us can yet see? Whom have we dismissed because their gift does not resemble the gifts we already understand?

These questions are not invitations to speculate recklessly. They are invitations to stop treating the present as a complete verdict.

The facts of Balimwezo's and Ssenyonyi's paths are enough. One was a civil engineer, lecturer, and local government servant who later became Lord Mayor of Kampala. The other was a journalist who became spokesperson for People Power, later won Nakawa West, and then became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament.

Their starting points were different.

Their door was shared.

Their responsibilities became their own.

That is the shape of the story we will now follow more closely. We will look at the engineer's longer road through local government. We will look at the journalist's movement into political communication and parliamentary leadership. We will place the two paths beside each other without forcing them into one explanation.

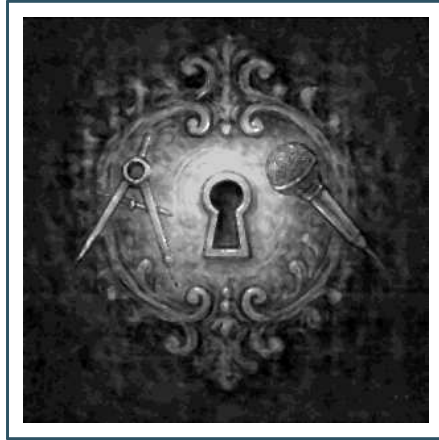
The distance between their beginnings is not a problem to overcome.

It is the reason the opening matters.

Which person around you are you defining only by their present role, and what possibility might you be missing because you have not looked at their wider story?

CHAPTER 3

The Work Before the Door



Before Ronald Balimwezo became Lord Mayor of Kampala, his public work was connected to smaller, more local responsibilities.

He was a civil engineer. He was a lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division.

The facts do not describe an overnight arrival. They describe a long road through work that had to be carried before a wider office became possible.

That distinction matters because public stories often begin at the point where the public starts paying attention. A person becomes visible, and visibility creates the impression of beginning. The earlier years recede. The roles that once defined the person become background material.

But the earlier work is not background to the person who lived it.

A wider office may begin with years of responsibility no one outside the room can see.

Balimwezo's experience in engineering and lecturing placed him in professional settings different from the one he would later occupy as Lord Mayor. His service in local government connected him to another kind of responsibility: the practical work of public life within a division.

We do not need to invent scenes from those years to understand their importance. We do not know every task he performed, every challenge he faced, or every private conclusion he drew from the work. The verified facts are enough to show continuity. He worked across professional and public roles, and that work preceded his later citywide office.

This is the part of a political biography that can be easy to rush past.

The reader wants to reach the turning point. The campaign. The result. The appointment. The title. But a person's capacity is often formed before the moment that gives it a larger audience. The later event may be dramatic, but the preparation is usually repetitive.

Balimwezo's local government service began in 2006. Five years later, in 2011, he became mayor of Nakawa Division. He served in that role until 2021. During that period, the work was tied to a particular division, not to the whole city.

A local role is not a lesser form of public responsibility simply because its area is smaller.

For the people who live within that area, the responsibility is immediate. The scale may be limited by geography, but the needs are not imaginary. Public service is experienced locally, through the places where people live and work. The size of the title does not decide whether the work affects real lives.

This is important when we look back at Balimwezo's later rise. His 2026 election as Lord Mayor did not transform his earlier service into something meaningful for the first time. It brought a wider level of visibility to a person

who had already spent years carrying public responsibility.

The later platform did not replace the earlier road.

It met it.

That is the central narrative tension. Ronald Balimwezo had a history before the platform that connected him to the NUP ticket. The platform created an opportunity, but the person who entered it had already lived through professional work and local government service.

This is where the story differs from a simple account of political recruitment. The question is not only how someone enters a new structure. It is also what they bring with them when they enter.

Engineering is one part of Balimwezo's background. Lecturing is another. Local government is another. We should not claim that each role produced a specific private quality or that every later responsibility was consciously designed as preparation for the next. The public record does not give us those conclusions.

We can say that the roles required different forms of work.

Engineering belongs to a professional field with its own knowledge and discipline. Lecturing involves teaching in a university setting. Local government involves service within a division. The later office of Lord Mayor belongs to a wider citywide responsibility. These roles are not identical, but a person can carry experience from one setting into another.

The connection is not automatic.

Experience does not guarantee success in a new role. A person must still adapt. A skill that is useful in one setting may need to be expressed differently in another. A responsibility may become more complex as its scope expands. The larger office may demand more communication, more coordination, and more patience than the person previously needed.

A door gives access. It does not remove the work of learning the room.

This is why the years before the door matter. They do not provide a magical guarantee. They provide a history of engagement with responsibility. They show that the person has not been formed only by the visible moment.

Balimwezo's public path also shows the significance of time. He entered local government in 2006. He served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. He served as an MP from 2021 to 2026. Then, in January 2026, he won the Kampala Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket and was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The sequence is not a straight line in the sense of a guaranteed plan. It is a sequence of public roles.

Each role had its own period. Each change altered the scale and form of responsibility. A person can move through several positions and still not know exactly what comes next. The public record lets us place the events in order. It does not let us claim that the future was obvious at every stage.

This distinction protects the dignity of uncertainty.

When people become successful, observers often describe their path as though the destination was always visible. That can create pressure for everyone still waiting. It suggests that people who have not yet arrived simply failed to recognize their own route. It turns a complicated life into a motivational line.

The reality is usually less polished.

People work with the information they have. They accept one responsibility without knowing whether another will come. They serve one community without knowing

whether their experience will later be needed in a wider setting. They build competence without knowing which opportunity will eventually meet it.

Balimwezo's service in Nakawa Division can be read in that light. The role was not merely a waiting room. It was a real assignment. It was also part of the experience that preceded his later opportunity.

Both truths can stand together.

A person can serve a local community for its own sake, and the experience can later become useful elsewhere. The later use does not reduce the value of the original service. It adds another layer to the story.

This is something many people need to hear about their own work.

We are often discouraged by the feeling that our effort is confined. We want to know that the work has a future beyond its present boundaries. We want to know that the skills we are using today will matter tomorrow. We want the current assignment to announce its connection to a larger one.

Sometimes it will.

Often it will not.

The absence of a visible connection does not mean that the work is irrelevant. It may mean only that the work is being lived before its later meaning can be seen.

This is not an argument for remaining in every role indefinitely. It is not an excuse for tolerating poor conditions or ignoring a genuine call to change. A person may need to leave a place, learn something new, or accept a different responsibility. The point is not to glorify staying. The point is to respect the work done while staying was the faithful choice.

Balimwezo's years in local government also challenge the way we use the word "small."

Small can describe an area. It should not automatically describe a person. A local assignment may be limited in size without being limited in dignity. A division may be one part of a city without being unimportant. A public servant may be known by fewer people without being less valuable.

Visibility is not the same as significance.

The platform that later became connected to Balimwezo's rise could not have created his earlier work. It could only provide another setting in which that work and experience met a new opportunity. The person and the platform were both necessary to the later outcome.

This is why the story cannot be told as if the door did everything.

Doors matter. So do the people who prepare to walk through them.

Bobi Wine's entry into politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and his later building of the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform created

an opening that did not exist in the same form before. But the opening did not tell Balimwezo how to carry responsibility. It did not give him a history in engineering, lecturing, or local government. Those parts of the story belonged to him.

The platform widened the possibility.

Balimwezo's work gave the possibility a person who could carry it.

We should not make this sound more mechanical than it was. People are not tools placed into structures. A platform does not "use" a person in the way a machine uses a part. A person brings judgment, agency, and responsibility. The point is that opportunities are shaped by both the room and the person who enters it.

This is true of careers, relationships, institutions, and communities.

The same invitation can produce different results in different people. A new role can reveal strengths that were difficult to see before. It can also expose areas where the person needs growth. An opportunity is not a guarantee of perfection. It is a chance to serve at a new level of responsibility.

Balimwezo's later position as Lord Mayor should therefore be understood as a continuation and expansion of public service, not as a replacement for the work that came before. The engineer, lecturer, local government servant, division mayor, and MP are all part of the public story. The Lord Mayor is the latest visible role in the record, not the only meaningful one.

This way of seeing also changes how we recognize people around us.

We may know someone only by what they are doing today. We may not see how their current work is shaping their judgment or preparing them for responsibilities we cannot yet imagine. We may overlook the person because their role seems too local, too technical, or too ordinary.

Pay attention before the wider platform appears.

The person who is serving quietly does not need us to predict their future. They need us to recognize their present. They need fair treatment, honest feedback, and appreciation that is not dependent on later success.

A person can be honoured for the work they are doing now without being promised a bigger title later.

That is a more truthful kind of encouragement.

It also leaves room for surprise. If we tell someone exactly what they will become, we may accidentally limit them to our imagination. If we say, “I see the care and competence you are bringing to this responsibility,” we honour what is real and leave the future open.

The future is God’s territory.

The present is where we meet one another.

Balimwezo’s public story gives us a clear example of that meeting. Years of engineering, lecturing, and local government service preceded a wider citywide responsibility. A political platform built after Bobi Wine’s 2017 decision later became connected to the opportunity. The public result arrived in January 2026, followed by the May swearing-in.

The door opened at a particular time.

But the work before it had already been happening.

This is why no season should be dismissed too quickly. The work may be forming competence. It may be deepening patience. It may be teaching a person how to serve people whose names will never appear in a later headline. It may be building the kind of responsibility that cannot be learned from public attention alone.

We cannot know exactly what every season is doing.

We can decide not to waste it.

Use the present responsibility honestly. Learn from the people in front of you. Let the work make you more dependable rather than merely more ambitious. Appreciate others who are serving in roles the world has not learned to celebrate.

If a wider door opens, be ready to enter with humility. If it does not, the work will still have mattered.

The door is not the only proof that preparation was real.

The work itself is evidence that you were entrusted with something.

Ronald Balimwezo's path from civil engineering and lecturing through local government, the mayorship of Nakawa Division, parliamentary service, and finally the Lord Mayorship of Kampala cannot be reduced to one moment. It is a public sequence in which different responsibilities gathered around one person over time.

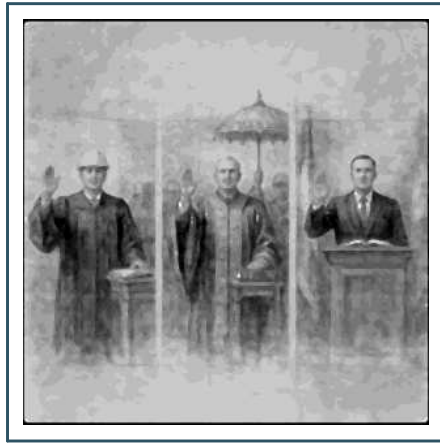
The platform mattered. The opportunity mattered. The person's earlier work mattered.

That is the story before the story's wider opening.

What responsibility are you carrying today that you are tempted to **dismiss because it has not yet revealed what it may prepare you to do?**

CHAPTER 4

The Voice Behind the Microphone



Joel Ssenyonyi's story begins before Parliament.

Before he became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament, before he won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat, his professional identity was that of a journalist. His first public language was not parliamentary procedure or legislative debate. It was journalism.

That starting point matters because public life is often described through its final titles. Once a person holds a senior position, earlier work can seem like a distant preface. The title becomes the centre of the story, and the professional life that came before it is treated as something the person simply left behind.

But people carry earlier work into later rooms.

A new public role does not erase the voice a person learned to use before entering it.

A new public role does not erase the voice a person learned to use before entering it.

Ssenyonyi was a journalist before entering politics. That fact gives the beginning of his story a clear shape, but it does not tell us everything about his experience. We do not know every assignment he held, every story he covered, or every private reason he later entered political life. The available facts do not support invented scenes or imagined motives.

What they do show is a movement between forms of public communication.

He came in as spokesperson for People Power, Bobi Wine's movement, before it became the National Unity Platform. That role placed him in a public position connected to a movement that was becoming a political platform. The journalist became a spokesperson. The voice behind the microphone entered a new kind of public conversation.

The change was significant, but it was not a complete break.

Journalism and political spokesperson work are not the same assignment. They carry different responsibilities and operate within different structures. Yet both involve communication with a public audience. Both require a person to work with information, language, and public attention. The skills may not transfer automatically, but the earlier experience can become relevant in a new setting.

This is the kind of transition that is easy to misunderstand from a distance.

A person moves from one field into another, and observers describe the move as though the earlier field no longer matters. They may say that the person "became political," as if the previous identity disappeared at the doorway. But a change of role is not necessarily a loss of history.

Ssenyonyi entered political life with journalism behind him.

The sequence is important. He did not begin as a parliamentarian. He came into the movement as its spokesperson before it became NUP. Later, he won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021. In January 2024, he became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The later position was not the starting point.

It was part of a progression through different responsibilities.

The word “progression” should not be mistaken for inevitability. We do not know whether each stage was planned from the beginning. We should not claim that journalism was deliberately chosen as preparation for parliamentary leadership unless the record establishes that. The facts simply show that the roles came in sequence.

A narrative can be clear without pretending that the future was obvious.

That is especially important in stories about public figures. The temptation is to read backward and say that everything pointed toward the final role. Journalism becomes a

direct route to spokesperson work. Spokesperson work becomes a direct route to Parliament. Parliament becomes a direct route to the Leader of Opposition’s office.

But the person living through each stage would have encountered the next responsibility as a new responsibility.

The public can arrange the roles after the fact. The individual still has to carry them one at a time.

Ssenyonyi’s movement into the People Power platform placed him inside a public structure that was itself changing. Bobi Wine had entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. Ssenyonyi came in as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP.

This gave his entry a particular context.

He was not entering an already settled career ladder. He was joining a platform whose later shape was still developing. The movement’s evolution

formed part of the public environment in which his own role took shape.

Again, the platform did not make him a journalist. It did not give him the experience he had already gained. It gave his communication skills a new setting and a new public responsibility.

That distinction will matter throughout this book.

A platform can create a room, but it cannot decide how every person will use the room. It can make an opportunity available, but the person who receives the opportunity must still carry the work. It can connect people from different backgrounds, but it cannot make their stories identical.

Ssenyonyi's background was journalism. Ronald Balimwezo's included civil engineering, lecturing, and local government service. The two men later became connected to the same platform, but they did not enter it from the same place.

This difference is most visible when we look at their routes.

Balimwezo had been in local government since 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. Ssenyonyi entered public political life as spokesperson for People Power. Balimwezo's earlier work was connected to local government and engineering. Ssenyonyi's earlier work was connected to journalism and public communication.

The roles were different before the outcomes became different.

Balimwezo would later win Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and would be sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026. Ssenyonyi would win Nakawa West in 2021 and become Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament in January 2024.

The same platform did not send them toward the same office.

That is not a contradiction. It is the central feature of the story.

A platform becomes meaningful through the people who bring different capacities into it. If every person arrived with the same history and moved toward the same role, the platform would reveal very little beyond its own design. The contrast between Ssenyonyi and Balimwezo shows something

more human: a shared opening can meet different people differently.

The journalist did not become an engineer.

The engineer did not become a journalist.

Their earlier professional identities remained part of what they carried into public responsibility, even as the responsibilities changed.

We should not overstate the transfer between journalism and political communication. They are related in some ways, but they are not interchangeable. A journalist's work has its own standards and responsibilities. A spokesperson works within a movement's public communication. The fact that one person moved from one role to another does not erase the distinction between them.

It does show that a person can bring experience from one field into a new public setting.

That is a useful way to think about career changes generally. People are not empty when they change direction. They carry methods, habits, and lessons that may become useful in a new role. Sometimes the connection is obvious. Sometimes it becomes visible only after the new role begins.

The earlier work may not have been designed for the later office, but it may still have prepared the person for parts of its responsibility.

This is why the title "the voice behind the microphone" is not meant to reduce Ssenyonyi to one image. It points to a starting point. Journalism placed him in a professional world where public information and communication mattered. His later role as spokesperson placed those capacities within a movement. His parliamentary career placed him in another public setting altogether.

The voice moved rooms.

The room changed each time.

A journalist communicates through one structure. A spokesperson communicates through another. A member of Parliament carries a representative role. The Leader of Opposition carries a parliamentary leadership role. These are distinct positions, even when communication

remains part of the work.

The changes in title tell us that public responsibility expanded and shifted over time. They do not tell us every thought behind the changes. They do not let us invent private motivations. They give us a sequence that can be followed carefully.

That sequence begins with journalism.

Then came the role as spokesperson for People Power, before it became NUP. That step connected Ssenyonyi to the same broader platform through which Balimwezo later won the Kampala Lord Mayor race. The two men did not meet the platform with identical backgrounds, but their paths became part of the same public story.

This is where a door can be seen from the inside.

From one side, it may look like a platform waiting for people to enter. From the other, it may look like a chance to carry familiar skills into a new setting. The builder sees the structure. The traveller sees the opening. The person who enters may not know how many others will follow or what later responsibilities may become possible.

Ssenyonyi's entry as spokesperson was one stage in that process.

We should not treat the role as merely a bridge to his later parliamentary leadership. It was a real responsibility in its own right. People often diminish earlier roles by describing them only in relation to what came later. But a spokesperson is not important merely because the person may later become an MP. The work mattered while it was being done.

This is true of every stage in a public life.

A person does not need to hold the final title for the current responsibility to be real. A journalist does not need to become a politician for journalism to matter. A spokesperson does not need to become Leader of Opposition for the communication role to carry weight. A parliamentary seat does not need to lead to a senior office for representation to be significant.

The later story should not swallow the earlier one.

Ssenyonyi's 2021 victory in Nakawa West came after his work as a journalist and spokesperson. The January 2024 appointment as Leader of Opposition came after the parliamentary seat. Each step created a new context, but each also rested on a history that preceded it.

The record is not a set of disconnected titles.

It is a sequence of public responsibilities.

This way of reading the story also helps us recognize people before their later roles become visible. The person speaking for a movement may later carry a parliamentary responsibility. The person serving in local government may later carry a citywide office. We cannot assume the final outcome, but we can refuse to treat the current role as insignificant simply because it is not the largest one.

That is where appreciation enters the narrative.

Appreciation does not require us to predict that a journalist will become a leader. It asks us to respect the journalist's work while it is being done. It does not require us to know whether a spokesperson will later win a seat. It asks us to recognize the responsibility of public communication now.

The present deserves accurate attention.

This matters because people often need to move through several rooms before they find the responsibility that becomes most visible. If we dismiss every room except the final one, we misunderstand the journey. We may also discourage the people still carrying earlier responsibilities.

Ssenyonyi's story is not only about where he ended up. It is about the public roles through which he passed.

Balimwezo's story is not only about becoming Lord Mayor. It is about engineering, lecturing, local government, the Nakawa Division mayorship, parliamentary service, and the later citywide office. The two stories will continue to unfold in parallel, but their parallel does not mean sameness.

One path begins in journalism.

The other begins in engineering and local government.

The shared platform comes later.

By the time the two paths are visible together, each man has already been shaped by work that existed before the platform. The opportunity matters, but so does the preparation that meets it. The door opens, but the traveller brings a history through it.

That is what the microphone reveals.

A public voice is never only the moment in which it becomes widely heard. It has a history. It has earlier rooms. It has responsibilities that may never receive the same attention as the later title.

Joel Ssenyonyi entered political life with journalism behind him. He became spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP. He later won Nakawa West in 2021 and became Leader of Opposition in January 2024.

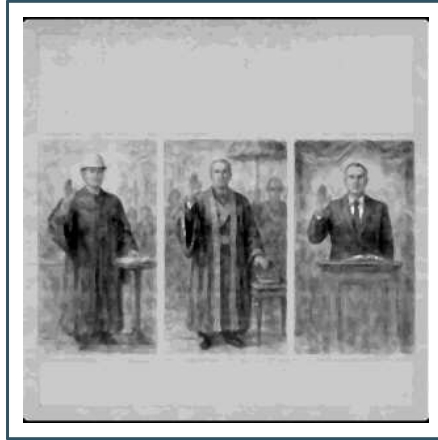
The future was not visible in the first room.

But the first room still mattered.

What part of someone's present work are you overlooking because you are waiting to see what they become later?

CHAPTER 5

A Platform Takes Shape



The first decision in this story belonged to Bobi Wine. In 2017, he entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election. The decision changed his own public life, but it did not remain contained there. He built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform, creating a political platform through which other people later entered public responsibility.

The important word is later.

Platforms do not reveal their full purpose at the moment they are created. They begin with an idea, a decision, or a group of people willing to make room for something that does not yet have a settled shape. Only over time does it become clear who will use the space and what different abilities will bring into it.

A platform becomes visible through the people who find room on it.

Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi came to the platform from different professional worlds. Balimwezo was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. Ssenyonyi was a journalist before entering politics and came in as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP.

Neither background was created by the platform. Each man brought his own history. The platform created a setting in which those histories could meet new public responsibilities.

This is where the story must remain precise. A political platform is not a machine that produces offices. It can create an avenue, but it cannot replace preparation, judgment, or work. It can make a chance possible, but it cannot carry a person through every responsibility after the chance arrives.

Balimwezo would later win Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 on the NUP ticket and be sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026. Ssenyonyi would win the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021 and become Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament in January 2024, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The outcomes were different because the people, roles, and routes were different.

A platform can hold difference without erasing it. That may be one of its most important functions. The engineer and the journalist did not need to become identical in order to enter the same public structure. Their earlier work remained part of what they carried into the new setting.

The platform also changed the meaning of opportunity. Before an opening exists, ability may remain local or disconnected from public office. After an opening exists, a person

may be invited to carry familiar skills into a new room. The invitation does not prove that the person will succeed. It gives them a chance to demonstrate responsibility in a different setting.

This is why appreciation belongs in the story. The people who build platforms often cannot know everyone who will later benefit. They may make a decision for reasons that are personal to them, then discover that the decision created room for others. The later traveller may be grateful even though the original builder could not have had that traveller in mind.

The connection is not always planned.

That does not make it less real.

A decision can create a platform. A platform can create opportunity. Opportunity can meet preparation. Preparation can become responsibility. The sequence is not mechanical, and it is not guaranteed. But it is one way lives become connected across time.

Bobi Wine's decision in 2017 began the platform's story. Balimwezo and Ssenyonyi became part of its later story. The builder did not determine every outcome, and the travellers did not arrive empty-handed.

The platform took shape through what each person brought to it.

What platform, relationship, or earlier decision has created room for you,
and how are you using that room responsibly?

CHAPTER 6

The Engineer's Longer Road



Ronald Balimwezo's route into the Lord Mayorship of Kampala did not begin with the Lord Mayor's office.

It began with work that had its own identity. He was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division.

Those years form the longer road beneath the later title.

A public office can make earlier responsibilities look like preparation alone. Once the final role is visible, people often read backward and arrange every previous step into a neat line. Engineering becomes a beginning. Lecturing becomes another stage. Local government becomes the bridge. The later office appears to have been waiting at the end of the sequence.

But the work was not only valuable because of what came later.

The road matters even when the destination changes its meaning.

Balimwezo's service in Nakawa Division was a real public responsibility. The division was not merely a rehearsal space for a future office. The work had value where it was performed, among the people and responsibilities of that setting. The fact that he later served at a wider citywide level does not make the earlier role less important.

This matters because readers often measure their own work by its reach. If an assignment affects fewer people, they decide it must matter less. If an office carries less public attention, they assume the person holding it has less significance. But reach and value are not identical.

A local responsibility can be carried with seriousness. A technical profession can form habits that become useful in public work. A lecturer can develop a way of explaining, organizing, or listening that later matters in another room. We should not claim exact private lessons that have not been documented. We can observe that Balimwezo's professional and public roles preceded his later office.

His path also included parliamentary service. He was an MP from 2021 to 2026. Then, in January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The movement from one responsibility to another was not a single leap. It was a sequence.

Each step altered the setting. Each role carried a different scale of public responsibility. The fact that the later office was more visible does not mean the earlier roles were empty. It means that a person can carry experience through several rooms before entering the one most people remember.

This is also why opportunity should not be confused with invention. The NUP ticket provided a political route, but it did not create Balimwezo's engineering background, lecturing, or years in local government. His preparation met an opportunity that came through a platform built after Bobi Wine's 2017 decision.

Both parts of the story matter.

Without preparation, an opening may be difficult to carry. Without an opening, preparation may remain confined to the place where it began. People need both the capacity to serve and the chance to use that capacity more widely.

Balimwezo's public thanks to Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance" captures this relationship. The statement does not erase his own work. It recognizes that ability and opportunity are different things.

A person may be ready and still need a door.

A door may open and still require the person to do the work.

That is the longer road: service before visibility, preparation before recognition, and responsibility continuing after opportunity arrives.

Which part of your own longer road have you undervalued because it has **not yet led to the role others can easily recognize?**

CHAPTER 7

The Spokesperson



Joel Ssenyonyi entered politics through public communication.

Before entering politics, he was a journalist. He later came in as spokesperson for People Power, Bobi Wine's movement, before it became the National Unity Platform.

The role of spokesperson placed him in a public position, but it did not erase the professional identity that came before it. Journalism was part of the history he carried into the movement. The voice that had worked in one setting now had to serve another.

That change is significant because communication is never only about speaking. It is also about responsibility: what is said, what is clarified, what is represented, and how a public audience receives information. We should not invent the details of Ssenyonyi's work or private motives. We can say that his route moved from journalism into the public communication of People

Power.

*A person may change rooms without losing the lessons of the room
behind them.*

Ssenyonyi's role as spokesperson came before the movement became NUP. That timing matters. He entered during a period when the platform itself was developing. He was not stepping onto a settled ladder with every later stage already named. He became part of a public structure whose later form was still ahead.

This is one way people find themselves in history. A person accepts a role that is real in the present without knowing what the structure will become. The work must still be carried even when the future is not fully defined.

Later, Ssenyonyi won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021. In January 2024, he became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The later office should not swallow the earlier one. Ssenyonyi was not a spokesperson only because the role led somewhere else. He was a spokesperson because that was the public responsibility he carried at that stage. The parliamentary roles came later and brought different expectations.

This distinction protects the dignity of beginnings.

A beginning does not have to resemble the conclusion. Journalism does not look identical to parliamentary leadership. A spokesperson's role is not the same as an MP's

role. The connection between them may be seen in the person's movement through public communication, but the responsibilities remain distinct.

The story also shows why a person's earlier profession should not be treated as irrelevant once a political role appears. People carry experience into new settings. A journalist may bring habits of public explanation. A civil engineer may bring experience from technical work and local government. The later setting does not erase the earlier one; it creates a new place in which

earlier experience may become useful.

This does not make the transfer automatic. No professional history guarantees a later office. No platform guarantees a particular result. The point is narrower: people do not enter opportunity empty-handed.

Ssenyonyi's path also illustrates the importance of being seen before the final title exists. The journalist came before the spokesperson. The spokesperson came before the MP. The MP came before the Leader of Opposition.

Each role was part of the record.

The sequence reminds us to appreciate present responsibility rather than waiting for a later title to make the person visible. A person does not become worthy of respect only after reaching the highest role in a sequence. The work matters at every stage, even when the wider public pays uneven attention.

The voice behind the microphone became a voice in Parliament. That is not a complete explanation of Joel Ssenyonyi, but it is a clear account of movement between public roles.

What earlier skill or identity are you carrying into your present work, and have you given it enough respect?

CHAPTER 8

The Same Platform



By themselves, the stories of Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi look unrelated.

One is a civil engineer and lecturer who entered local government in 2006 and served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. The other was a journalist before entering politics and came in as spokesperson for People Power.

Their professional histories point in different directions.

Then the shared platform becomes visible.

Bobi Wine entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. Ssenyonyi entered as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP. Balimwezo later won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket.

The connection does not make the two men identical. It makes their differences more revealing.

A shared platform does not require shared beginnings.

This is what the same platform made possible: not one kind of person, but more than one kind. Balimwezo brought engineering, lecturing, local government, and parliamentary experience. Ssenyonyi brought journalism, public communication, a parliamentary seat, and later parliamentary leadership.

Their backgrounds did not disappear when the platform connected them. The platform became a setting in which different histories could meet a new public opportunity.

This is important because organizations are often described as though they are the main actors and people are only names placed inside them. But a platform is made meaningful by the people who bring their own capacities into it. A structure can create room, but the people inside the room still carry responsibility.

Balimwezo's later path led to the Lord Mayorship of Kampala. Ssenyonyi's led to the Leader of Opposition's office in the 12th Parliament. The outcomes were not interchangeable. The roles were not interchangeable. The histories were not interchangeable.

The opening was shared.

That is enough to create a meaningful parallel.

A person may enter a platform because of one kind of experience and later be asked to carry another kind of responsibility. The movement may provide an opening, but the person must still respond to the demands of the role. No platform can replace preparation. No preparation can force an opportunity into existence.

The two stories therefore meet at a point of tension. Individual work matters, but so does access. Personal ability matters, but so does the room in which ability can be used. Public responsibility belongs to the individual, but

the possibility of receiving it can depend on structures larger than the individual.

This is not a political argument. It is a human observation.

People need opportunities that fit their capacity. They also need time to develop capacity before opportunity arrives. A journalist and an engineer may both be ready to serve, but not in the same way. A platform that has room for difference may allow each person to contribute without forcing either to become a copy of the other.

The same platform can therefore produce different stories without contradicting itself.

The difference between the men also helps us resist simple explanations of public success. We cannot say that one professional background guarantees a particular office. We cannot say that the platform alone explains everything. We can say that two people from different starting points became connected through an opening that followed Bobi Wine's earlier political decision.

The door was shared.

The work remained personal.

Where have you mistaken belonging to the same community for needing to become the same kind of person?

CHAPTER 9

The 2021 Crossroads



The year 2021 became an important point in both men's public paths, though not in the same way.

Ronald Balimwezo's service as mayor of Nakawa Division had ended in 2021 after a period that began in 2011. He served as an MP from 2021 to 2026. Joel Ssenyonyi won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021.

The same year therefore placed both men in parliamentary roles, but their routes into public responsibility remained different.

Balimwezo arrived with years of local government experience, along with his background as a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. Ssenyonyi arrived after working as a journalist and serving as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP.

The same year can mark different beginnings for different people.

The same year can mark different beginnings for different people.

It is tempting to read a date as though it carries one universal meaning. But dates become significant through the lives attached to them. For Balimwezo, 2021 marked a move from the Nakawa Division mayorship into parliamentary service. For Ssenyonyi, it marked his victory in Nakawa West.

The year became a crossroads, not because the two men took identical roads, but because their paths moved into parliamentary public life within the same period.

This is where the shared platform becomes more concrete. People Power had become NUP, and both men's later public roles were connected to the platform in different ways. Ssenyonyi had entered as spokesperson before the change. Balimwezo later won on the NUP ticket.

The sequence should be described without making it sound predetermined. The record tells us what roles came when. It does not tell us that either man possessed a complete map of what would follow. A date can be a turning point without being an explanation of every later event.

The 2021 crossroads also shows the difference between public office and personal identity. A parliamentary role can become part of a person's public life, but it does not erase the work that preceded it. Balimwezo's engineering and local government service remained part of his history. Ssenyonyi's journalism and spokesperson role remained part of his route.

We often ask people to leave their earlier selves behind when they enter a new room. We want a clean break because it makes the story easier to tell. But a person's past work may be precisely what helps them understand the new responsibility.

That does not mean that every earlier skill transfers perfectly. It means that no one begins again from nothing.

The 2021 moment also carries a lesson about appreciation. Public attention tends to gather around the new title, but the years before the title still matter. The local government service before parliamentary work

matters. The journalism before public political communication matters. The spokesperson role before parliamentary leadership matters.

A person should not have to reach the next stage before the current stage is respected.

This is true in our own lives. We may be living through a transition and feel that the previous season has become irrelevant. We may be impatient with the work that no longer appears to define us. But earlier responsibilities often remain part of how we carry later ones.

The same year can hold an ending and a beginning. One role can close while another opens. A person can leave one form of public service and enter another. Someone else can begin a new role from a different professional history.

The crossroads does not tell us that all roads are the same.

It tells us that lives can meet at the same time without losing their distinct direction.

What earlier season of your life are you treating as irrelevant, even though it may still be shaping how you carry today's responsibility?

CHAPTER 10

The Leader of Opposition



In January 2024, Joel Ssenyonyi became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The title marked another change in the scale and form of his public responsibility. It came after his earlier work as a journalist, his role as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP, and his 2021 victory in the Nakawa West parliamentary seat.

The sequence matters because leadership rarely begins with the final title.

A title may arrive in one moment, but responsibility usually has a longer history.

Ssenyonyi's route into the office was not the same as Balimwezo's route toward the Lord Mayorship. Balimwezo's public path included engineering, lecturing, local government

beginning in 2006, the Nakawa Division mayorship from 2011 to 2021, and parliamentary service from 2021 to 2026. Ssenyonyi's path included journalism, spokesperson work, the Nakawa West seat, and then parliamentary leadership.

The comparison is useful because it shows that public responsibility can grow through different kinds of experience.

A journalist can move into political communication and later parliamentary leadership. An engineer and local government servant can move toward a citywide mayoral office. Neither path is a guarantee for anyone else. The point is that the route to responsibility is not always shaped by one professional background.

Ssenyonyi's appointment as Leader of Opposition also demonstrates the importance of sequence without allowing sequence to become a prophecy. The fact that he held earlier roles before the appointment does not mean that every earlier role existed only to produce the later office. Journalism was real work. Spokesperson was real work. The Nakawa West seat was real responsibility.

The final title gathered those stages into a public narrative, but it did not make them disposable.

This is a common mistake when we tell stories about leaders. We focus so intensely on the office that the person's earlier work becomes a footnote. Then we ask why other people have not yet reached the same place, forgetting that they may be carrying a different sequence entirely.

A person's route can be long without being wasted.

The public record does not give us every detail of Ssenyonyi's inner experience, and we should not invent it. We can say that his responsibilities changed over time. He moved from journalism into spokesperson work, then into Parliament, and later into parliamentary leadership.

That movement involved opportunity, but also acceptance of responsibility. A title does not perform the work on its own. The person who receives the title must still inhabit it, answer for it, and carry its weight.

The story also raises the question of how we appreciate people who are still in earlier stages. If we only respect the Leader of Opposition, we may fail to respect the journalist. If we only respect the final office, we may miss the preparation that made the transition possible.

The person before the title is not a lesser person.

This should change how we speak about those around us. We can honour someone's present role without predicting their future. We can say that a person communicates clearly, serves carefully, or accepts responsibility without declaring that they will one day hold a particular office.

Appreciation is not a forecast.

It is attention to what is already true. Appreciation is not a forecast. It is attention to what is already true.

Ssenyonyi's public path became more visible in January 2024, but the path did not begin in that month. The title was new. The history was not.

Whose current responsibility are you overlooking because you are **waiting for the title that might come later?**

CHAPTER 11

The Lord Mayor's Race



In January 2026, Ronald Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. In May 2026, he was sworn in as Lord Mayor.

The result marked the most visible office in his public story so far, but it did not mark the beginning of his service. Balimwezo had been in local government since 2006. He had served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. He was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had served as an MP from 2021 to 2026.

The race was a public moment. The preparation was distributed across years.

A visible result often rests on an invisible accumulation of responsibility.

It is easy to describe an election result as a sudden change. One day, a person is known in one role; the next, the public is asked to see them in another. But public recognition often arrives after a history that has already been developing.

Balimwezo's win connected that history to a wider citywide office. The NUP ticket formed part of the opportunity through which he won. The platform's origin reached back to Bobi Wine's entry into politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and his building of the People Power movement into NUP.

The sequence contains both continuity and change.

The continuity lies in Balimwezo's public service before the race. The change lies in the scale of the office he entered after the result. A local government veteran became Lord Mayor. An engineer and lecturer carried his earlier professional history into a wider public responsibility.

The result should not be used to erase the complexity of the path. We do not know every private thought, expectation, or fear involved in the race. We should not invent scenes around it. The public facts are sufficient: he won in January 2026, the win ended Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and he was sworn in in May 2026.

The story's meaning is not found in political commentary. It is found in the meeting of preparation and opportunity.

Balimwezo publicly thanked Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance." The phrase matters in this chapter because it places the public result inside a

relationship between ability and access. The chance did not create the years of service. The years of service did not make the chance unnecessary.

Both are part of the story.

This is true beyond public office. Many people are prepared for responsibilities they cannot yet access. Others receive access before they feel

fully prepared. The task is to keep developing, to accept appropriate responsibility, and to appreciate the people who make room without claiming ownership of the whole result.

The Lord Mayor's race therefore becomes more than a final event. It becomes a point from which earlier years can be seen differently. The local work remains local, but it is no longer the only part of the public story. The engineer, lecturer, local government servant, mayor of Nakawa Division, and MP are now connected to the Lord Mayorship.

The door opened at a visible moment.

The person had been walking toward responsibility for much longer.

When someone near you reaches a visible milestone, will you remember **and honour the less visible responsibilities that came before it?**

CHAPTER 12

Two Doors, Different Rooms



Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi walked through the same broad platform into different forms of public responsibility.

Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 on the NUP ticket and was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026. Ssenyonyi won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021 and became Leader of Opposition in the 12th Parliament in January 2024, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The offices were different. The timing was different. The routes were different.

Yet both stories belong to the same larger account of opportunity.

One door can lead to different rooms without becoming a different door.

One door can lead to different rooms without becoming a different door.

This is a useful way to think about shared platforms. A platform is not valuable because it guarantees identical outcomes. It is valuable because it can create space for people with different histories to carry different responsibilities.

Balimwezo came through engineering, lecturing, local government, and parliamentary service. Ssenyonyi came through journalism, spokesperson work, and Parliament. Their backgrounds were not interchangeable, and their later offices were not interchangeable.

The shared connection does not flatten the difference. It makes the difference visible.

That visibility challenges the habit of treating people as products of one structure. We may say that a platform produced a mayor or a parliamentary leader, but people are not manufactured by platforms. They bring capacity, history, limitations, and responsibility. An opening matters, but so does the person who receives it.

The same opening may also expose different strengths. One person may be prepared through years of local government. Another may be prepared through journalism and public communication. One may carry citywide responsibility. Another may carry parliamentary leadership. The roles ask different things from the people who hold them.

A fair narrative must honour both the platform and the person.

It must also avoid turning the outcomes into a political argument. The focus here is not on praising or criticizing parties, opponents, or Uganda's political situation. The focus is on the human pattern: an opportunity becomes available, and people from different backgrounds enter it with different histories.

The pattern is repeated across ordinary life. A teacher may open a door that two students use in different ways. A family may create conditions in which siblings develop different gifts. A community may offer one

opportunity that becomes a business for one person and a service vocation for another. The same room does not produce the same life.

Difference is not evidence that the opening failed.

It may be evidence that the opening was wide enough.

Balimwezo and Ssenyonyi also show that later responsibility does not cancel earlier identity. The Lord Mayor remained connected to engineering, lecturing, and local government. The Leader of Opposition remained connected to journalism and spokesperson work. Titles add information; they do not tell the whole story.

This matters when we appreciate people. If we only see the office, we may miss the person. If we only see the platform, we may miss the preparation. If we only see the result, we may miss the years in which the person carried responsibility without public confirmation.

Two doors may look similar from a distance. Inside, the rooms demand different work.

The person who enters must learn the room. The people who helped make the door possible must allow the traveller to carry responsibility in a way that is faithful to their own calling.

Whose different path are you tempted to compare unfairly with your own, and what would change if you honoured the room they were given instead?

CHAPTER 13

What the Builder Could Not See



Bobi Wine entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election in 2017.

He later built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform.

At the beginning, he could not have known every person whose public life would later be connected to that platform. He could not have known the full shape of the opportunities that would emerge from the decision. A person making the first move rarely sees the complete chain of consequences.

That is not unusual. It is how human action works.

A decision begins in one moment, but its effects may continue into another. A person creates room without knowing who will use it. A community supports a beginning without knowing what the beginning will become. A friend offers encouragement without knowing whether the

encouragement will remain private or become part of a public story.

The builder sees the first opening; God sees the people who may one day use it.

The platform that grew from Bobi Wine's political entry later became connected to the paths of Ronald Balimwezo and Joel Ssenyonyi. Balimwezo, a civil engineer, lecturer, local government servant, and former mayor of Nakawa Division, eventually won Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 and was sworn in in May 2026. Ssenyonyi, a former journalist and People Power spokesperson, won Nakawa West in 2021 and became Leader of Opposition in January 2024.

The later outcomes do not prove that the entire chain was planned from the beginning. They show that decisions can have reach beyond their original purpose.

This is both comforting and demanding.

It is comforting because our work does not have to produce a visible result immediately in order to matter. We may make a decision whose usefulness will appear only later. We may prepare a room that someone else will use. We may support a person whose future we cannot identify.

It is demanding because our decisions affect more than our private lives. We should take them seriously. We should not assume that no one else will be touched by our

choices. We should not use the uncertainty of the future as an excuse for carelessness in the present.

The story also places a limit on personal credit. A builder matters, but the builder does not own every later result. Bobi Wine's decision and platform formed part of the context for other people's public paths. Balimwezo and Ssenyonyi still carried their own histories and responsibilities. The connection is real without becoming total ownership.

This is a healthier way to understand influence.

Influence is not the ability to control another person's future. It is the ability to affect what becomes possible. Once the possibility exists, another person must still choose, work, adapt, and accept responsibility.

The same is true when we receive help. We should remember who made room for us, as Balimwezo did when he thanked Bobi Wine for "believing in me and giving me a chance." But gratitude should lead to responsible action, not permanent dependence. A chance is honoured by what we do with it.

The builder cannot see everything.

The traveller cannot claim to have built everything.

God alone sees the whole chain.

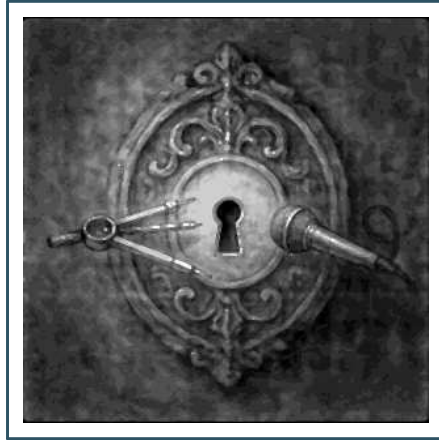
This should make us patient with our own lack of certainty. We do not need to know exactly who will benefit before we do honest work. We do not need to predict every outcome before we encourage someone. We do not need to possess the final story in order to be faithful in the opening scene.

The work is to build what we are responsible to build, appreciate the people already near us, and release the consequences we cannot control.

What are you building now without knowing who may benefit later, and **how can you build it with greater care?**

CHAPTER 14

The Door and the People



This story began with a musician and ends with people.

Bobi Wine entered politics through the Kyadondo East by-election in 2017. He built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform. The platform later became connected to two men whose professional starting points were far apart.

Ronald Balimwezo was a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He had been in local government since 2006, served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021, and was an MP from 2021 to 2026. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Joel Ssenyonyi was a journalist before entering politics. He came in as spokesperson for People Power before it became NUP, won the Nakawa West parliamentary seat in 2021, and became Leader of Opposition in the 12th

Parliament in January 2024, succeeding Mathias Mpuuga.

The platform was shared. The paths were not.

A door matters because people are waiting on the other side of it.

That is the central lesson. We can become fascinated by the builder, the structure, or the public result and forget the human beings for whom opportunity becomes real. A door is not meaningful merely because it exists. It matters because someone can enter it and carry responsibility into a new room.

The story also warns us against waiting for proof before we appreciate people. Balimwezo's later office made his earlier service easier to notice. Ssenyonyi's parliamentary leadership made his earlier journalism and spokesperson work easier to arrange into a clear narrative. But both men had lives and responsibilities before their most visible titles.

The person before the title deserves respect.

This principle reaches beyond public life. We do not know who the people around us will become. We do not know which colleague is developing a capacity that will later help many people. We do not know which young person needs one honest word of encouragement. We do not know which ordinary decision will create a platform for someone else.

We should not turn that uncertainty into fantasy. We should not make promises about people's futures or invent motives behind their choices. We should simply become more attentive to what is already true.

Who is serving faithfully? Who is learning? Who is carrying responsibility without recognition? Who has been reduced to a role that does not describe the whole person? Who needs a chance that is appropriate, honest, and supported?

These questions make appreciation practical.

Appreciation is not a political endorsement. It is not blind loyalty. It is not the refusal to correct or hold accountable. It is the discipline of recognizing a person's dignity and present contribution before a larger audience confirms

it.

A platform can open a door. People must still use the room well. A person can receive a chance and still need to work, learn, and accept responsibility. A builder can create an opening and still need to release control. The story requires all three forms of humility.

We must be humble enough to admit that we need doors. We must be humble enough to thank the people who help us. We must be humble enough to open doors for others without requiring them to remain dependent on us.

That is how opportunity becomes service rather than possession.

The final question is not whether every person will become a mayor or a parliamentary leader. The final question is whether we will treat people as significant before their

future becomes obvious. Will we honour the engineer before the Lord Mayor's office? The journalist before parliamentary leadership? The servant before the public recognition?

The answer will shape the communities we create.

A community that waits for proof becomes skilled at celebrating results and poor at protecting beginnings. A community that appreciates people early gives room for growth without pretending to know the final outcome. It creates doors that are wide enough for different gifts and humble enough not to belong to one person forever.

Bobi Wine could not see every person who would later use the platform connected to his decision. Balimwezo could not see the full meaning of his earlier service while he was living it. Ssenyonyi's final title was not visible from his first professional role.

No one sees the whole story at the beginning.

That is why the person beside you matters now.

Appreciate them before proof. Encourage them without controlling them. Give a fair chance where you can. Carry your own opportunity with gratitude. Leave the door open when it is no longer yours to guard.

You may never know what your obedience makes possible.

You may never know whether your appreciation strengthened someone's courage. You may never see the later room. But you can still be faithful at the doorway.

Who is standing near you with a gift you have not yet learned to recognize, and what will you do before the end of this week to make room for them?

Author's Note

This volume began with a decision and followed the people who came after it.

Bobi Wine's entry into politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election is the opening fact, but it is not the whole story. The larger story is what happened when the platform built through People Power and later NUP became connected to people whose professional histories were very different.

Ronald Balimwezo brought engineering, lecturing, local government service, parliamentary experience, and a long public road into the Lord Mayorship of Kampala. Joel Ssenyonyi brought journalism, spokesperson work, parliamentary representation, and later leadership in the 12th Parliament. Their routes cannot be collapsed into one formula. Their offices are different. Their histories are different. Their shared connection is an opening, not an explanation for everything.

That distinction mattered throughout the writing. These are real people, not characters created to prove a lesson. Where the public record was clear, I followed it. Where it was not clear, I refused to invent private thoughts, motives, scenes, or dialogue. The story is strong enough without them.

What remains is a simple pattern. A person can make a decision whose consequences reach beyond the original moment. A platform can create room for people who did not build it themselves. Preparation can precede recognition by many years. A journalist can become a parliamentary leader. An engineer and local government servant can become Lord Mayor. None of these outcomes makes the earlier work irrelevant.

The most important lesson, however, is about appreciation.

We often wait until the future confirms a person before we honour the present. We wait until the appointment, the victory, the title, or the public attention. By then, appreciation is easy. The harder and more faithful act is to recognize people before their significance is obvious.

I do not mean that we should make careless predictions. We cannot know who will become influential, and we should not turn every person into a project. I mean that we can tell the truth about what we see now. We can honour service while it is still local. We can respect a developing gift. We can offer an appropriate chance without trying to own the result.

The title of this volume points to a door, but the door is not the hero. The people are. The builder matters. The traveller matters. The years before the opening matter. The responsibility after the opening matters.

If these pages have one request, it is this: do not wait for public proof before you appreciate the person beside you. You do not know who is being prepared. You do not know which decision will become useful to someone else. You do not know whether your encouragement will become part of another person's courage.

Make room where you can. Thank the people who made room for you. Carry your own opportunity faithfully. Then let the door serve more people than you first imagined.

Muhumuza Bright Andrew



VOLUME THREE

KINGMAKER

What Bobi Wine's Politics Reveals About How God Lifts People

BRYT MA TECH UGANDA

VOLUME THREE
KINGMAKER

What Bobi Wine's Politics Reveals About How God Lifts People

Before You Begin

Three people. Three different fields. One repeating pattern.

This book studies that pattern closely, but it is not really about politics, and it is not really about any one of the three men in it. It is about a door that keeps opening for people who did not build it themselves, and what that might mean for the door standing in front of you right now.

Read each case study on its own terms first. The pattern will become visible on its own; you will not need to be told what to see.

CHAPTER 1

The Pattern Before the Explanation



There is a pattern here that becomes clearer when several lives are placed beside each other.

Ronald Balimwezo is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He has been in local government since 2006, served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021, became an MP from 2021 to 2026, and won Kampala's Lord Mayor race in January 2026 on the NUP ticket. He was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

Ali Bukeni, known as Nubian Li, is a singer and long-time creative partner of Bobi Wine. In January 2026, he was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division after defeating incumbent Paul Mugambe. At his 2021 wedding, Bobi Wine publicly stated that without Nubian Li's encouragement, he might never have

contested the 2017 Kyadondo East by- election that began his own political career.

Hussein Muyonjo, known as Swengere, is a comedian and radio presenter at Baba FM, well known across eastern Uganda. He had no prior political career. He won the NUP ticket for Jinja North Division ahead of 2026 after the sitting MP withdrew and

endorsed him. He then won the general seat, defeating 13 other candidates, with 19,427 votes.

Three people. Three professional histories. Three different forms of public responsibility.

The connecting thread is Bobi Wine's political platform. He entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built the People Power movement into the National Unity Platform.

A pattern becomes visible when we stop asking who is most important and start asking what the stories share.

This is not an argument that one person mechanically produces another person's success. Balimwezo had years of public service. Nubian Li had a musical career and a long creative partnership with Bobi Wine. Swengere had a public identity built through comedy and radio. Each person brought a different history to the opportunity.

The pattern is narrower and more useful. A person can develop influence in one field, encounter a new platform, and carry that influence into another form of responsibility. A friend can encourage a decision that changes public history. A local servant can receive a wider office. A comedian can move from entertainment into Parliament.

The theological question is not whether every result was secretly predetermined. The question is what we learn when preparation, appreciation, and opportunity meet.

This book will study that meeting. It will not invent motives that are not documented. It will not turn political figures into heroes or villains. It will not

comment on Uganda's political situation beyond the supplied facts. It will ask what the lives reveal about how God lifts people through other people, through platforms, and through doors whose future users cannot be known in advance.

The first lesson is humility. We rarely see the complete story while we are living one part of it. Bobi Wine could not know every person who would later use the platform he built. Nubian Li could not know, when he encouraged a friend toward politics, how that encouragement would be remembered. Balimwezo could not know, during his local government years, that a later opening would lead to the Lord Mayorship. Swengere could not script a radio career into a parliamentary seat.

The second lesson is appreciation. We often wait until a person's significance is obvious. God's work invites a different posture. Recognize the singer before the office. Respect the engineer before the citywide title. Honour the comedian before the parliamentary result.

The third lesson is responsibility. A door does not carry the traveller. A platform does not replace character. A chance must still be used faithfully.

This is the pattern beneath the stories: influence can cross fields, opportunity can travel beyond its origin, and appreciation can become part of the chain by which a life reaches its next responsibility.

What pattern in the lives around you might become visible if you looked beyond people's current titles?

CHAPTER 2

Case Study One: The Engineer Who Became a Mayor



Ronald Balimwezo's story begins with competence that was not originally political in form.

He is a civil engineer and lecturer at Kyambogo University. He entered local government in 2006. From 2011 to 2021, he served as mayor of Nakawa Division. He was an MP from 2021 to 2026. In January 2026, he won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket, ending Erias Lukwago's 15-year tenure, and he was sworn in as Lord Mayor in May 2026.

The sequence is important because it shows preparation moving across settings.

Engineering is not the same as mayoral office. Lecturing is not the same as city leadership. Local government in one division is not the same as responsibility for Kampala. Yet a person can carry experience from one setting into another. The transfer is not automatic, and it is not a guarantee. It is an opportunity for earlier work to become useful in a wider room.

Competence may need a wider platform, not a different identity.

Balimwezo's later office did not create the earlier work. The Lord Mayorship did not make the engineering or lecturing meaningful for the first time. His years in local government were not merely a waiting room. They were public service in their own right.

This distinction matters for faith study because believers often treat the present as valuable only when it produces a preferred future. We say that a small responsibility matters because it may lead to a large one. But people and communities deserve more respect than that. A local assignment matters while people are receiving its service, whether or not it becomes a step toward wider recognition.

The case therefore gives us two teachings. The first is about preparation. A person may develop through professional work and local responsibility before a larger opportunity appears. The second is about dignity. The earlier work must not be reduced to its later usefulness.

The public record allows us to say that Balimwezo served in local government beginning in 2006, served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021, and later moved through parliamentary service into the Lord Mayorship. It does not allow us to invent his private expectations or claim that he always knew where the path would lead.

That uncertainty is part of the lesson. Preparation is often recognizable only in retrospect. Before the final office appears, the work may look like work. It may not announce itself as a spiritual curriculum.

The platform also matters. Balimwezo won the 2026 Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket. Bobi Wine had entered politics in 2017 and built People Power into NUP. The platform created an opportunity, but it did not provide

Balimwezo's years of engineering, lecturing, local government, or parliamentary experience. The person and the platform met.

This gives us a practical takeaway for small groups: ask members to identify one present responsibility they have been calling insignificant. Then ask them to describe its value without mentioning what it might lead to later. That exercise separates present faithfulness from future ambition.

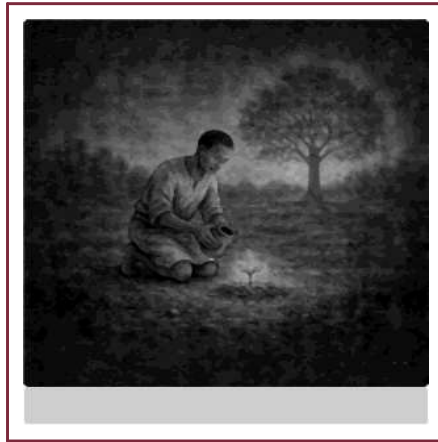
The case also challenges the habit of praising only visible outcomes. Balimwezo's public recognition became wider when he won the Lord Mayor race. But appreciation before that moment would have been more discerning because it would have recognized service without depending on the final title.

The lesson is not that every engineer should become a mayor. It is that no current role completely defines the range of responsibility a person may later carry.

What present work in your life deserves respect even if it never becomes a public title?

CHAPTER 3

Case Study Two: The Friend Who Became a Mayor



Ali Bukeni, known to most as Nubian Li, brings a different kind of case study.

He is a singer and long-time creative partner of Bobi Wine. In January 2026, he was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division after defeating incumbent Paul Mugambe. His story is not only about receiving a later office. It is also about helping another person take an earlier step.

At his 2021 wedding, Bobi Wine publicly stated that without Nubian Li's encouragement, he might never have contested the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election that began his own political career.

That statement gives this case a two-way structure.

Sometimes the person who helps build a door later discovers that the door opens for them too.

Nubian Li's encouragement, as publicly described by Bobi Wine, came before the political platform that later became connected to Nubian Li's own mayoral office. The sequence does not prove that the later office was the purpose of the earlier encouragement. It shows something more surprising: an act that helped another person can become part of the helper's own later story.

This is a direct challenge to transactional thinking. We often help people because we expect a return. We encourage someone because we want access, loyalty, or recognition. But encouragement is most powerful when it is offered without knowledge of its eventual reach.

The public facts do not tell us every detail of Nubian Li's conversation with Bobi Wine, and we should not invent them. We know only the public statement: without Nubian Li's encouragement, Bobi Wine might never have contested the 2017 by-election. That is enough to establish the importance of encouragement without turning it into a manufactured scene.

The case also shows that influence can move in more than one direction. Bobi Wine's decision led to the building of a platform. Later, Nubian Li himself became Mayor of Nakawa Division. The person who encouraged a friend toward politics eventually entered public office through the platform connected to that political beginning.

This is not a neat reward system. We must not teach that every act of encouragement will return to the encourager as success. That would make generosity another investment strategy. The deeper lesson is that service can travel in unexpected directions.

Nubian Li's story also includes hardship in the supplied record: he was jailed for nearly a year following the 2021 campaigns. During that time, his wife, Mutoni Gloria, won a local council seat and was later appointed Deputy Mayor of Nakawa Division. These facts should be handled with dignity and without speculation about private emotions or motives.

The case invites a discussion of endurance, but not a fictional account of what anyone felt. We can say that public responsibility and personal cost can exist in the same story. We can say that the later mayoral office does not erase the difficult parts of the path. We cannot claim more than the record gives us.

For a small group, the practical exercise is simple: ask participants to name one person whose encouragement changed their direction. Then ask whether they have ever encouraged someone without knowing what the act would become. The exercise shifts attention from achievement to relationship.

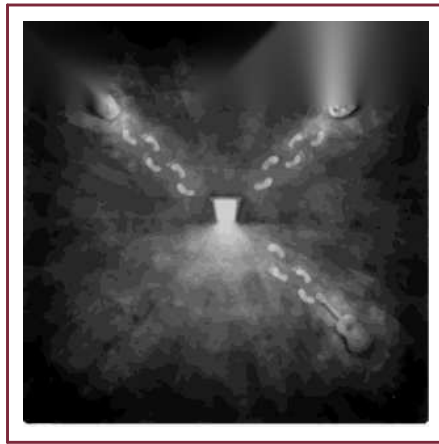
Nubian Li's case also teaches appreciation. Bobi Wine's public acknowledgment names the friend whose encouragement mattered to his political beginning. Such recognition should not be postponed until the friend becomes a mayor. It should be offered because the act was meaningful when it was given.

The friend became a mayor, but that is not the only reason the encouragement matters.

Who encouraged you before the world could see what your next step might become, and have you thanked them without turning the gratitude into a debt?

CHAPTER 4

Case Study Three: The Comedian Who Became an MP



Hussein Muyonjo, known as Swengere, entered public responsibility from yet another direction.

He is a comedian and radio presenter at Baba FM, well known across eastern Uganda. He had no prior political career. Ahead of 2026, he won the NUP ticket for Jinja North Division after the sitting MP withdrew and endorsed him. He then won the general seat, defeating 13 other candidates, with 19,427 votes.

The movement from comedy and radio to Parliament is not a story of one identity replacing another. It is a story of public trust and opportunity

meeting in a new setting, though we must describe that idea carefully and avoid claiming undocumented motives.

A person's public work may prepare trust in one field before responsibility arrives in another.

A person's public work may prepare trust in one field before responsibility arrives in another.

Swengere was well known across eastern Uganda through comedy and radio. That is a documented part of his public identity. The supplied facts do not tell us how every listener interpreted his work, what private ambitions he held, or why he accepted the political opportunity. We should not invent those details.

We can observe the sequence. He had no prior political career. He won the NUP ticket after the sitting MP withdrew and endorsed him. He then won the general seat with 19,427 votes, defeating 13 other candidates.

The sequence shows that a person can enter political office from outside the traditional route of prior political service. It also shows that public familiarity in one field can become relevant when a new opportunity appears. Relevance is not the same as qualification for every responsibility. It means only that a person's earlier public presence may shape how an opportunity is received.

This case is especially useful for small-group discussion because it raises questions about transfer. What can move from comedy and radio into public responsibility? Communication may move. Familiarity may move. A relationship with an audience may matter. But public office also brings responsibilities that cannot be reduced to entertainment.

The case therefore resists both cynicism and romanticism. Cynicism says a comedian has nothing serious to contribute. Romanticism says popularity automatically equals leadership. The documented facts support neither conclusion. They show a comedian

and radio presenter with no prior political career receiving a political opportunity and winning a parliamentary seat.

The spiritual lesson is about not confusing a person's current field with the limit of their usefulness. We often decide that someone belongs only in the role where we first encountered them. We know the singer as a singer, the engineer as an engineer, the comedian as a comedian. Then a new door opens, and we are surprised that their public identity can carry into another kind of responsibility.

Surprise should make us attentive, not careless.

A small group can use this chapter to distinguish three ideas: popularity, trust, and responsibility. They may overlap, but they are not identical. A person may be well known without being ready for every office. A person may be less known and still be capable. A person who receives a chance must still carry the work responsibly.

Swengere's 19,427 votes and victory over 13 other candidates are part of the documented outcome. They do not allow us to invent a broader political analysis. The book's focus remains the personal and spiritual pattern: a public figure from one field crossed into another through a platform and an opportunity.

The case asks us to widen our vision. The person who makes people laugh may also carry ideas about service. The radio presenter may also possess a capacity for public responsibility. We should not assume the future, but we should not close it prematurely.

Whom have you placed permanently inside one role because you have not **imagined what else they may be able to carry?**

CHAPTER 5

The Two-Way Door



The first three case studies do not all move in the same direction.

Balimwezo moved from engineering, lecturing, local government, and parliamentary service into the Lord Mayorship of Kampala. Swengere moved from comedy and radio into Parliament. Nubian Li moved from music and creative partnership into the Mayorship of Nakawa Division, but his story also includes encouraging Bobi Wine toward the political step that began the larger platform.

His case makes the door two-way.

A door can carry help outward and opportunity back toward the person who first offered it.

This does not mean that encouragement is a guaranteed investment. Nubian Li's encouragement did not come with a documented promise of a later mayoral office. The later connection is meaningful because it was not presented as a transaction. One act helped another person enter a new public path; years later, the encourager entered public office himself.

This pattern changes how we understand influence. Influence is not only what a powerful person gives to a less powerful person. It can begin in friendship. It can begin in a sentence. It can begin when one person takes another person's possibility seriously.

The supplied facts say that at Nubian Li's 2021 wedding, Bobi Wine publicly stated that without Nubian Li's encouragement, he might never have contested the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election. We should not add a private conversation around that statement. The public acknowledgment is enough.

The sequence that followed is also documented. Bobi Wine entered politics in 2017 and built People Power into NUP. Nubian Li was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division in January 2026. The connection does not prove that one event caused the other in a simple way. It shows how lives can remain connected across years.

The case is useful in teaching because it corrects two habits. The first is to think only founders matter. The second is to think only officeholders matter. The friend who encourages the first step may be part of the story even before receiving any public title. The later officeholder may still owe part of the story to someone whose role was relational rather than official.

This is why appreciation matters. Public recognition should not begin only when a person becomes visible to a large audience. It should include the people who encouraged, trusted, and made room before the outcome could be measured.

The case also teaches release. If Nubian Li's encouragement had been offered only to secure a future benefit, it would be difficult to call it genuine encouragement. We should not assume his motive. We can say that the publicly documented story presents the encouragement before the later office. The sequence invites us to imagine help that is not controlled by its

eventual result.

For group discussion, ask: when have you helped someone and later benefited from a path that help made possible? Then ask: can you honour the connection without claiming that the later outcome was owed to you?

The two-way door does not make every story symmetrical. Balimwezo, Nubian Li, and Swengere reached different offices through different routes. The point is not sameness. It is that opportunity can move through relationships in more than one direction.

A friend can encourage a public decision. A platform can later create room for the friend. A gift offered outward can become part of an unexpected return.

What help have you given without knowing where it would lead, and can **you remain grateful even if the result returns in a form you never expected?**

CHAPTER 6

Influence Changes Fields



Each case study crosses a boundary.

Balimwezo's background is in civil engineering, lecturing, and local government. Nubian Li's is in singing and creative partnership. Swengere's is in comedy and radio presentation. Their later public roles were mayoral or parliamentary.

The boundary crossing is the teaching point.

Influence does not always stay in the field where it began.

A person's public work can form habits that become useful elsewhere. Engineering may involve disciplined problem-solving. Lecturing may involve explanation and

responsibility. Music may build public connection. Comedy and radio may create familiarity with a broad audience. These statements must remain general; the supplied facts do not document the exact internal skills each person carried or how each person understood them.

Still, the cases show different professional origins meeting one political platform. Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket. Nubian Li was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division. Swengere won the Jinja North Division parliamentary seat with 19,427 votes after defeating 13 other candidates.

The platform did not require one professional background. It became a route through which people from different fields entered public office.

This does not mean professional experience is automatically transferable. Public responsibility asks new things of people. An audience is not the same as a constituency. Popularity is not the same as judgment. Technical competence is not the same as every kind of leadership. A careful study must hold both sides: earlier influence can matter, and new responsibilities still require new learning.

That balance is important for faith communities. We sometimes over-spiritualize difference by saying that a person can do anything if they are called. We sometimes under-spiritualize it by saying that a person can do only what their original profession permits. The case studies suggest a third way: a person may carry something valuable across fields while still needing to grow into the new responsibility.

Bobi Wine's platform made such crossings possible in the documented story. He entered politics in 2017 and built People Power into NUP. Balimwezo, Nubian Li, and Swengere each arrived with different backgrounds and later held different offices.

The question for a small group is not, "Which profession is best?" It is, "What may God be able to use from a person's current field in a new setting?"

That question can help us appreciate people without predicting them. We do not need to say that the radio presenter will become an MP or that the engineer will become a mayor. We can ask what discipline, communication,

creativity, or public connection might become useful if a new door appears.

The cases also challenge our categories. A singer is not only a singer. A comedian is not only a comedian. An engineer is not only an engineer. These descriptions are true, but they are not complete.

A person should not be reduced to the first room in which we met them.

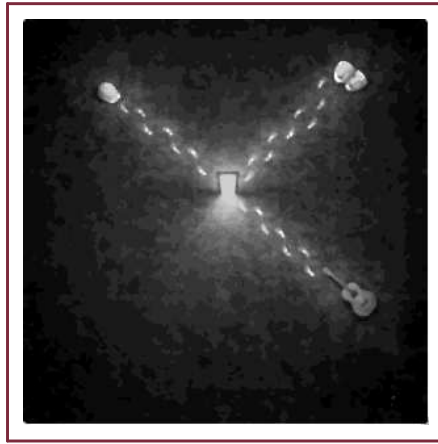
At the same time, we must not use the idea of crossing fields to dismiss preparation. The office still has demands. The person still carries responsibility. An opportunity is not permission to stop learning.

This is the practical takeaway: appreciate transferable gifts, but support continued formation. Make room for people to bring their histories into new settings, and make room for them to learn what the new setting requires.

What strength in someone else's present field could become useful in a different setting, and how can you encourage growth without assuming an outcome?

CHAPTER 7

The Platform Is Not the Person



A platform can open a door. It cannot walk through it. A platform can open a door. It cannot walk through it.

This distinction protects both the platform and the people connected to it. Bobi Wine entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built People Power into NUP. Balimwezo later won the Kampala Lord Mayor race on the NUP ticket. Nubian Li was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division. Swengere won the Jinja North Division parliamentary seat.

The platform forms part of the story. It is not the whole story.

Opportunity creates room; responsibility reveals what a person does with it.

A person may have ability before receiving an opening. A person may receive an opening before the public understands what they can carry. But the opening does not complete the work. The traveller must accept responsibility, learn the room, and serve within the limits of the office.

The supplied facts do not allow us to make judgments about every individual's performance or motives. This book is not evaluating the political work of the officeholders. It is studying the pattern by which people from different backgrounds entered public roles through a shared platform.

This restraint is important. If we praise only the platform, we erase the people's work. If we praise only the people, we erase the opportunity that made the opening possible. A truthful account gives each part its place.

Balimwezo's engineering, lecturing, local government, and parliamentary history mattered. Nubian Li's singing and creative partnership mattered. Swengere's comedy and radio work mattered. The platform mattered too. None of these elements should be treated as sufficient on its own.

The same principle applies to our own lives. We can become overly dependent on the person who opened a door. We can also become overly proud of our own effort and forget the room that allowed it to be seen. Humility remembers both.

For small-group study, this chapter can support an exercise in gratitude. Ask each person to complete two sentences: "I am capable of this because..." and "I had room to do this because..." The first question honours effort. The second honours opportunity. Together, they resist both self-erasure and self-invention.

The platform is not the person, but the person is not independent of every platform. Institutions, relationships, communities, and decisions shape what becomes possible. We should be grateful for the openings we receive and careful with the openings we create.

A platform also has an ethical responsibility. If it creates room for people, it should not reduce them to instruments. They are not merely proof that the platform works. They remain persons with dignity and accountability.

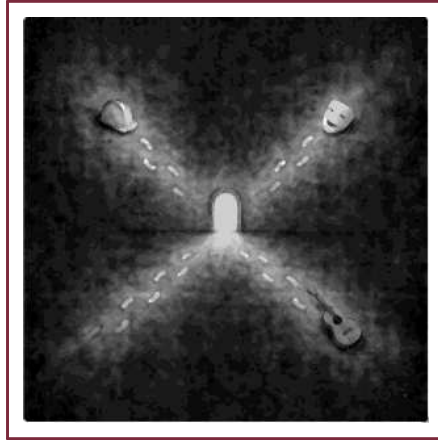
This is why appreciation must accompany opportunity. A person should be seen as more than the role they fill. A platform should be more than a ladder for its founder. The room should serve people rather than possess them.

The case studies make this visible through contrast. An engineer, a singer, and a comedian entered different offices through the same broader platform. Their differences did not disprove the platform. They revealed its reach.

Which opportunity in your life are you tempted to claim as entirely your own, and whose contribution or platform do you need to acknowledge?

CHAPTER 8

Recognition Before Results



The world is comfortable recognizing people after results.

After Balimwezo won Kampala's Lord Mayor race, the public had a clear reason to notice him. After Nubian Li was declared Mayor of Nakawa Division, his political role became visible in a new way. After Swengere won the Jinja North Division seat with 19,427 votes, the outcome could be named and counted.

But recognition after results is easier than appreciation before results.

It takes less faith to celebrate what everyone can already see.

The teaching of these case studies is not that we should predict the future carelessly. We should not announce that every singer will become a mayor or every comedian an MP. We should not promise a person a title God has not

promised.

We can still appreciate what is present.

Balimwezo's years in local government began in 2006. He served as mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021. Those facts were true before the Lord Mayorship. Nubian Li was already a singer and long-time creative partner of Bobi Wine before becoming Mayor of Nakawa Division. Swengere was already a comedian and radio presenter before winning the NUP ticket and the general seat.

The earlier work did not need the later result to become real.

This is a crucial principle for small groups. Ask participants to name a person they respect without mentioning that person's future. If the description depends entirely on what the person might become, it is not yet appreciation of the present.

Recognition after results can also become shallow. When a person succeeds, many people claim they always believed in them. But belief that appears only after public confirmation is often agreement with evidence. Appreciation before confirmation requires attention.

The case of Nubian Li adds another dimension. Bobi Wine's public statement at the 2021 wedding recognized encouragement that had mattered before the later public outcome. The acknowledgment reminds us that the earlier act deserved to be named even after the story had grown.

This is not a call to flatter everyone. Appreciation must be truthful. We can recognize effort without pretending it is excellence. We can acknowledge growth without calling it completion. We can give a person a chance while keeping clear expectations.

Truthful appreciation is stronger than prediction.

The case of Swengere also teaches caution. His public familiarity through comedy and radio is documented, as is his later victory. We should not use the outcome to claim that every entertainer is automatically prepared for public office. That would turn one story into an unfair formula.

The proper lesson is narrower: do not decide too quickly that a person's present field prevents future responsibility. Remain attentive to what is actually present, and let future doors remain open without forcing them.

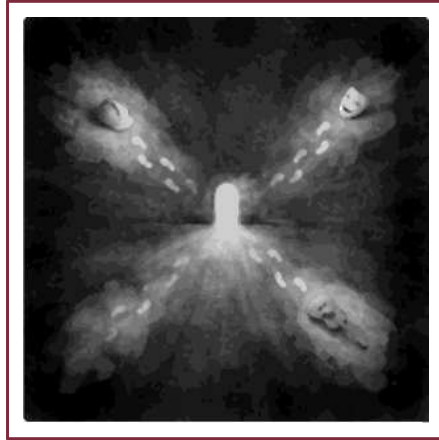
For a practical takeaway, invite members to write one honest sentence of appreciation to a person whose work is still mostly unseen. The sentence should name the present contribution and avoid predicting a future title.

Recognition may be public. Appreciation can be private. Both matter, but they do different work.

Who deserves your honest appreciation now, before any public result makes it easy to offer?

CHAPTER 9

Unseen Preparation and Cost



Preparation is not always visible, and it is not always comfortable.

Balimwezo's public path includes years in local government, the mayorship of Nakawa Division, parliamentary service, and later the Lord Mayorship. Nubian Li's story includes music, creative partnership, encouragement of Bobi Wine's political beginning, later public office, and nearly a year in jail following the 2021 campaigns. Swengere's path includes comedy, radio, no prior political career, a party ticket, and a parliamentary win with 19,427 votes.

These facts do not form one identical pattern. They do show that later public roles can be connected to earlier work and difficult seasons that did not look like a final outcome.

Preparation is not always a staircase; sometimes it is a season whose purpose remains hidden.

Preparation is not always a staircase; sometimes it is a season whose purpose remains hidden.

We must handle hardship with care. The record tells us that Nubian Li was jailed for nearly a year following the 2021 campaigns. It does not tell us everything he felt or how he interpreted that period. We should not invent an inner testimony. We can acknowledge the fact without turning his suffering into a convenient inspirational device.

This is a good discipline for faith study. Do not force every painful event to become a lesson too quickly. Sometimes the first faithful response is to tell the truth about what happened and refuse to pretend that difficulty is simple.

The same caution applies to preparation. We can observe that Balimwezo served for years before the Lord Mayorship. We cannot claim that every year was consciously designed as preparation for that office. We can say that long service preceded a wider responsibility.

Swengere had no prior political career before entering the 2026 path described in the brief. That fact reminds us that preparation may not always look like a conventional political ladder. His public work was in comedy and radio. The later opportunity required a crossing into Parliament.

The cases invite us to distinguish preparation from prediction. Preparation is the formation of capacities and habits through real responsibilities. Prediction is a claim about what will happen next. We may recognize the first without pretending to know the second.

In a small group, this distinction can prevent harmful spiritual pressure. Members should not be told that every hardship guarantees promotion or that every delay proves God is preparing a public reward. Faithfulness is valuable even when the future remains ordinary.

At the same time, we should not dismiss hidden seasons. A person may be learning through work that seems unrelated to their future. They may be carrying responsibility without an audience. They may be developing a way of serving that becomes useful in another field.

Nubian Li's encouragement of Bobi Wine shows that preparation and influence can also be relational. The act that helped another person begin may later become part of one's own story, but the earlier act should not be judged only by the later return.

The practical takeaway is to ask: what is this season teaching you to carry, regardless of whether it leads to a title? That question honours growth without demanding a particular outcome.

Unseen preparation is not wasted simply because it is unseen. But neither should we use the language of preparation to excuse harm, stagnation, or carelessness. The faithful response is honest service, teachability, and attention to what the present responsibility requires.

What hidden season are you tempted to call wasted, and what is it honestly teaching you to carry today?

CHAPTER 10

Appreciation as a Spiritual Practice



Appreciation is often treated as a mood. In these stories, it is better understood as a practice of seeing.

It means recognizing that people carry significance before the world confirms it. It means respecting present service without demanding a dramatic future. It means remembering that the person next to us may be building, receiving, or walking through a door we cannot yet see.

Balimwezo, Nubian Li, and Swengere make this practice concrete. Balimwezo's years in engineering, lecturing, local government, and Parliament preceded the Lord Mayorship. Nubian Li's music and creative partnership preceded his mayoral office, and his encouragement was publicly remembered as part of Bobi Wine's political beginning. Swengere's comedy

and radio work preceded a parliamentary seat despite having no prior political career.

Appreciation is faithfulness toward what is present before it becomes impressive.

Appreciation is faithfulness toward what is present before it becomes impressive.

This does not mean seeing only potential. Potential can become another way of refusing to see the person who is already here. We should not value a singer only because the singer may become a mayor. We should not value an engineer only because the engineer may become Lord Mayor. We should not value a comedian only because the comedian may become an MP.

People are not valuable because of their possible public usefulness.

They are valuable now.

The later outcomes simply reveal that our first descriptions were incomplete. That is why appreciation must be more than strategic recognition. If we encourage people only when we see a future benefit, we are not appreciating them; we are assessing them as investments.

A small group can practice appreciation through three questions. What has this person done faithfully? What burden may their work carry? What truthful sentence can I say without exaggeration or prediction?

The practice also requires listening. We should not impose our interpretation on another person's life. We can appreciate what we observe without claiming to know motives. We can say, "I have seen your consistency," without saying, "God will certainly make you famous."

This protects dignity.

It also protects the community from disappointment. If we turn every person into a prophecy, we will feel betrayed when the person's life takes another shape. Appreciation without possession allows people to become themselves before God.

The stories also reveal the cost of delayed appreciation. We often speak after the public result because speaking earlier would have required attention and courage. We would have had to recognize a person without the safety of consensus.

Faith-rooted appreciation does not need to be loud. It needs to be true.

For practice, ask each member to identify one person whose current work has become invisible through familiarity. Then ask them to offer one specific sentence of thanks within the week. The sentence should not mention promotion, future influence, or public success.

The exercise may seem small. That is part of the point. Doors are not always opened by dramatic speeches. Sometimes they are kept open by ordinary acts of recognition.

Appreciation does not determine another person's destiny. It may still strengthen the courage with which they carry today.

Whose present faithfulness have you made ordinary through familiarity, **and what specific truth about their service will you name?**

CHAPTER 11

The Ethics of Opening Doors



Not every open door is a good door, and not every invitation is wise.

The language of opportunity can become careless if it ignores accountability. A person may be given a platform and still need training. A person may be popular and still need correction. A person may be gifted and still need boundaries. Appreciation does not require us to suspend judgment.

The three case studies allow us to hold generosity and responsibility together.

Balimwezo's later office followed years of public service. Nubian Li's later office followed music, creative partnership, and a story of encouragement. Swengere's parliamentary victory followed comedy and radio work, despite no prior political career. Each story includes an opening, but none gives us permission to assume that openings are enough.

A healthy door offers opportunity without removing responsibility.

This is especially important for small groups because spiritual communities can confuse support with blind loyalty. We may believe in a person and still tell the truth. We may give someone a chance and still define the limits of the responsibility. We may appreciate a gift and still ask whether the person is ready to use it well.

The case of Swengere makes this especially clear. His comedy and radio work made him well known across eastern Uganda, and the facts record his later ticket and victory. But public familiarity is not identical to preparation for every parliamentary duty. The responsible teaching is not that popularity guarantees leadership. It is that a person from outside conventional political experience should not be dismissed automatically.

The case of Balimwezo shows another side. Long preparation does not guarantee that every later challenge will be easy. Experience matters, but it does not remove the need for continued learning.

Nubian Li's story shows that relationship can open a path, but relationship should not become manipulation. Encouragement is not a license to control the person encouraged. A door should not become a debt that governs someone's future.

The ethics of opening doors therefore include honesty, consent, support, and release. Make the opportunity clear. Do not promise what you cannot provide. Offer guidance without claiming ownership. Let the person accept or decline responsibility. If they enter, allow them to grow into the room.

This is the practical takeaway for leaders: ask whether your support expands another person's agency or merely expands your own influence. If the person must remain dependent on you in order to keep the opportunity, the door may be serving the builder more than the traveller.

For those receiving opportunity, the ethic is gratitude without bondage. Remember who helped you. Use the room responsibly. Continue learning. Do not treat a chance as proof that you no longer need accountability.

A platform can be generous and still require standards. A community can be welcoming and still require truth. Appreciation can be warm and still be

wise.

The God who lifts people does not need us to abandon discernment. He asks us to use discernment without contempt.

What door are you opening for someone, and what safeguards will help the opportunity remain both generous and responsible?

CHAPTER 12

The God Who Lifts People



The three stories now stand together.

Ronald Balimwezo: civil engineer, lecturer at Kyambogo University, local government servant since 2006, mayor of Nakawa Division from 2011 to 2021, MP from 2021 to 2026, and Lord Mayor of Kampala after winning the January 2026 race on the NUP ticket and being sworn in during May 2026.

Nubian Li, or Ali Bukeni: singer and long-time creative partner of Bobi Wine, publicly identified by Bobi Wine as the friend whose encouragement helped make the 2017 Kyadondo East decision possible, later declared Mayor of Nakawa Division in January 2026.

Swengere, or Hussein Muyonjo: comedian and Baba FM radio presenter, well known across eastern Uganda, with no prior political career, later winning the NUP ticket and the Jinja North Division general seat with 19,427 votes after defeating 13 other candidates.

The cases are not identical, and they should not be forced into one formula. Their professional histories differ. Their public roles differ. Their routes differ.

The shared platform and the repeated pattern are enough.

God often lifts people through doors that no single person could have built alone.

Bobi Wine entered politics through the 2017 Kyadondo East by-election and built People Power into NUP. His decision became part of the context through which other people later entered public office. Nubian Li's encouragement was publicly remembered as part of that beginning. Balimwezo's years of service met a wider platform. Swengere crossed from comedy and radio into Parliament.

What does this reveal about how God lifts people?

First, God is not limited by professional categories. The engineer, singer, and comedian each carried a different history into public responsibility. Their stories remind us that a person's current field is not the limit of God's possible use.

Second, God works through people. The platform was built by a person's decision. Encouragement came through a friendship. Opportunities were received by people who still had to carry their own responsibilities. Divine action did not remove human agency; it moved through it.

Third, preparation may remain hidden until opportunity arrives. Balimwezo's local service preceded the Lord Mayorship. Nubian Li's encouragement preceded the office he later received. Swengere's public work preceded a political career he had not previously entered.

Fourth, appreciation is part of faithful seeing. We cannot know who will become important in a public sense. We can still honour the people already near us. We can recognize service before titles, gifts before offices, and courage before results.

Finally, the door is not the destination. A platform can open an opportunity, but the person must still serve. A title can increase visibility, but it cannot create character. A public result can confirm a moment, but it cannot explain an entire life.

For small groups, this volume can be used as a series of questions rather than a set of conclusions. Who has opened a door for you? Whose door have you helped build? What gift are you dismissing because it appears in an unfamiliar field? Where have you waited for proof before offering appreciation? What responsibility comes with the opportunity you have received?

The answers will differ because the lives in the room differ. That is fitting. The cases themselves are different. The pattern is not sameness. It is possibility.

No one in these stories could see the entire chain at the beginning. Bobi Wine could not know every later beneficiary of the platform. Nubian Li could not know how his encouragement would be remembered or what public role he would later hold. Balimwezo could not know how his years of service would meet a future opening. Swengere could not know where comedy and radio would lead.

Neither can we see the whole story.

That is not a reason to become passive. It is a reason to become faithful with what is in our hands. Appreciate the person beside you. Make room where you can. Carry your own opportunity responsibly. Refuse to reduce people to their present titles. Do not demand that every gift become public before you honour it.

The God who lifts people may be preparing someone in your room. He may also be preparing you through a room you have not yet learned to value.

A final practical exercise is simple. Name one person whose potential you have not yet learned to see. Name one opportunity you received from someone else. Name one door you can open without controlling who walks through it. Then act on one of those answers.

The point is not to predict the future. The point is to become faithful in the present.

The engineer, singer, and comedian did not build the same story. They walked through a shared opening in different ways. Their lives show that God can lift people through platforms, friendships, preparation, and unexpected transitions.

We do not know who is next.

So appreciate the person beside you now.

Whose door may you already be standing beside, and what faithful act of appreciation or opportunity will you offer before you know the ending?

◆

The Author of Every Page

◆

When we read a book, we understand something the characters inside it cannot fully understand: there is an author behind the pages.

The character experiences the uncertainty of the chapter. The reader may wonder what will happen next. But the author already knows. The author knows who will rise, who will wait, who will meet whom, and when the door will open. The character lives the page one sentence at a time. The author holds the whole story.

That is the central truth we must carry from these pages: God is not merely observing our lives. He is the principal Author of them.

He does not simply watch history unfold from a distance. He writes within it. He knows the chapter before we recognize the title. He knows the meeting before two people understand why their paths have crossed. He knows the door before the traveller sees the handle.

No one reads ahead in their own story, but the Author already knows every page.

The engineer, the singer, and the comedian did not write the chapter in which they became leaders. Ronald Balimwezo did not create every circumstance through which his path moved from engineering, lecturing, local government, and parliamentary service into the Lord Mayorship of Kampala. Ali Bukeni, known as Nubian Li, did not write the full meaning of the encouragement that helped Bobi Wine take his first political step,

nor could he have known that he would later be declared Mayor of Nakawa Division. Hussein Muyonjo, known as Swengere, did not write the

chapter in which a comedian and radio presenter with no prior political career would win the NUP ticket and then win the Jinja North Division parliamentary seat.

They carried responsibility, but they did not possess the whole manuscript.

Someone else did.

Behind the human hand that opened a door, an even greater Author had already understood the chapter. Behind the encouragement, the platform, the opportunity, and the unexpected transition, God was not confused. He was not discovering the ending as the people discovered it. He was not waiting for history to tell Him what their lives would become.

The people inside the story experienced uncertainty. God did not.

This does not mean that human choices are meaningless. A book's characters may still act, speak, resist, love, work, and choose within the story. The fact that God authors a life does not turn a person into a lifeless object. Balimwezo still had to serve. Nubian Li still had to encourage. Swengere still had to accept responsibility. The door could open, but someone still had to walk through it.

Yet the final authority over the story does not belong to the traveller.

We often live as though it does. We think our future depends entirely on whether a person notices us, whether an institution accepts us, whether a rival blocks us, or

whether an obstacle remains in our path. These things can affect the page we are currently reading. They do not become the author of the book.

People can influence a chapter. They cannot seize the manuscript from God.

Obstacles can delay a page. They cannot delete what God has written.

Opposition can make the story difficult to understand. It cannot finally cancel the purposes of the Author.

Throughout history, resistance to God's purposes has never become greater than God's authority. He has always defeated opposition to what He

has ordained, not through the pride of human triumph, but through the settled strength of His sovereignty. The confidence is peaceful because the outcome does not depend on our anger. God does not need us to threaten anyone, label anyone as His enemy, or turn another person's life into a battlefield. We can rest in the truth that no created resistance is ultimate before the One who writes history.

That truth should make us humble, not boastful.

If God is the Author, then we are not required to understand every page before we trust Him. The character does not need to know the whole plot in order to be faithful in the present scene. We may be living through a chapter that feels slow, confusing, or unfinished. We may see only a closed door while God sees the room beyond it. We may think a delay has become the whole story when it is only a paragraph.

The people in this book did not read ahead. They lived through their own pages without the benefit of the final table of contents. The engineer served before the wider office.

The singer encouraged before the later public responsibility. The comedian worked in radio before entering Parliament. The meaning of their earlier chapters became clearer only when later pages had been written.

That is often how God teaches us.

He gives enough light for the next step, not always enough light for the entire road. He gives us today's responsibility before He explains tomorrow's significance. He may ask us to honour a relationship whose future we cannot see, to remain faithful in a role that feels small, or to trust a door that has not yet opened.

The Author is not careless with the pages that confuse us.

He knows where they belong.

This does not make every painful event easy, and it does not ask us to call injustice good. It does not require passive acceptance of harm or the denial of real grief. It gives us a deeper place from which to face what we cannot yet explain. We may tell the truth about a difficult chapter while still believing that the Author has not lost control of the book.

The page may be unclear to us.

It is not unclear to Him.

So appreciate the people God has placed in your current chapter. You do not know whether you are encouraging a future leader, serving beside someone whose responsibility will widen, or receiving help from a person whose significance you have not yet learned to see. Do not wait until the final title appears before you honour the present person.

And when your own chapter feels unfinished, do not assume that unfinished means forgotten. A story can be incomplete without being abandoned. A door can be closed without being the end. A delay can be real without being ultimate.

The Author of every page is still writing.

You are not required to read ahead.

You are required to trust Him with the page in front of you, to carry today's responsibility honestly, and to believe that no obstacle has the authority to become the final author of your life.

What chapter do you believe you are currently living, and can you trust the Author even in the pages that do not yet make sense?

Author's Note

I wrote this volume by placing three lives side by side and resisting the urge to make them identical.

Ronald Balimwezo is an engineer, lecturer, local government servant, former mayor of Nakawa Division, former MP, and Lord Mayor of Kampala. Ali Bukeni, known as Nubian Li, is a singer and long-time creative partner of Bobi Wine who later became Mayor of Nakawa Division. Hussein Muyonjo, known as Swengere, is a comedian and radio presenter who later won a parliamentary seat in Jinja North Division.

Their professional histories are different. Their public responsibilities are different. Their routes into opportunity are different. That difference is not an obstacle to the teaching. It is the teaching.

Bobi Wine's 2017 entry into politics through the Kyadondo East by-election and his later building of People Power into NUP created a connecting platform. The platform did not make the people empty vessels. Each person brought a history, a gift, and a responsibility. The door mattered, and so did the travellers.

Nubian Li's story added a particular tenderness to the volume. Bobi Wine publicly said at the 2021 wedding that without Nubian Li's encouragement, he might never have contested the by-election that began his own political career. That statement shows how a friend's encouragement can become part of public history. It also reminds us that the person who helps build a door may later discover that the door opens for them too.

The facts in this volume are deliberately limited. I have not invented private motives, scenes, or dialogue. I have not treated political office as proof that a person is perfect. I have not taken a political side. These are real, living public figures, and they deserve dignity beyond whatever lesson a reader may draw from their stories.

The lesson I do draw is simple. God lifts people through people. He uses platforms, friendships, preparation, and opportunities. He can carry influence from engineering,

music, comedy, radio, or any other field into a responsibility no one could have predicted from the beginning.

But the deepest lesson is about appreciation. We do not know who is being prepared. We do not know whose encouragement will become part of another person's courage. We do not know which ordinary responsibility will later meet an unexpected door. We do not know whether the person beside us will become publicly significant, but we do know that the person already has dignity.

So let us learn to see before the proof arrives. Let us make room without trying to possess the future. Let us receive opportunity with gratitude and carry it with responsibility. Let us honour the builder, the traveller, and the people who kept the door open long enough for the story to continue.

The God who lifts people is not limited to one kind of person or one kind of path. That is good news for those who feel overlooked, and it is a warning to those who think they already know who matters.

We rarely see the door before we are standing in it.

Muhumuza Bright Andrew

Appendix A: Case Study Summary

Ronald Balimwezo: civil engineer and local councillor since 2006, then Lord Mayor of Kampala (2026). Competence needed a wider platform, not more competence.

Nubian Li (Ali Bukeni): singer and longtime creative partner of Bobi Wine, then Mayor, Nakawa Division (2026). The door he helped build for someone else opened for him too, years later.

Swengere (Hussein Muyonjo): comedian and radio presenter, then MP, Jinja North Division (2026). Public trust built in one field transferred into a governing mandate.

Appendix B: Discussion Questions

1. What "door" has already opened in your life that you haven't fully walked through yet?
2. Have you ever helped build a door for someone else, only to find yourself walking through a version of it later?

About the Author

Muhumuza Bright Andrew is a full-stack developer and writer based in Mbarara, Uganda, working under the brand Bryt Ma Tech Uganda. His writing draws on faith, personal experience, and close observation of the world around him to explore how ordinary decisions, often made for reasons that have nothing to do with anyone watching, end up shaping the lives of others in ways no one could have predicted. *God of Balimwezo* is part of a growing series of books exploring themes of faith, appreciation, and purpose.

GOD OF BALIMWEZO

OMNIBUS EDITION

Three people. Three fields. One repeating pattern. An analytical faith-study built around three case studies: an engineer who became a mayor, a singer and friend who became a mayor, and a comedian who became an MP. Their professional histories were different, but each story raises the same question: how does God lift people through platforms, relationships, preparation, and unexpected opportunity?

Muhumuza Bright Andrew

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About the Author

Muhumuza Bright Andrew writes on faithfulness, leadership, and the unseen years that shape a public life. God of Balimwezo is his study of what it means to remain faithful before an audience arrives.

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